SATURDAY
November 14, 2026

DELHI
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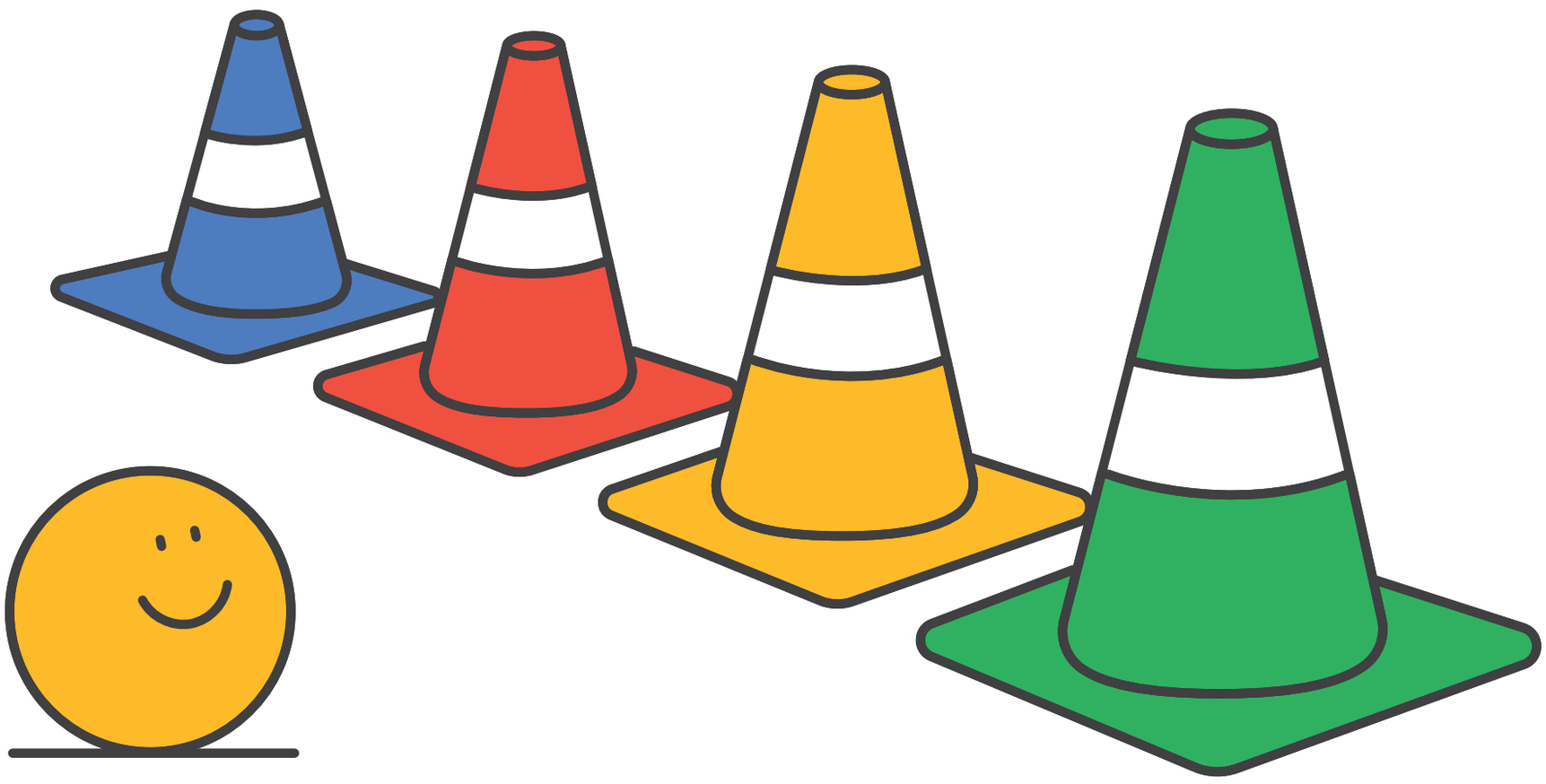
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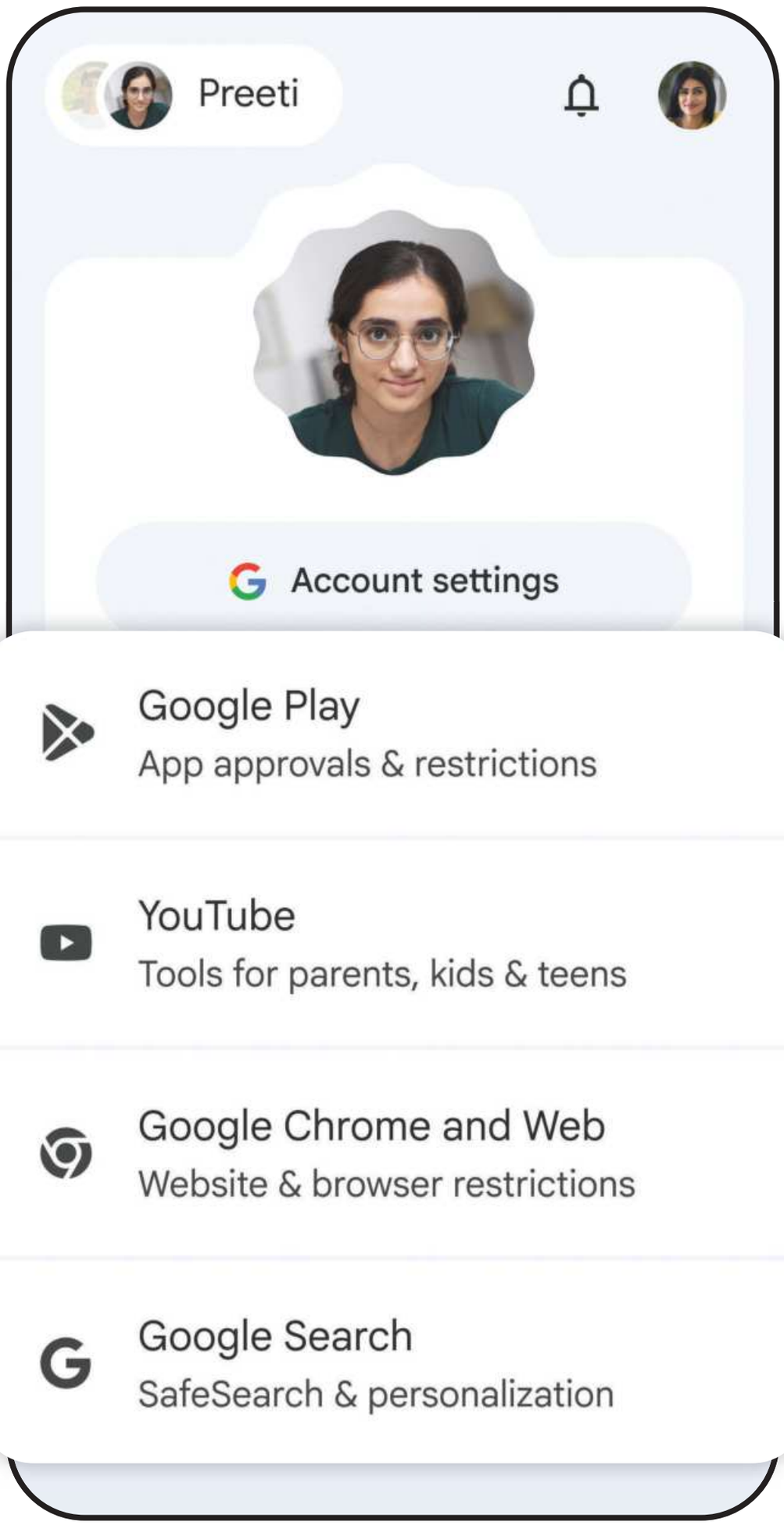
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Learn more about how to set up these safety features

Simulated UI for creative purposes. Results may vary.

DigiKavach
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Noida (Delhi-NCR)	20 Nov | 6:00 PM	25 नवंबर | सुबह 11:30 बजे
Indore	14 Dec | 8:00 AM	16 दिसंबर | सुबह 8:00 बजे
Jaipur	26 Nov | 5:00 PM	9 दिसंबर | सुबह 11:00 बजे

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IN BRIEF



PM flags off new Namma Metro line in Bengaluru

BENGALURU
Prime Minister Narendra Modi flagged off an elevated section of the Pink Line of Namma Metro in Bengaluru on Friday. With this, Namma Metro's operational network crossed 100 km, making it the second-largest network after the Delhi Metro. » Page 3

Owaisi-Azad tie-up won't affect INDIA bloc, say SP, Cong.

LUCKNOW
The SP and Congress on Friday said the alliance of Asaduddin Owaisi's AIMIM and Chandrashekhar Azad's ASP (KR) will have no impact on voters from social groups facing injustice under the BJP government in U.P. » Page 4

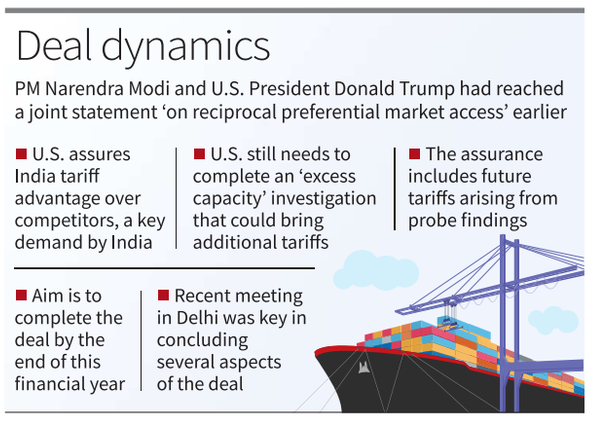
U.S. assures India of tariff edge over its competitors

Both sides working to conclude interim trade deal by fiscal year-end, officials say, with New Delhi insisting on assurances of comparative advantage as agreed in the Trump-Modi joint statement

T.C.A. Sharad Raghavan
NEW DELHI

In a significant breakthrough towards the conclusion of the India-U.S. interim trade deal, the U.S. has assured India of a comparative advantage over its competitors once it finalises its tariff structure, a senior official in the Commerce and Industry Ministry said, adding that both sides were working to complete the deal by the end of the current financial year.

Officials in New Delhi have said that India would move ahead with the deal only if it was assured of a comparative advantage, as was agreed to in the February 2026 joint statement between Prime Minister Narendra Modi and U.S. President Donald Trump.



"Talks are ongoing and the U.S. has assured us of a comparative advantage over our competitor countries," the senior official said on the condition of anonymity.

This is a significant development because officials, including Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal, have repeatedly said that India would move ahead with a deal with the U.S. only if it is assured of a comparative advantage over its competitors.

Separately, Commerce Secretary Rajesh Agrawal confirmed that a two-man team from the U.S. visited India earlier this month during which substantial progress was made towards finalising the text of the deal. The February joint statement stated that the U.S. and India "commit to provide each other preferential market access in sectors of respective interest on a sustained basis".

However, since then, the U.S. has imposed additional 10% 'forced labour' tariffs on India, the same as on some of its competitors such as Indonesia, Malaysia, Pakistan, and Sri Lanka. It is also conducting an investigation into India and other countries related to excess capacity, which could see additional tariffs levied. The official, however, said the U.S. assurance of comparative advantage for India takes into account this future tariff.

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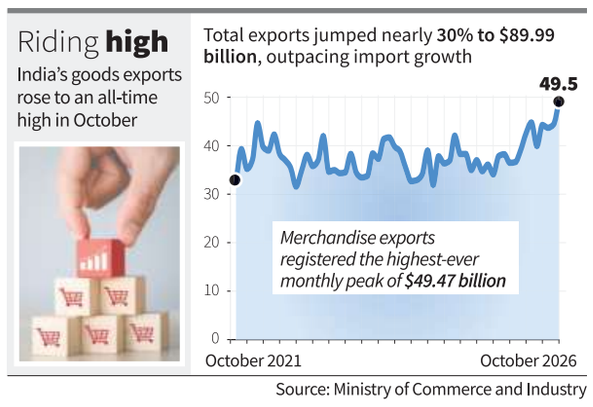
Exports touch record high as diversification pays off

T.C.A. Sharad Raghavan
NEW DELHI

India's merchandise exports rose to an all-time high of $49.5 billion in October, bringing down the country's overall trade deficit, official data released on Friday showed.

While a large part of this growth was due to petroleum products, Commerce Secretary Rajesh Agrawal said diversification of exports to various locations helped improve the numbers. India's total exports, including goods and services, stood at $89.99 billion in October 2026, up nearly 30% from last October. The overall trade deficit shrank from $25.1 billion last October to $20.1 billion year-on-year (YoY).

"In the month of October, merchandise exports have registered a new peak of $49.47 billion," Mr. Agrawal said at a press briefing. "This is the highest-ever monthly merchandise export value, along with the highest monthly growth of 45.03% in the last five years."



Source: Ministry of Commerce and Industry

Merchandise imports rose to a record high of $89.35 billion in October 2026, up 16.5% YoY. Total imports stood at $110.1 billion, a 16.6% increase.

According to trade experts, goods exports growing faster than merchandise imports shows that while the rise in global prices contributed to the increase in the value of India's exports, there was also an increase in the underlying export volumes.

"The particularly encouraging part of this growth is that this is not in any particular sector, this is not in any particular geography, it is broad-based across countries and regions," Mr. Agrawal said. "Forty-three of our 50 top export destinations posted positive growth in October this year as compared to 2025."

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CHALLENGES PM
Modi tapped my phone, says Rahul Gandhi
NEWS » PAGE 11



TENSION MOUNTS
Four Naga civilians killed in Manipur
NEWS » PAGE 10



YOUNG, HENRY SHINE
New Zealand crushes India in fourth ODI
SPORT » PAGE 17

Iran says it targeted a U.S. radar in Bahrain in retaliatory strike

Stanly Johny

Iran's Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps (IRGC) on Friday said it had "destroyed" a U.S. military early-warning radar in Bahrain, in retaliation for a U.S. strike on a telecommunications tower in Sirik in the country's south.

"An hour ago, in response to the enemy's air attack on a telecommunications tower in Sirik, the IRGC's aerospace fighters targeted and destroyed the early-warning radar of the American aggressors on the island of Bahrain," the IRGC said in its statement.

It added that the attack was "a serious warning to the aggressor enemy to end air mischief and oil smuggling in the Strait of Hormuz".



Iran Guards said the attack was a warning to end air mischief and oil smuggling in the Strait of Hormuz. REUTERS

The U.S. military's Central Command denied that the radar had been destroyed and said it intercepted two "one-way attack drones" launched at Bahrain by the Guards.

FULL STORY ON
» WORLD PAGE

Festive fervour



Devotees carry brass vessels on their heads at the Ganga ghat on *Nahay Khay*, the first day of Chhath Puja, in Patna on Friday. ANI

Students among 24 killed in Assam minibus-truck collision

The Hindu Bureau
GUWAHATI

Twenty-four people, including college students, were killed when a minibus collided head-on with a container truck at Rangajan near Kaziranga National Park in eastern Assam's Golaghat district on Friday.

Officials said 39 people, including the driver, were on board the minibus when the accident occurred around 1 p.m. on National Highway no. 715. The spot is about 230 km east of Guwahati.

Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma confirmed the number of casualties and said that several critically injured persons were undergoing treatment at the Jorhat Medical College and Hospital in the adjoining Jorhat district and the Civil Hospital in Golaghat, the district headquarters. Of the 15 injured, some were battling for their lives.



Fatal accident: People gather at the site of collision near the Kaziranga National Park in Assam on Friday. AFP

CONTINUED ON
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Global disruption of Microsoft services hits Indian businesses

Balasubramanyam C.P.
CHENNAI

The global disruption of multiple Microsoft services, which began on Thursday and continued late into Friday, affected several Indian businesses' internal communications and customer-facing operations.

In its latest update on Friday, the company said it was making progress in fixing the outage, which has affected e-mail access and workplace applications in businesses, public services, and other organisations across the globe.

In India, the disruptions affected businesses from start-ups to multinational corporations.

A senior executive at a major telecom company in India told *The Hindu* that employees were unable to access e-mails or send service-disruption alerts to customers. Call-centre traffic also increased, the executive said.

Meetings disrupted

Rahul Ganapathy, CEO of deep tech start-up Atsuya Technologies, said customer e-mails and scheduled Teams meetings were disrupted, though his company did not rely entirely on Microsoft.

At a Big Four professional services firm in Bengaluru, a senior employee said its internal operations were affected, but added that IT teams were restoring services.

The disruptions also left airlines experiencing customer-support delays.

IndiGo said its e-mail support was affected and advised customers to use 6E Skai, its AI-powered virtual assistant.

Akasa Air warned of e-mail support delays and directed passengers to its customer care centre and social media. Air India said flight operations were unaffected, although it rerouted e-mails.

High-severity advisory

Separately, India's Computer Emergency Response Team (CERT-In), under the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology, issued a high-severity advisory on Friday, warning of multiple vulnerabilities in Microsoft products.

It flagged an Outlook vulnerability that it said was being actively exploited and urged users to apply security updates.

The advisory did not explicitly link the vulnerabilities to the outage.

'Recovery under way'

Microsoft identified Exchange Online – described as its cloud-based messaging platform that delivers e-mail, calendar, contacts, and tasks – as the primary service affected.

Some Microsoft Graph requests accessing Exchange Online data timed out, affecting dependent features in Teams, Copilot, and SharePoint, the company said. Core Teams messaging and online meetings largely continued normally, it added.

It said recovery was progressing, with improvements in North America and Europe and encouraging signs in Asia-Pacific.

Service availability and e-mail delivery were improving, but intermittent access problems and delays could continue, it said, adding that it was working through e-mail backlogs and retained a 48-hour timeout window to protect delayed messages. Service health and capacity had not fully returned to baseline, said the company.

CONTINUED ON
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INBRIEF



L-G unveils mutli-level parking facility at Bhikaji Cama Place

Lieutenant-Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu inaugurated a multi-level parking facility built by the Delhi Development Authority (DDA) at Bhikaji Cama Place on Friday. The facility can accommodate 432 cars and 193 two-wheelers. Speaking at the event, the L-G said the facility will ensure smoother mobility. "Equipped with modern, accessible amenities, it will ease roadside congestion in this busy commercial hub. I have directed the DDA to identify more sites across congested markets and institutional areas for similar facilities," said Mr. Sandhu.

DU clears ₹17-cr. aid for infant with rare genetic disorder

Delhi University on Friday approved a proposal to provide ₹17 crore in aid for the treatment of the nine-month-old daughter of a faculty member at the School of Open Learning (SOL). The infant has been diagnosed with Type II spinal muscular atrophy, a rare genetic disorder. The SOL Academic Association raised ₹3.11 crore through crowdfunding and other contributions. SOL Director Payal Mago said the coordinated efforts of university faculty and prompt action had helped secure financial assistance for the child's treatment within the required time frame.

Four-day Chhath Puja begins: all facilities in place, says CM; tents few, ghats dirty: Oppn.

Gupta says she's monitoring arrangements; fast has begun but lighting, sanitation are lacking: AAP; govt. pushed Purvanchalis to observe the festival in filth: Cong.; schools to remain closed on Monday

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI



Devotees taking a dip in the Yamuna in New Delhi on Friday. PTI

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Friday said preparations for Chhath Puja in Delhi were complete and she was personally monitoring the arrangements to ensure that every devotee observing the fast has access to a safe, clean and convenient environment for offering prayers.

The four-day festival dedicated to the Sun God began on Friday. It is observed by Purvanchalis and other communities in Bihar, Uttar Pradesh, West Bengal and Jharkhand.

The Opposition Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) and the Congress questioned the state of preparations, claiming that the arrangements were far from satisfactory and accusing the Delhi government of "playing with the sentiments" of the Purvanchali community in the national capital.

Meanwhile, the Directorate of Education (DoE) on Friday announced that schools in Delhi will remain closed on November 16 on account of the festival. The holiday will be observed in all government, government-aided and recognised unaided private schools, as per the DoE circular.

Speaking to mediapersons after inspecting various ghats and conducting a review meeting, the CM said she had directed officials to ensure that all obstacles are removed as a priority through coordination among the departments concerned.

She added that arrangements for electricity, water, roads, security, medical facilities and sanitation had been completed to ensure that devotees face no inconvenience.

In a release, the Chief Minister's Office stated that senior officials, including District Magistrates, are conducting ground inspections of the ghats in coordination with Chhath Puja committees and the agencies concerned.

AAP MLA from Burari Sanjeev Jha, who hails from the Purvanchali community, said he visited Shyam Ghat in Jagatpur and Shastri Park Ghat in Burari and found the arrangements for tents, lighting and sanitation to be lacking. "The fast has already begun, and the tents have still not been installed. The government failed to prepare for the festival in time," he said.

'Purvanchalis misled'

Delhi Congress president Devender Yadav alleged the BJP had been misleading Purvanchalis on the state of preparations, as the Yamuna stretch from Wazirabad to Okhla has "nothing but tonnes of garbage".

Speaking to reporters at Soorghat in Wazirabad, Mr. Yadav said, "The Rekha Gupta government has pushed the devotees to hold the pious festival in drainwater. Devotees are being greeted with filth. The BJP has made a mockery of its responsibility towards people."

Hazardous air in city; traffic police to step up checks at borders

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI



City residents woke up to hazardous air on Friday. PTI

Delhi reported severe air pollution on Friday morning, with the air quality improving marginally towards the evening, as per official data.

Delhi Traffic Police said it held an inter-State coordination meeting on measures to intensify checks at the city's borders and alternative entry routes to prevent vehicles that don't meet the emission norms under the Graded Response Action Plan from entering the national capital.

Under the existing restrictions, non-Delhi registered vehicles that do not comply with BS-VI emission norms are not allowed into the city.

The Capital's 24-hour average overall air quality index (AQI) was 403 ('severe') at 9 a.m. on Friday, as per Central Pollution Control Board data, an increase from Thursday's AQI of 373 ('very poor').

AQI is a measurement of air pollution on a scale of 0-500. A higher value suggests an increase in toxicity. An AQI reading between 201 and 300 is considered 'poor', 301 and 400 'very poor', 401 and 450 'severe' and 451 and 500 'severe plus'.

As per Ministry of Earth Sciences data, vehicular emissions contributed nearly 20.2% of the pollution load, followed by stubble burning at 9.2%.

In a release, Delhi Traffic Police stated: "Officers were asked to ensure adequate police deployment at border entry points, alternative routes and entry loops to identify, intercept and divert vehicles that do not comply with the prescribed restrictions." It added that checks for Pollution Under Control certificates and violations of the norms laid down by the Supreme Court and National Green Tribunal will be intensified.

HIMACHAL PRADESH
PUBLIC WORKS DEPARTMENT
INVITATION FOR BIDS (IFB)

The Executive Engineer, Bhoranj Division HPPWD, Bhoranj on behalf of Governor of H.P invites the Item rate/ Percentage rate bids, in electronic tendering system from the eligible class for the works as detailed below on the table:-

Sr. No.	Name of work	Estimated Cost (In Rs.)	Earnest Money (in Rs.)	Starting date for downloading Bid	Deadline for submission of Bid
1.	R/R damages on link road Chamboh to Awahdevi via Hayor km 0/00 to 4/00(SH:- P/L C.Conc Pavement at Km 2/00 2/870)(Under PDNA 2025 Sr. No. 18391850) (II) R/R damages to link road Sangroh to Bakkar Khad via Bohana Km 0/00 to 3/900 (SH:- P/L C.conc pavement at RD 2/900 to 3/900 , 2/480 to 2/580, 2/610 to 2/700 , 0/210 to 0/230 & R/wall at RD 0/310 to 0/330, 0/898 to 0/910 (Under PDNA 2025 Sr. 1801) (III) R/R damages on link road Samirpur Bakkar Khad via Matlana Km 0/00 to 5/500 (SH:- P/L C.conc pavement at RD 0/00 to 1/600 (Under PDNA Serial No. 1804) .	1,82,76,063/-	3,65,600/-	16-11-2026	21-11-2026

The bidders are advised to note all details of tenders, from the department website

Executive Engineer,
Bhoranj Division,
HPPWD Bhoranj,
Pin Code 176045
Tel. No. 01972-266099
e-mail : eepwd-bhoranj-hp@gov.in
HIM SUCHANA
on behalf of Governor of HP.
HP / 4700/26-27 **AVAM JAN SAMPARK**

BENGALURU CENTRAL CITY CORPORATION
Office of the Executive Engineer,
Health and Sanitation, Ground Floor,
Behind Dasappa Hospital, N.R. Road, Bengaluru - 560002.

No: EE/H&S/TEND/01/2026-27 **Date: 13-11-2026**

INVITATION FOR TENDER (IFT)
(Two Cover System) (Through GOK KPP Portal only)

The Executive Engineer, Health and Sanitation, BCCC, Bengaluru invites Proposals (Technical and Financial) from eligible bidders for the work detailed below.

Sl. No.	Name of the Work
1	Engaging of 12 Nos. of Battery Operated Litter Picker Machine (Ride on Cum Walk Along Mode) on hire basis for a period of 12 Months in the Jurisdiction of Bengaluru Central City Corporation. **Amount Put to Tender (Rs. in Lakhs): 157.47, EMD Amount (in Rs.): 1,53,000/-**

Calendar of Events: **1)** RFP Document may be downloaded from the GOK Karnataka Public Procurement Portal Website: **https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in from 16-11-2026 at 16.00 Hours onwards. 2)** Last Date for Receipt of Queries on **20-11-2026 upto 15.00 Hours. 3)** Date of Pre Bid Meeting: **21-11-2026 at 15.30 Hours in the Office of the Executive Engineer (H&S). 4)** Last Date for Receipt of Tenders is **03-12-2026 upto 17.00 Hours. 5)** Date of Opening of Technical Proposals is **04-12-2026 at 17.00 Hours.** Further details can be had from the above office.

Sd/-
Executive Engineer, Health & Sanitation, BCCC.

PUNE MUNICIPAL CORPORATION
(PMC) PUNE 411 005.
SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER BHAVAN DEPARTMENT
Web - http://mahatenders.gov.in

Offers by way of e-tendering (Percentage Rate Tender) are invited by The Superintending Engineer, Bhavan Department, Pune Municipal Corporation, Pune from contractor's in e-tendering system for following works

1) E-tender sale period	:-	From 14/11/2026 (after 2:30 PM) to 08/12/2026 (up to 2:30 PM).
2) Tender acceptance period (final date & time)	:-	From 14/11/2026 (after 2:30 PM) to 08/12/2026 (up to 2:30 PM).
3) Date of opening technical bid envelope	:-	From 09/12/2026 (after 3:00 PM)

Sr. No	Tender No.	Name of the work	Total Tender Amount	Earnest Money (0.5%) Rs	Work Period	Cost of Tender Document	Name of the person responsible for the tender
1	PMC/BHAVAN/ 100/2026-27	Pr.Kr. 7 K Madhil Nadi Sudharna Praklpa Antargat Badhit Honari Sangamwadi Smashanbhumi Sthalantarit Karne Kami Sthaptya Vishayak Kame Karne.	71453664	357268	6 Months (including the monsoon period)	17879	Manojkumar Mate 9511944992

The details of the above work; such as Security Deposit, Earnest Money Deposit, Terms and Conditions of the etender and Schedule B of the work are available on website http://mahatenders.gov.in Tenders for this works are to be submitted by-tendering system.

Bidders can avail the e-tender document From 14/11/2026 (after 2:30 PM) to 08/12/2026 (up to 2:30 PM) Pune by the way of e-tendering system only. The last date of Submission by the way of e-tendering will be 08/12/2026 (up to 2:30 PM). The tender will be opened on 09/12/2026 on 3.00 pm.

ADVT No: 3/1107
Date: 13/11/2026

Executive Engineer(Bhavan)
Pune Municipal Corporation
Pune - 411005

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Or write to us at **customercare@thehindu.co.in**
Scan the QR code to register your feedback

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PUNJAB STATE WAREHOUSING CORPORATION
SCO 74-75, BANK SQUARE, SECTOR-17B CHANDIGARH
PBX: 0172-5197847, 5197846

NOTICE INVITING TENDER

PSWC invites online tenders through GeM Portal for creation of 0.50 LMT godown capacity at 01 location in the State of Punjab for guaranteed lease of 10 years on Build, Own and Operate/Lease basis for storage requirements of FCI under two bid system 'Technical Bid' and 'Financial Bid'.

NIT (alongwith GeM Bid IDs) is available on Department's website i.e. **https://pswc.in**

PSWC reserves the right to scrap the tender at any stage without assigning any reason and PSWC will not be held liable for any costs and consequences incurred by the intending bidders.

Note: Any corrigendum(s)/Notification(s) to this Notice Inviting E-Tender shall be published Department's website & GeM Portal.

1004/12/2026-27/17041 **Managing Director, PSWC**

उत्तराखण्ड पावर कारपोरेशन लिमिटेड
(उत्तराखण्ड सरकार का उपक्रम)
कार्यालय अधिशासी अभियन्ता, विद्युत वितरण खण्ड (उत्तर)
18 ई.सी. रोड, देहरादून दूरभाष : 2652916 Email:eddndn@yahoo.com

पत्रांक: 4999 / विविध (उ)/ दिनांक 13/11/26

निविदा सूचना

अधोहस्ताक्षरकर्ता द्वारा निम्नलिखित कार्य हेतु उत्तराखण्ड शासन द्वारा प्रदत्त विद्युत कार्यों के लिए 'क' श्रेणी के लाईसेन्स धारक, वैध जी.एस.टी., ई.पी.एफ., ई.एस.आई.सी. के अन्तर्गत पंजीकृत, आयकर / पैन कार्ड धारक निविदादाताओं से मुहरबन्द निविदायें दो भागो में (प्रथम भाग में निविदा धरोहर धनराशि संबंधी घोषणा पत्र, नियम एवं शर्तें, उत्तराखण्ड विद्युत निरीक्षक द्वारा निर्गत 'ए' क्लास लाईसेंस की प्रतिलिपि, जी.एस.टी पंजीकरण, पैनकार्ड आदि एवं द्वितीय भाग में दरें जो कि निविदा खुलने की तिथि से कम से कम छः माह तक वैध हों) दिनांक 28.11.2026 को 14.00 बजे तक आमंत्रित की जाती है जिसका प्रथम भाग उसी दिन 15.00 बजे उपस्थित निविदादाताओं अथवा उनके प्रतिनिधियों के सम्मुख अधोहस्ताक्षरी द्वारा सार्वजनिक रूप से खोला जायेगा। प्रथम भाग के मूल्यांकन के बाद द्वितीय भाग खोला जायेगा। निविदा प्रपत्र किसी भी कार्य दिवस में वैध जी.एस.टी. धारक के द्वारा दिनांक 27.11.2026 (14:00 बजे) तक अधोहस्ताक्षरी के कार्यालय से निविदा प्रपत्र का मूल्य नगद (अप्रतिदेय) जमा कर क्रय किये जा सकते हैं। बिना निविदा धरोहर धनराशि व अन्य संबधित घोषणा पत्र के निविदा भाग-2 नहीं खोली जायेंगी। निविदा खुलने की तिथि में अवकाश होने / अधोहस्ताक्षरी के मुख्यालय से बाहर होने पर अगले कार्य दिवस को निविदा खोली जाएगी। अधोहस्ताक्षरी को यह अधिकार होगा कि वह बिना कारण बताये समस्त अथवा किसी भी निविदा को निरस्त कर सकते हैं। विस्तृत नियम एवं शर्ते निविदा प्रपत्र में वर्णित हैं।

निविदा संख्या 30/EDD(N)/2026-2027, Work - R&R work under EDSD Anarwala, Rajpur Road & Sahastradhara Road Under EDD (North), Dehradun की धरोहर राशि रू0 30,000.00, निविदा प्रपत्र का मूल्य रु0 590.00 G.S.T. Extra.

किसी भी विद्युत समस्या के लिए सम्पर्क करें टोल फ्रि न० 18004190405
"राष्ट्र हित में बिजली बचायें।"

अधिशासी अभियन्ता
विद्युत वितरण खण्ड (उत्तर)

DTC sends notices to 200 bus conductors for not working on Deepavali; warns of fines up to ₹1,000

Shrimansi Kaushik
NEW DELHI

Nearly 200 Delhi Transport Corporation (DTC) bus conductors were issued show-cause notices for being absent from duty on November 8, Deepavali. The notices warned of penalties of up to ₹1,000 for those who could not explain their absence. Depot managers issued notices to at least 102 conductors at the Rani Khera depot, 60 at the BBM depot and 37 at the Rohini Sector-37 depot.

When reached for comment, the DTC did not respond.

A senior official said, "The duty rosters are prepared in advance, and conductors have to inform their respective depot managers if they are unable to report for duty. If they remain absent on gazetted holidays, DTC counts those days as leave without pay."

"Show-cause notices are issued, and penalties are imposed if they fail to respond within 72 hours with an explanation. Buses ply every day, including holidays. If conductors do not report for duty, passenger services are affected, and they are responsible for this lack of professionalism," the official added.

Govt. of Jharkhand
Jharkhand Combined Entrance Competitive Examination Board
Science & Technology Campus, Sirkha Toli, Namkum-Tupudana Road, Namkum, Ranchi – 834010.Website : https://jceceb.jharkhand.gov.in
e-mail : jceceboard@gmail.com
Advt. No. :–JCECEB/65 /26 - 124 Ranchi/Dated: 13/11/2026

Notice regarding 1st Round of Online Counselling for NEET (PG)-2026 All India & NRI Quota Seats of Laxmi Chandravansi Medical College & Hospital, Bishrampur, Palamu and Netaji Subhas Medical College and Hospital, Adityapur, Seraikela-Kharsawan on the basis of NEET PG-2026 Result

Online Application Forms are invited from qualified eligible candidates of NEET PG-2026 examination for the preparation of all India merit list for admission in All India & NRI quota Post Graduate Medical Seats of Laxmi Chandravansi Medical College & Hospital, Bishrampur, Palamu and Netaji Subhas Medical College and Hospital, Adityapur, Seraikela-Kharsawan.

The Candidates claiming for admission under the NRI Quota seats, will have to fill in a separate format and produce concerned original certificates/documents at the time of admission.

Educational Criteria:-
a) The Candidates who have passed the MBBS degree course from a university or college approved by the National Medical Council (NMC), New Delhi.
b) The candidate must have completed the Rotating Internship by 30 Sep, 2026.

2. Interested candidates are requested to fill the **Application Form Online** on Board's website **http://jceceb.jharkhand.gov.in** by Clicking on "Click here for All Online Application Submission –JCECEB 2026" tab by following the given directions as per the schedule given below :-

Schedule for 1st Round of Online Counselling for NEET (PG) - 2026 Course

Sl. No.	Activity	Schedule Date
1.	Online Application Form filling & Certificates/Documents Uploading	**16.11.2026 to 19.11.2026**
2.	Publication of Provisional State Merit List for 1st Round of Online Counselling	**20.11.2026**
3.	Online Registration & Choice Filling for Seat Allotment	**20.11.2026 to 23.11.2026**
4.	Issue of Provisional Seat Allotment Letter	**25.11.2026**
5.	Certificates /Documents verification and admission in the concerned Institute	**25.11.2026 30.11.2026**

3. **Counselling will be held as per the guidelines issued by MCC/NMC New Delhi. In case of any change in guidelines, counselling dates as well as other terms & conditions will be notified accordingly.**
4. **It is mandatory for the candidate to upload Score Card of NEET (PG) -2026.**
5. **Applicable Fees**:– Applicants have to pay Application/Registration, Counselling Fee and Security Deposit through Payment Gateway by Credit Card/Debit Card/Net Banking as given below:-

(a) Application/Registration Fee :-

Sl. No.	Category	Rate
1.	All Indian candidates	` 1000/–
2.	SC / ST / Female candidates of jharkhand state	` 500/–
3.	Divyang candidate	–

(b) Counselling Fee:-

Sl. No.	Category	Rate
1.	All Indian candidates	` 2000/–
2.	SC / ST / Female candidates of jharkhand state	` 1200/–

(c) Security Deposit:-

Sl. No.	Institution	Security Deposit
1.	GOVERNMENT	30,000/- (UR/EWS) 15,000/- (ST/SC/OBC/PWD)
2.	Private	Medical College-2 Lac Dental College-1 Lac
3.	Both (Government/Private)	Medical College-2 Lac Dental College-1 Lac
4.	Stray/Mop-up	50,000/-

6. (a) Security Money will be forfeited if admission is not taken after seat allotment in Second Round and next Round of Counselling. Apart from this, Security Money will not be returned even in case of cancellation of admission in case of giving wrong information by the candidate at the time of registration and not presenting the required original certificates at the time of admission.
(b) The Security Money will be refunded if the candidates have taken valid admission and no seat is allotted after any stage of Counselling.
(c) Security Money deposited by the candidates at the time of counselling, will be refunded to the candidate and/or the institute within three months after the end of last round of online counselling.

By the order of Controller of Examination,
Sd/-
Officer on Special Duty

PR 393869 Jharkhand Combined Entrance Competitive Examination Board(26-27)D

DU student barred for 3 yrs. for attack on professor

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Delhi University on Friday cancelled the PhD registration of a student, Shubham Singh, over allegations that he assaulted a professor at Law Centre-II, Anupam Jha, on August 17. Mr. Singh has also been barred from the campus and from appearing for exams for three years, as per Proctor Manoj Kumar Singh's order.

Timings
DELHI

SATURDAY, NOV. 14
RISE 06:43 SET 17:28
RISE 11:01 SET 21:22

SUNDAY, NOV. 15
RISE 06:43 SET 17:28
RISE 11:42 SET 22:18

MONDAY, NOV. 16
RISE 06:44 SET 17:28
RISE 12:17 SET 23:15

Delhi Weather	max	min
Delhi City	31	16
Safdarjang	31	16
Palam	28	16

Delhi Palam Today
28°C Shallow fog and mist in cool morning. Day will be comfortable. Night will be cool. Weather will be dry with severe pollution level.

Delhi Palam Tomorrow
28°C The dry weather to continue. Night will be cool & hazy. Fall in night temperature. Pollution level will be severe. Day will be comfortable.

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THE HINDU
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PM Modi flags off new Metro line in Bengaluru; CM seeks more funds

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU


Prime Minister Narendra Modi flagging off the Namma Metro Pink Line stretch with Chief Minister D.K. Shivakumar on Friday. ANI

Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Friday flagged off the much-anticipated elevated section of the Pink Line of Namma Metro, a 7.5-km stretch between Kalena Agrahara and Suddagunte Palya in Bengaluru, on Friday.

With this stretch becoming operational, Bengaluru became the second city after Delhi-NCR to cross the 100-km mark in its Metro network. However, Bengaluru has an operational network of 103.6 km, compared with Delhi-NCR's 416 km.

Namma Metro, which had a network of just 17 km in 2014, had expanded to more than 100 km, the Prime Minister said.

Chief Minister D.K. Shivakumar set a more ambitious target of 500 km of metro network, which he said "could help address nearly 50% of the city's traffic congestion". Mr. Shivakumar appealed for more financial contribution and expediting clearances for Namma Metro projects by the Union government. Mr. Shivakumar said that Karnataka was bearing more than 80% of the financial burden of metro projects despite the 50:50 Centre-State partnership.

However, Mr. Modi did not respond to the demands on the stage.

Highlighting delays in project approvals, the Chief Minister sought urgent clearance for the proposed metro Red Line (Phase 3A), pending for nearly two years.

Mr. Modi said the Pink Line will improve connectivity to several key education institutes such as the Indian Institute of Management, Bangalore as well as major business, technology and commercial centres. He also inaugurated or laid foundation stones for various projects worth over ₹15,600 crore.

APPOINTMENT

KBNU
KHAJA BANDANAWAZ UNIVERSITY
EDUCATING HUMANITY
KALABURAGI, KARNATAKA.

RECRUITMENT NOTIFICATION
No. 07/2026 Date: 07-11-2026

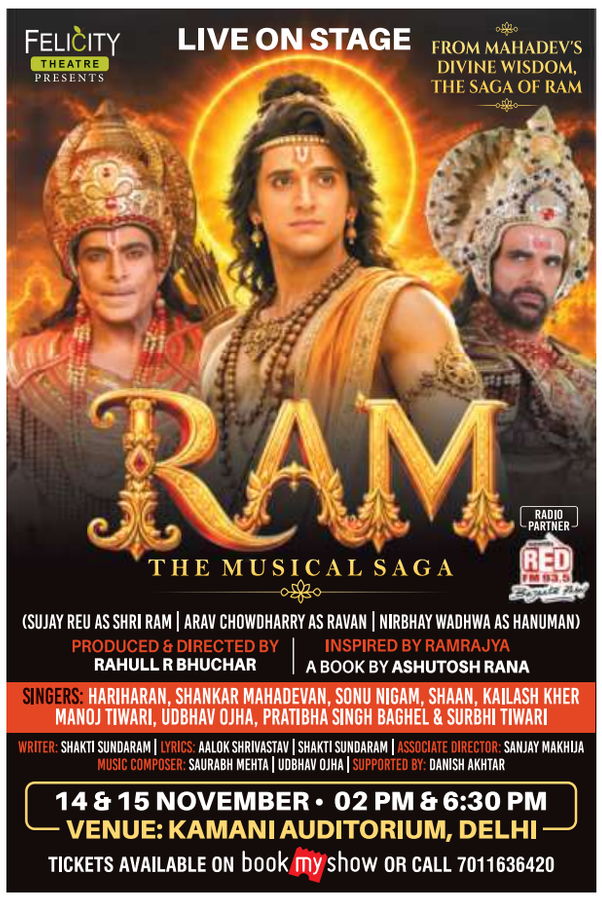
The Khaja Bandanawaz University is a private University established by an Act of the State Legislature of Karnataka in 2018. The University invites applications from eligible citizens of India for the following teaching and non-teaching positions under the **Faculty of Medical Sciences.**

Teaching Positions:
Professor, Associate Professor, Assistant Professor & Senior Resident under following Departments;

- Anatomy
- Physiology
- Biochemistry
- Microbiology
- Forensic Medicine & Toxicoloqy
- Community Medicine
- Pharmacology
- General Surgery
- Psychiatry
- Pathology
- General Medicine
- Dermatology
- Orthopaedics
- Anaesthesiology
- Radio-Diagnosis

Non-Teaching Position:
- Clinical Psychologist

Interested candidates may apply by visiting our official website or scanning the QR code provided.
The last date to submit the online application is 22nd Nov, 2026.
For further details/updates please visit
www.kbn.university
Sd/-
Registrar



ONE MORE CHANCE
HARYANA SIR 2026

Your name missing from the Draft Electoral Roll?

If you were marked Absent, Shifted, Dead or Duplicate (ASDD), you can still get your name included in the Final Electoral Roll.

1 Check the list
ASDD lists shall be displayed afresh at Polling Stations, Panchayat Bhawans, ULB & BDO offices and on the CEO Haryana website.

2 Get your form
Your BLO will deliver your enumeration form either physically or by WhatsApp / SMS / e-mail. Or you can download and fill it on the website or the ECINET App by entering the same EPIC number that existed before your name was deleted.

3 Submit to your ERO / AERO / BLO

AT SAME ADDRESS
Enumeration Form + Annexure-B
Mention reason why you couldn't submit enumeration form earlier. Submit yourself, through family, or online on ECINET with e-sign.

SHIFTED WITHIN HARYANA
Enumeration Form + Annexure-C
Submit to the ERO / AERO of the Assembly Constituency where you have shifted. No Form-8 needed.

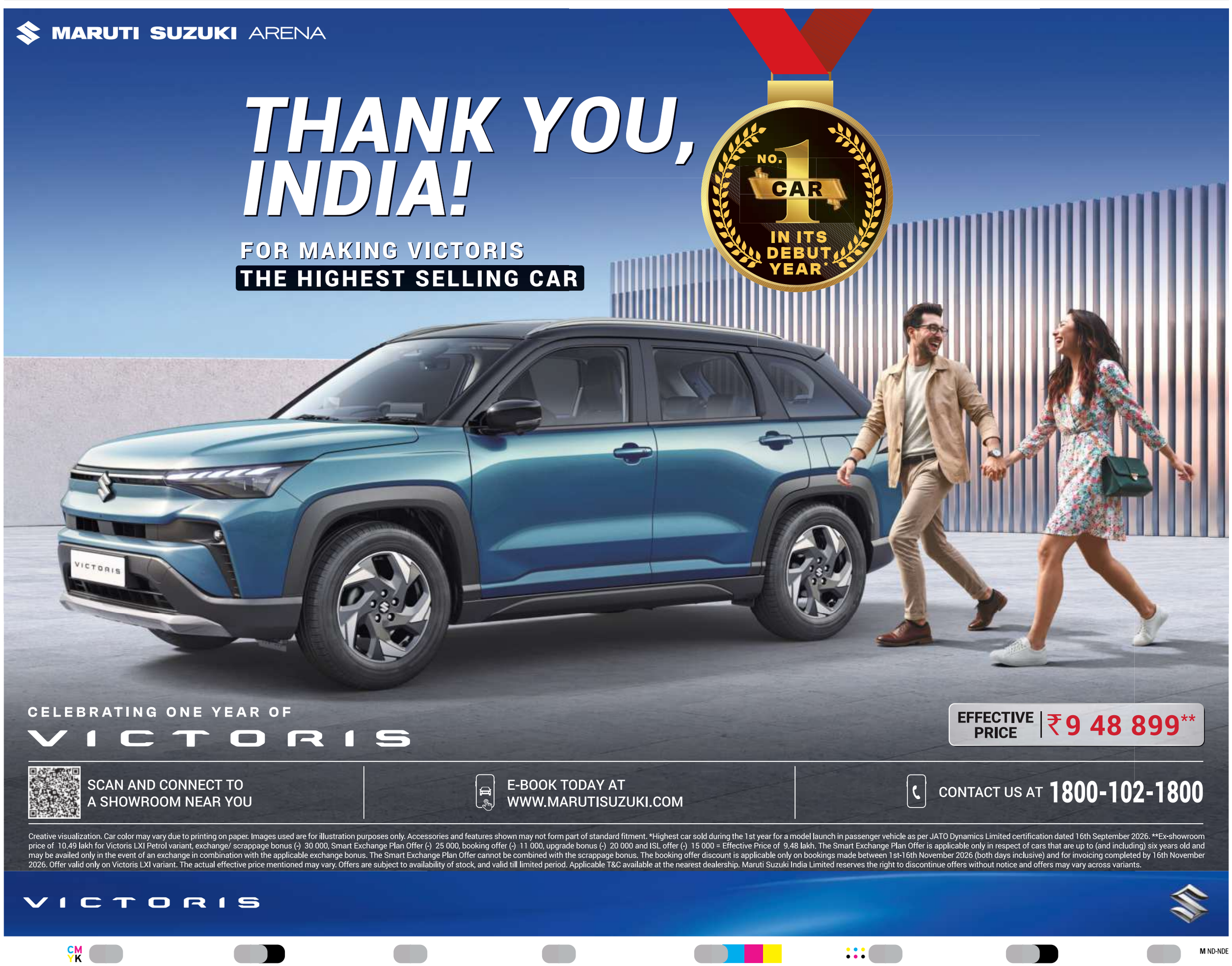
ALREADY SUBMITTED FORM-6
No need to apply again
Your Form-6 submitted during SIR will be processed.

✓ **Same EPIC number** that was assigned to you prior to SIR shall be re-assigned once your enumeration form is accepted.

⌂ **Homeless**? The BLO's field verification will be accepted as residence proof.

NEED HELP?
Voter Helpline 1950 • "Book a call with BLO" on ECINET App
Website ceoharyana.gov.in Facebook /ceoharyana Instagram @ceo.haryana
X @ceoharyana YouTube @ceo.haryana

2270/13/26/2027/50992/199/7



INBRIEF



Former Goa CM Parsekar returns to BJP after 4 years

Former Goa Chief Minister Laxmikant Parsekar, who had quit the BJP in 2022, rejoined the ruling party on Friday in the presence of senior leaders. The development came ahead of the Assembly election, which is due before March next year. State BJP president Damodar Naik, Chief Minister Pramod Sawant and other BJP leaders were present during Mr. Parsekar's reinduction. Speaking to reporters, the former Chief Minister said he had been working for the BJP for most of his life, and had continued to work for the party even after leaving it. His formal return to the party fold made many people happy, he added. PTI

Six vehicle pile-up on Mumbai Coastal Road tunnel; none hurt

Six vehicles were involved in a chain-reaction accident inside the northbound tunnel of the Mumbai Coastal Road in the early hours of Friday, with one of the vehicles catching fire following the collision. No injuries or casualties were reported, officials said. The accident occurred around 2:33 a.m. between CP 9 and CP 10 in the Coastal Road tunnel, within the jurisdiction of the Marine Drive Traffic Division. According to officials, the accident initially involved a collision between two cars, following which a trailing vehicle rammed into the stationary cars, triggering a chain-reaction crash involving six vehicles.

Owaisi-Azad U.P. alliance won't impact INDIA bloc prospects, say SP, Cong.

Akhilesh Yadav says he would continue with his existing partners, asks newly forged alliance to prove its worth; people expect BJP to divide votes, are aware of end game of such fronts: Cong.

Mayank Kumar
LUCKNOW



We, the Samajwadis, will unite to take on the BJP, said SP president and former U.P. CM Akhilesh Yadav at a press briefing on Friday. ANI

The Samajwadi Party (SP) and Congress on Friday said the alliance of Asaduddin Owaisi's All India Majlis-e-Ittehadul Muslimeen (AIMIM) and Chandrashekhar Azad's Azad Samaj Party (Kanshi Ram) will have no impact on voters from social groups facing injustice under the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) government in Uttar Pradesh. They added voters are aware that only the INDIA bloc, comprising the SP and Congress, is capable of defeating the BJP decisively.

SP chief Akhilesh Yadav said he would continue with his existing alliance partners and asked the newly forged front to prove its worth on the ground. "The election date will be announced before January 10. We are moving forward in collaboration with our previous alliance partners. In fact, I would suggest that they [Mr. Owaisi and Mr. Azad] establish a permanent presence here; it would foster better coordination and facilitate ongoing dialogue," he told reporters here at the party headquarters. "We, the Samajwadis, will unite to take on the BJP, work to remove it from power, and ensure it is removed once and for all," he added.

"Even before the announcement of the AIMIM-ASP (KR) alliance, people were expecting that the BJP will try to divide the votes of Dalits, Muslims, backwards and progressive sections of society. But we believe people are fully aware of the real end game of any such front. People across sections of the society are fully behind the INDIA bloc and are waiting for the Assembly poll to defeat the anti-people BJP government," said Congress national secretary Shahnawaz Alam.

'Voters cautious'

The SP said Dalits and Muslims at the ground level remain cautious about this 'sudden' alliance. "The AIMIM and ASP (KR) have formed the Samajik Parivartan Morcha (Front for Social Change) to attract anti-incumbency votes from the BJP government, primarily among Scheduled Castes and Muslims. The Samajwadi Party welcomes any effort to expose communal forces that use false promises to attract voters, particularly Dalits. While the front might shift 2-3% of the vote away from the BJP – potentially benefiting the INDIA bloc – Dalits and Muslims at the ground level remain cautious about the intent and viability of this sudden, unnatural alliance. Ultimately, this arrangement is unlikely to alter the election prospects of the INDIA bloc," said senior SP leader Sudhir Panwar.

On Thursday, Mr. Owaisi and Mr. Azad announced an alliance for the 2027 Assembly election, the first declared non-National Democratic Alliance, non-INDIA bloc political front in Uttar Pradesh ahead of the poll, with both parties – considered marginal players – looking to consolidate Scheduled Caste and minority voters in the politically crucial State.

'115 Bharat Summit speakers denied entry into India'

R. Ravikanth Reddy
HYDERABAD



Shashi Tharoor

Senior Congress leader and MP Shashi Tharoor has alleged that 115 of the 315 speakers invited to the second edition of the Bharat Summit in Hyderabad were denied entry into India or had their visas cancelled, "apparently on the instructions of the Union Ministry of Home Affairs".

Mr. Tharoor, who is in Hyderabad for the Bharat Summit, in a post on social media platforms, questioned the legal basis for the action. He pointed out that the summit would conclude on Saturday, making it impossible to reverse the decision in time for the affected participants to attend. "What a shame that a proud democracy has become so insecure that it must stifle any voices it fears will be critical!" he wrote.

Earlier, Congress MP Chamala Kiran Kumar Reddy had also said that nearly 30% of the invitees could not travel to India because of visa-related issues.

When the Ministry of External Affairs was asked about Mr. Tharoor's tweet on visa rejection, MEA spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said: "Visa matters are sovereign functions of any country or any government."

CM slams BJP

Telangana Chief Minister A. Revanth Reddy has questioned the BJP's criticism of Congress leader Rahul Gandhi's participation in the Bharat Summit, wondering why the party was "spewing venom" against the Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha when he was coming to participate in discussions on important issues. Mr. Gandhi is scheduled to participate in the valedictory session on Saturday.

Addressing a press conference in Hyderabad, Mr. Reddy said the BJP should welcome Mr. Gandhi in a democratic spirit and use the international platform to share its views rather than oppose his participation or blindly brand him as anti-national.

Special summary draft roll published in Uttarakhand, 1.2 lakh more names than SIR list

Press Trust of India
DEHRADUN

The draft electoral roll under the special summary revision (SSR) under way in Uttarakhand recorded about 72.8 lakh voters, nearly 1.2 lakh more than the 71.6 lakh listed in the final SIR published last month.

Officials said that during the SSR drive, 1,25,216 names were added to the electoral roll under the SSR, while 6,130 applications (Form 7) for the deletion of names were processed and resolved. The draft electoral roll for the State was published on Thursday.

An SSR of the electoral roll was carried out in the State from October 4 to October 31 under the directives of the Election Commission of India (ECI), Additional Chief Electoral Officer (CEO) Vijay Kumar Jogdande said at a press conference on Friday. The final SIR roll was published on October 3.

SSR of electoral roll was carried out in the State from Oct. 4 to 31 under the directives of the ECI

The SSR draft electoral roll of the State includes 72,78,035 voters - 34,84,447 women, 37,93,373 men, and 215 third-gender voters.

The Additional CEO further informed that the draft electoral roll for Uttarakhand can be viewed online on the ECI website and the Chief Electoral Officer's office website.

The roll can also be accessed through the offices of the District Election Officer or Electoral Registration Officer or via the Booth Level Officers.

Following the publication of the draft electoral roll, a meeting was held on Friday, chaired by Chief Electoral Officer B.V.R.C. Purushottam, with representatives from recognised national political parties.

Cooperation sought

During the meeting, the CEO provided the parties with a soft copy of the draft electoral roll. He also appealed to all political parties for their cooperation in the SSR drive.

Mr. Jogdande explained that following the publication of the draft electoral roll, individuals who will attain the age of 18 by January 1, 2027, or those who could not be included in the electoral roll for any reason, may submit an application by filling out Form 6.

Controversial ex-HC judge C.S. Karnan passes away

Mohamed Imranullah S.
CHENNAI



C.S. Karnan

Justice C.S. Karnan, a controversial former judge of the Madras High Court, who was sentenced to six months in prison in contempt proceedings initiated by the Supreme Court during his stint as a judge of the Calcutta High Court in 2017, and was jailed once again in 2020 following his retirement, died in Chennai on Friday. He was 71.

A native of Karnatham village in Cuddalore district, Karnan was born on June 12, 1955. He got enrolled as an advocate with the Bar Council of Tamil Nadu and Puducherry on April 11, 1984, and practised in the Madras High Court, City Civil Courts and Family Courts, handling civil, criminal, constitutional and service matters.

He was elevated as a judge of the Madras High Court in 2009, pursuant to a recommendation made by the High Court collegium comprising then Chief Justice A.K. Ganguly and Justices S.J. Mukhopadhaya and P.K. Misra, and accepted by the Supreme Court collegium comprising then Chief Justice of India K.G. Balakrishnan and Justices B.N. Agrawal and Arijit Pasayat, the next two senior judges of the top court.

During his stint as a Madras High Court judge, Karnan had accused the other judges of ill-treating him because he belonged to a Scheduled Caste. He also had confrontations, sometimes in open court, with former Supreme Court judges R.K. Agrawal and Sanjay Kishan Kaul over recommendation of names to be elevated as judges of the High Court, and alleged discrimination against Scheduled Caste lawyers.

Karnan was transferred to the Calcutta High Court on March 10, 2016. In February 2017, a seven-judge Bench of the Supreme Court led by then Chief Justice of India (CJI) J.S. Khehar initiated *suo motu* contempt proceedings against him for levelling baseless charges against other judges, and also restrained him from performing judicial as well as administrative work as a judge of the High Court.

On May 1, 2017, the Supreme Court directed the West Bengal government to constitute a board of doctors from Pavlov Government Hospital in Calcutta to examine Karnan and report whether he was in a fit condition to defend himself. However, Karnan declined to be medically examined and gave a written declaration on May 4, 2017, that he was normal and had a stable mind.

On May 8, 2017, he passed an "order" sentencing the then CJI and seven other judges of the Supreme Court to five years of rigorous imprisonment, and also imposed a fine of ₹1 lakh each under the SC/ST (Prevention of Atrocities) Act of 1989. He directed the Commissioner of Police, New Delhi, to execute his "order" and granted liberty to the eight judges to approach Parliament.

A day later, the seven-judge bench of the Supreme Court found Karnan guilty of criminal contempt and sentenced him to six months' imprisonment after observing that his conduct towards a large number of judges and the judiciary in general had tarnished the image of the judges concerned as well as the judiciary.

However, the West Bengal police could not execute the Supreme Court order since Karnan absconded and attained superannuation on June 12, 2017. After an intensive search, the police arrested him in Coimbatore on June 20, 2017. Even after serving the sentence, Karnan continued to openly denounce judges with allegations of corruption and caste-based discrimination.

10 criminal cases

Around 10 criminal cases were registered against him for reportedly circulating 33 videos on social media abusing sitting as well as former judges, their spouses, lawyers, court staff and others using "vulgar, scandalous, vituperative and obscene" words. The tenth case was booked for allegedly trespassing into the residence of a former Supreme Court judge in Chennai and abusing her daughter and son-in-law.

Karnan was arrested again on December 2, 2020, and was granted bail by the Madras High Court on March 23, 2021, after he filed two affidavits tendering an unconditional apology to all concerned and undertook not to repeat such behaviour in future.

Sonia Gandhi's memoir revisits her Coorg ties and electoral debut from Ballari seat

Rishita Khanna
BENGALURU



Congress leader Sonia Gandhi's memoir, *Belonging,* displayed at a bookstore in New Delhi. AFP

An arecanut plantation in Karnataka was among the places that caught the interest of Sonia Gandhi's father, Stefano Maino, during his visits to India. Alongside a power project in Keralam and a factory in Maharashtra, it was one of the places he chose to see beyond the usual tourist circuit, writes Sonia Gandhi in her recently released memoir, *Belonging: A Journey of Love*.

Father's visits

From her father's visits to India and the memories of people who became part of her family life to the electoral contests in which she and her mother-in-law, Indira Gandhi, were involved, Karnataka finds mention in different parts of the memoir.

Another person from Karnataka who figures in Ms. Gandhi's memories was Amie Crishna, who hailed from Coorg and served as one of Indira Gandhi's personal secretaries.

Amie, Ms. Gandhi writes, would also tell her about Coorg, its people and their valour, and its food, including "curries made with the avocados that grew wild there".

The State also figures in the electoral journeys of both Indira Gandhi and Sonia Gandhi.

Sonia Gandhi recalls how the coffee-growing constituency of Chikkamagaluru gave her mother-in-law a route back to Parliament in November 1978, after her defeat in Rae Bareli in the 1977 Lok Sabha election in the aftermath of the Emergency.

Karnataka also became the setting for Sonia Gandhi's own electoral debut. In 1999, she contested the polls from both Amethi in Uttar Pradesh and Ballari in Karnataka.

On the campaign trail

The memoir also recounts how her daughter, Priyanka Gandhi, accompanied her when she filed her nominations in both constituencies and joined her on the campaign trail in Ballari.

MNS chief accuses BJP of inciting conflict in Maharashtra after Bhojpuri songs at stations

Press Trust of India
MUMBAI



MNS chief Raj Thackeray

Maharashtra Navnirman Sena (MNS) president Raj Thackeray on Friday accused the BJP of making desperate attempts to incite conflict in Mumbai, which has a sizeable North Indian population, and Maharashtra by exploiting the Chhath Puja issue ahead of the upcoming elections in Uttar Pradesh.

His remarks come two days after a controversy erupted over playing of Bhojpuri songs at some Mumbai railway stations ahead of the festival. The move drew criticism and raised questions over the use of railway announcement systems for cultural events.

The MNS chief said no attempts should be made to incite a "cultural frenzy" under the guise of religious worship to "plunder" Maharashtra and tarnish its cultural heritage. He said that the State's restraint should not be mistaken for cowardice.

"The Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) and the toxic social media ecosystem it nurtures are currently making desperate attempts to incite conflict in Mumbai, Maharashtra, by exploiting the issue of Chhath Puja," Mr. Thackeray said in a post on X. The BJP remains frustrated because the conflict it so desired has failed to materialise, he said.

'All for U.P. election'

"All this frantic manoeuvring is being orchestrated with an eye on the upcoming election in Uttar Pradesh," Mr. Thackeray said. The U.P. Assembly election ise expected to be held early next year.

He said the North Indian and Gujarati communities must also realise that the BJP is merely pitting them against locals to serve its selfish interests. "If the North Indian and Gujarati communities choose to join them and confront the Marathi manoos, then let them be advised: This is Maharashtra! This is the land of the Marathas!" he said.

Targeting the BJP, Mr. Thackeray said the saffron party's 'think tank' has suffered a decline in its intellectual capacity. The "divide and rule" tactic on which it relied for years to win elections is no longer effective, he said.

Whenever Lok Sabha election approach, the BJP stokes Hindu-Muslim tensions, parades women wearing burqas through public grounds and parks, aiming to frighten the public by suggesting that "the other" has now encroached upon their own spaces, Mr. Thackeray alleged.

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WORLD DIABETES DAY

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— A Patient Awareness Initiative —

Continuous Glucose Monitoring: Understanding the Trends

Continuous glucose monitoring uses a small sensor to measure glucose in fluid beneath the skin and display readings throughout the day. For some people, it reveals patterns occasional finger-prick tests may miss, including overnight changes and responses to meals or activity. A sensor reading may differ from blood glucose, especially when levels change quickly. Follow device instructions and confirm with a finger-prick test when advised or when symptoms do not match readings. Continuous monitoring is not necessary for everyone. Ask your healthcare professional whether it suits your treatment, needs, and budget. This can help guide individual decisions.



Dr. Ajay Agrawal
Endocrinologist

Can Diabetes Affect Hearing?



Dr. Mugdha Tapdiya
Diabetologist

Research has found an association between diabetes and hearing impairment, although the reasons are not fully understood. Changes affecting blood vessels and nerves may contribute, but hearing difficulties can have many other causes. People with diabetes should not assume that reduced hearing is an inevitable complication. If you struggle to follow conversations, frequently increase television volume, or experience persistent ringing in the ears, arrange a medical assessment. A hearing test can help identify the problem. Protecting hearing also includes avoiding excessive noise exposure. Discuss any new hearing changes with a healthcare professional rather than ignoring them.

Using Insulin Injections Correctly

Insulin works best when administered using the prescribed dose, device, and technique. Ask a healthcare professional to demonstrate injection steps and watch you within the lumps that can new needle as pens, syringes, changed. Check before each unexplained technique and team. Never without an agreed plan. Correct technique matters every day.



Dr. C. K. Parekh
Diabetologist

practise. Rotate injection sites recommended area to reduce affect insulin absorption. Use a instructed, and never share or needles, even if the needle is the insulin label and dose injection. If you notice highs or lows, discuss your injection sites with your care change your insulin dose

Store Insulin Safely



Dr. Pawan Goyal
Diabetologist

Insulin can lose effectiveness if stored incorrectly, so follow instructions for your specific product. Unopened insulin is refrigerated within the temperature range on its label; it must not be frozen or exposed to direct heat. In-use storage limits vary by formulation and brand, so check the package leaflet rather than assuming every insulin lasts the same number of days. During hot weather, use an appropriate cooling solution without placing insulin directly against ice. Do not use insulin that has been frozen, overheated, or looks different from its instructions. Ask a pharmacist if storage is uncertain.

Diabetes Remission Is Not the Same as a Cure



Dr. S. K. MUNDRA
Diabetologist

Some people with type 2 diabetes can achieve remission, meaning blood glucose remains below the diabetes range without glucose-lowering medicines for a sustained period. This may follow significant weight loss or metabolic surgery, but it is not guaranteed and does not mean diabetes is permanently cured. Glucose levels can rise again, so monitoring remains important. Do not stop medicines or attempt extreme diets without medical supervision. Discuss evidence-based options with your healthcare team, based on your health and circumstances.

Individualising Diabetes Care for Older Adults

Diabetes care in older adults should reflect health, daily function, personal priorities, and available support. A treatment plan that suits one person may be too complicated.or risky for another. Some medicines can cause low blood glucose, which may lead to falls, confusion, or injury. Tell your clinician about missed meals, memory difficulties, mobility changes, or problems managing medicines.



Dr. Vikramjeet Singh
Diabetologist

Do not reduce or stop treatment yourself; the care team can review whether adjustments are appropriate. Simple routines, clear instructions, and help from trusted caregivers can support safer care while respecting independence. Individualised plans can improve safety and daily wellbeing.

PCOS and the Risk of Type 2 Diabetes

Polycystic ovary syndrome, or PCOS, is a hormonal condition that can affect menstrual cycles, skin, and fertility. It is associated with insulin resistance and a risk of type 2 diabetes. Not everyone with PCOS develops diabetes, and symptoms alone cannot establish blood glucose status. A healthcare professional may recommend glucose testing based on risk and clinical guidance. Regular activity, balanced meals, adequate sleep, and weight-management support when appropriate can improve metabolic health. If you have PCOS, ask your clinician how often screening is needed and which prevention steps suit you.



Dr. M. S. Mahar
Diabetologist

Plan Ahead When Travelling With Diabetes



Dr. Alex Mathew
Diabetologist

Travel is easier when diabetes supplies and routines are planned in advance. Carry medicines, glucose-monitoring equipment, and fast-acting carbohydrate in hand luggage, with extra supplies in case of delays. Keep medicines in their original labelled packaging and check storage requirements, particularly for insulin. Long journeys, time-zone changes, altered meals, and increased activity can affect glucose levels. Ask your healthcare team how to adjust medication timing and monitoring before departure; do not improvise dose changes. Keep medical identification and emergency contacts accessible. If flying, check airline rules for carrying supplies. A written plan helps you travel with greater confidence and safety.

Planning Pregnancy When You Have Diabetes

People with diabetes planning pregnancy can benefit from a preconception consultation. Blood glucose management before conception helps reduce risks for the pregnant person and baby. A clinician can review medicines, blood pressure, kidney and eye health, and whether folic acid is recommended. Some medicines are unsuitable during pregnancy and may need changing beforehand under medical supervision. Do not stop treatment abruptly or wait until pregnancy is confirmed to seek advice. With early planning and coordinated care, many people with diabetes have healthy pregnancies. Recommendations depend on medical history and clinical guidance. Discuss plans before trying to conceive.



Dr. Lalit Mohan Kaushik
Diabetologist

Understanding Diabetes-Related Nerve Damage

Diabetic neuropathy refers to nerve damage associated with diabetes. It commonly affects the feet and legs, causing tingling, burning, numbness, or pain, but other nerves can also be involved. Symptoms may develop gradually, and some people have nerve damage without obvious discomfort. Report new sensations, weakness, balance problems, or changes in digestion or bladder function to your healthcare professional. Examination can help identify nerve problems and exclude other causes. Maintaining appropriate glucose levels and managing other cardiovascular risk factors may reduce the risk of progression. Early recognition helps guide treatment, protect affected areas, and address symptoms.



Dr. Vineet Jain
Diabetologist

Diabetes and Skin Health

Skin problems can occur in people with diabetes, particularly when glucose levels remain elevated. Dryness, itching, fungal infections, and bacterial infections may develop, although these symptoms can also have other causes. Keep skin clean, moisturise dry areas, and dry skin folds carefully. Avoid scratching persistent rashes or using unprescribed steroid creams without medical advice. Seek prompt assessment for spreading redness, warmth, pain, pus, fever, or wounds that do not heal. Good glucose management may help reduce some skin-related risks. Persistent or recurring skin changes deserve proper evaluation rather than being dismissed as minor irritation.



Dr. Atul Arora
Diabetologist

Diabetes and the Importance of Healthy Bones

Bone health deserves attention in diabetes care. People with diabetes, particularly those with long-standing disease or certain complications, may face an increased risk of fractures. In type 2 diabetes, bone density can appear normal despite changes in bone strength. Adequate calcium and vitamin D intake, weight-bearing activity suited to individual ability, and avoiding tobacco can support skeletal health. Older adults should also discuss falls risk and medicines with their healthcare team. Supplements are not necessary for everyone and should be based on individual needs. Ask your clinician whether bone health assessment is appropriate for you.



Dr. Vipul Mohan
Diabetologist

Diabetes and Sexual Health Deserve Attention



Dr. D. N. Jha
Diabetologist

Diabetes can affect sexual health, but these concerns are difficult to discuss. In some people, nerve damage, blood vessel changes, hormonal factors, or medicines may contribute to erectile difficulties, reduced sexual response, or vaginal dryness. High glucose can also increase susceptibility to infections. These problems deserve respectful medical attention and are not a personal failure. Tell your healthcare professional what has changed; assessment may identify treatable causes or support. Do not start supplements or prescription treatments without advice, especially if you take other medicines. Open conversations can improve comfort and quality of life.

Understanding Diabetes and the Menstrual Cycle



Dr. Amit Chaudhary
Diabetologist

Hormonal changes during the menstrual cycle can affect blood glucose levels in some people with diabetes. These changes vary between individuals and may be more noticeable in the days before menstruation. Recording glucose readings alongside menstrual dates can help identify recurring patterns. If levels regularly rise or fall, discuss the findings with your healthcare professional before changing treatment. People with diabetes who experience irregular periods should also seek assessment, as hormonal conditions may contribute. Menstrual changes do not affect everyone in the same way. Understanding individual patterns can support more informed decisions and personalised diabetes management.

Prepare for Diabetes Emergencies

An emergency plan helps people with diabetes and their families act quickly. Keep an updated medicine list, emergency contacts, and allergy information accessible. If you use insulin or medicines that can cause low blood glucose, learn warning signs and how your care plan recommends treating an episode. Family members or trusted companions should know when emergency help is needed and how to use prescribed glucagon, if applicable. Severe confusion, seizures, unconsciousness, or inability to swallow safely requires urgent assistance; do not give food or drink by mouth. Review the plan whenever treatment changes.



Dr. Ansuman Delbehera
Diabetologist

Managing Diabetes During the Working Day



Dr. M. Shamshad
Consultant Physician

A busy workday can disrupt meals, activity, glucose checks, and medicine schedules. Planning ahead makes diabetes management more practical. Keep supplies accessible, arrange a suitable place to check glucose or take medicines, and know how your care plan recommends responding to low blood sugar if your treatment can cause it. If shift work or unpredictable breaks affect your routine, discuss options with your healthcare team. Consider telling a trusted colleague what to do in an emergency, if comfortable. Diabetes should not be a reason for shame. Workplace support helps people manage their health and work safely.

This is patient awareness initiative by MSN labs. The views and opinions expressed here are based on the expertise of the doctors and is not endorsed by MSN labs. Reader's are advised to seek to necessary medical advised from a qualified medical practitioner

Brace for impact

High inflation due to external factors could soon exacerbate economic pain

India's much-hyped domestic economic resilience is set to be tested over the next few months as external factors start to impose inescapable pressures. A case in point is inflation. The latest data on retail inflation show that it crossed the Reserve Bank of India's 6% upper comfort limit in October 2026. According to economists, this is likely to continue through the third quarter of this financial year, which means at least two more months of high inflation. Agricultural shortfalls brought on by a patchy and deficient monsoon have meant that food inflation rose sharply to 8.5% in October 2026. Elevated fuel prices meant that inflation in the transport category also rose sharply. What is worse is that high inflation is spreading to almost every aspect of a household's day-to-day needs. In fact, the latest Consumer Price Index (CPI) data show that 10 of the 12 major categories saw inflation in October hitting their highest levels recorded in the new series of the index. So, things such as clothing, footwear, housing, furnishings, and services such as healthcare, education, communication, recreation, and restaurant and hospitality are not only getting more expensive, they are doing so at an accelerating rate. This would have been bad enough had wages been increasing in real terms. Yet, latest research by Data for India on the country's official wage statistics shows that, while nominal wages about doubled from 2012 to 2024, they actually fell 4% over the same period after adjusting for inflation. And this is sharper for high-skilled and high-earning workers. Lower wage earners saw marginal increases over this period. While this is of some comfort, it is the higher wage earners that drive consumption in an economy. Real wage contraction for them, which is likely to have worsened in 2026, will hit consumption levels and private investment.

Further, there is strong evidence to suggest that the official inflation metrics are not capturing the full extent of rising prices. Data on cash with the public and UPI transactions show the value of both have been growing in double digits over the last year and more, significantly outpacing nominal GDP growth. This either suggests that the informal economy is far larger than earlier thought or, more likely, that inflation is well above what the official figures are being able to capture. Unfortunately, there are no real magic-wand fixes to this situation. Inflation is largely beyond the government's control, and wage growth cannot happen overnight. The only way forward is to continue trying to spur sector-specific growth and warn people of the impending storm.

Critical ban

India needs to create an entire ecosystem for recycling of lithium-ion batteries

On November 10, the Directorate General of Foreign Trade banned the export of lithium-ion battery black mass by moving it from the "free" to the "prohibited" list of exports. Black mass is an intermediate product when spent batteries and factory scrap are shredded. It contains valuable lithium, nickel, cobalt, manganese and graphite. The Commerce Ministry says the ban will ensure feedstock for domestic refiners, lift their capacity utilisation and draw investment. While the recycling of lead-acid batteries end-to-end is an established ecosystem and formalised, too, lithium-ion battery recycling is an emerging segment with only a few dozen licensed operators but has much potential given the scale of use of such batteries in EVs. While the ban will redirect supply it will not automatically create a market and ecosystem. Just banning export without creating an entire ecosystem will only lead to dumping of lithium-ion batteries into landfills if the blackmass has no market. Blackmass production is a largely mechanical process but further downstream processing is more specialised chemical processing requiring larger investment and further policy support. If downstream units are online, their output can directly feed into indigenous lithium-ion battery manufacture.

India depends heavily on imports for critical minerals such as those used in battery inputs. Beyond working on supply aspects, the government must address the price gap to create a robust recycling market. Under the Battery Waste Management Rules, 2022, producers buy extended producer responsibility (EPR) certificates from recyclers but these are undervalued. Cheap certificates reward recycling on paper over investment in high-yield plants. A floor price that covers the full cost of recovery, with digital tracking, would fix that. Rare earths show how recycling remains a missed opportunity for India because of policy gaps. A smartphone can be up to 1% neodymium-iron-boron magnet by weight. That puts its rare earth content at about 3,000 parts per million, comparable to India's monazite beach sands. Extracting it takes less energy than mining. A magnet separated from the phone is about 30% rare earth. Magnets make up as much as 3% of a hard drive, but are usable only if they are removed before the drive is shredded for data destruction. Yet the e-waste rules do not require rare earth separation. Rare earths need a separate EPR category, too. Payment by weight cannot be applied for rare earth minerals.

To strengthen the Supreme Court, divide it

In 2016, three judges of the Supreme Court of India paused to ask a question about their own institution: had the apex court, established by the Constitution's framers to safeguard the Republic's foundational document, lost its way, drowning in ordinary appeals while its constitutional work withered? They framed 11 questions and referred it to a larger Bench. A decade later, the reference remains unheard. No emblem of the problem is sharper, nor any case for reform stronger: split the Supreme Court in two.

As 2025 drew to a close, the court carried 92,318 pending cases, its heaviest backlog ever and nearly 10,000 more than a year earlier. The caseload is growing at a pace that no reasonable enlargement of the Bench can outrun. The remedy is simple and not new: a lean Constitutional Court of about 11 judges in Delhi, hearing only constitutional cases and substantial questions of law, with four or five regional Courts of Appeal to handle the appeals that now flood the apex court. The idea is not to shrink the judiciary's reach but to sort its work, so that questions shaping the Republic are not decided in the same queue as those shaping a single case.

Consider how far the court has drifted. In the first half of the 1960s, its Constitution Benches decided an average of 134 cases a year; over the last decade, that has collapsed to fewer than 10. The docket, instead, has been swallowed by Special Leave Petitions, discretionary appeals under Article 136 that were intended to serve as a rare safety valve. By one count, they accounted for 84.6% of the court's admission docket in 2011. A tribunal designed to be the final word on the Constitution has turned itself into a general court of fourth appeal. It has admitted as much: in *Bihar Legal Support Society* (1986), a Constitution Bench under Chief Justice P.N. Bhagwati said it was never meant to be an ordinary court of appeal.



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Adding judges without sorting the work risks enlarging the same overburdened court. The task is not to move the same work faster, but to sort it

Beyond the backlog

The case for splitting the court is not merely that it is overcrowded. A two-tier structure would allow specialisation to achieve what an increase in judicial capacity alone cannot. A dedicated Constitutional Court, hearing a curated stream of cases, could sit in full Benches and deliver consistent, predictable rulings that settle questions once. Regional courts of appeal could specialise in the ordinary caseload and clear it far faster than an apex court. They would also bring the final tier of ordinary justice closer to the citizens who need it. Every large legal system has converged on this pyramid-shaped structure: a final court works best when it decides a few cases carefully, while the tiers below it handle many more quickly.

The 229th Law Commission Report (2009) laid out a full blueprint for a Constitution Bench in Delhi with four regional Cassation Benches. In 2023, a Parliamentary Standing Committee recommended regional Benches, which the Union Law Ministry has since accepted. The model is well tested in the very democracies India is compared to.

The U.S. Supreme Court sits atop 13 federal Courts of Appeals, deciding only a sliver of cases. South Africa runs a two-court system: a Constitutional Court in Johannesburg, and a separate Supreme Court of Appeal in Bloemfontein for everything else. Germany's Federal Constitutional Court in Karlsruhe hears constitutional matters alone, while specialised federal courts handle other areas of law.

And this is not only a matter of systems built that way from the start: countries have made the very change India now contemplates. Brazil is the closest recent parallel. Its Supreme Federal Tribunal once carried the same double burden as ours, guarding the Constitution while drowning in ordinary federal appeals. The 1988 Constitution created a separate Superior Tribunal of Justice to take over that appellate load.

Brazil, however, also offers a warning: the split alone did not ease the backlog, which declined only after the apex court was given the power to filter out cases it did not need to hear. The tool is familiar from the very courts India admires. The U.S. Supreme Court grants review to roughly one per cent of the 7,000 petitions it receives each year, a discretion held since 1925; Brazil's apex court, after a 2004 reform, hears a constitutional appeal only where the question carries a "general repercussion" beyond the parties. Without such a filter, a Constitutional Court would inherit, in miniature, the very congestion it was built to escape. And the route need not be treacherous: the 229th Report argued Article 130 may permit regional Benches without a constitutional amendment, meaning the first steps could be taken by the court itself, without waiting for Parliamentary approval.

The strongest objection must be stated at full strength, because it is why this reform has stalled for so long, and because it is held by those who know the institution best. The concern, voiced by successive Chief Justices, is that a divided Supreme Court may no longer be a single supreme one: separate the constitutional work from the appellate work, and the regional courts could come to be seen as lesser venues, with litigants pressing to reach the apex court in Delhi, until the authority that flows from having one final court is diffused. There is real force in this. An apex court's power lies partly in its indivisibility: it is the last word, with no higher forum to appeal to and no rival court to be played against it.

Restoring the court

But the concern mistakes the disease for the cure. A single court is only a single voice when it can speak with one, and ours cannot: it already sits in a dozen small Benches that often contradict each other, its constitutional work reduced to a handful of Constitution Benches a year.

The indivisibility being defended is a fiction; the court is already divided, not by design but by sheer volume, into scattered panels whose rulings no one can fully reconcile. Separation would rescue the constitutional core of one that has fractured on its own. When the Bench was expanded to 34 in 2019, pendency stood near 60,000; today it is close to 93,000. In 2025, the court disposed of 65,615 cases and still fell behind, as 75,410 fresh matters arrived. In 2026, Parliament raised the sanctioned strength again, to 38. Adding judges without sorting the work risks enlarging the same overburdened court. The task is not to move the same work faster, but to sort it.

The Supreme Court that gave us the basic structure doctrine, and once stood as the boldest constitutional court in the democratic world, now rarely sits in constitutional judgment at all. No outside hand has diminished it; it has been buried under its own docket. To leave it as it is, out of reverence for a unity that no longer exists, is to mistake sentiment for strength. Splitting the court would let it return to its pristine structure, while a new tier of regional appeals courts would finally give ordinary litigants the swift justice they are owed. That would not be its diminishment, but its restoration.

(With contributions from Anushka Kewlani of CUTS)

The challenge of holding the Quad together

Speaking to the media on the sidelines of the G20 Foreign Ministers' Meeting in Atlanta, the U.S. Secretary of State announced that the leaders of the four Quad countries – India, Australia, Japan and the U.S. – are expected to meet in Manila in November, on the sidelines of the ASEAN Summit. The announcement is significant as this would be the first summit-level meeting of the Quad leaders since Donald Trump began his second term as U.S. President. It would also be the first such summit attended by Japanese Prime Minister Sanae Takaichi since she assumed office. The last Quad Leaders' Summit was held in Wilmington in 2024, when Joe Biden was U.S. President and Fumio Kishida was Japan's Prime Minister.

While India was expected to host the subsequent Quad Leaders' Summit, the grouping underwent a period of intense strategic turbulence in 2025, on account of Washington's shifting geopolitical priorities and changing political dynamics in its bilateral relations with Quad members, especially India. However, this did not result in complete collapse of the grouping. Apart from the leader-level summit, the group has remained successful in continuing its operational synergies in its various initiatives. This was most evident in the elevation of the Quad's Indo-Pacific Maritime Domain Awareness initiative to the Indo-Pacific Maritime Surveillance Collaboration framework, launched in New Delhi in May 2026, following the Quad Foreign Ministers' Meeting.



Harsh V. Pant

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The big ticket question confronting the Quad, however, is how Donald Trump engages with the group and the broader Indo-Pacific geography

Keeping the Quad afloat

Additionally, the foreign ministers of the four Quad countries held multiple meetings across 2025 and 2026, a period characterised as the nadir of the group's political alignment. In 2025, the foreign ministers met twice in Washington, with the first meeting marking Marco Rubio's first engagement as U.S. Secretary of State. In 2026, they met three times, in New Delhi, Manila, and Atlanta. A natural priority area for the agenda of these meetings was to schedule a leader-level summit for the group. For a grouping of this nature, which has neither a permanent bureaucracy nor an institutional framework of its own, such summits serve as crucial platforms to reaffirm its shared purpose and chart its agenda for the months ahead.

The big ticket question confronting the Quad, however, is how President Trump engages with the group and the broader Indo-Pacific geography. This, in many ways, is going to be the first occasion where Mr. Trump could articulate his vision and outlook towards the region for the remainder of this term. It was during his first tenure in the White House that the Quad was revived in 2017, and the Quad bolstered its approach towards the Indo-Pacific by renaming the U.S. Pacific Command to U.S. Indo-Pacific Command. However, since beginning his second term, Mr. Trump's priorities have been dictated by the ongoing Russia-Ukraine war, Washington's approach towards the transatlantic relationship and NATO, and the war in West Asia. Although the U.S. has not publicly expressed disinterest in the Indo-Pacific, regional partners have remained cautious about the possibility of a fundamental shift in Washington's engagement with the region.

President Trump's insistence that the U.S. expects its partners to enhance burden-sharing within the transatlantic security architecture it is invested in has also caused concern in the Indo-Pacific. The U.S. continues to remain a significant security actor in the region, especially in the Pacific, with several like-minded countries embedded in the U.S.-led security architecture. Furthermore, the White House's decision to review AUKUS has heightened concern and uncertainty among other players in the Indo-Pacific. This has prompted various countries to undertake measures to diversify their security policies. For example, Japan, through its One Cooperative Effort Among Nations (OCEAN) framework, has sought to increasingly reshape its post-war security posture by deepening strategic alignment with partner countries. Australia has made efforts to strengthen defence partnerships with India, Japan, Southeast Asian countries, and Pacific Island countries to deter China's growing footprint in the region. India continues to pursue a policy of multi-alignment and diversification of defence and strategic ties with like-minded countries in the Indian Ocean and the wider Indo-Pacific.

The recent meeting between the Defence Ministers of JAI (Japan-Australia-India) in Cebu also signals a willingness among these countries to further deepen their partnership notwithstanding the nature and character of Washington's role in the region. New entrants in the Indo-Pacific strategic landscape, such as France, have also sought to bolster ties with regional countries to sustain a balanced security environment in the region. Even though Mr. Trump's actions have spurred a rethink on the changing security order in the Indo-Pacific among regional partners, Washington's role remains critical, especially in the face of a worsening maritime security environment prompted by continued expansion of China's footprint. Washington's role in safeguarding the Taiwan Strait, a critical flashpoint in the Indo-Pacific strategic geography, remains significant.

A strategic message from Manila

While questions remain about the nature and character of U.S. involvement in the Indo-Pacific, at least for the remainder of President Trump's tenure in White House, the announcement of the imminent leader-level summit of the Quad appears to have breathed new life into the group. Even though India was expected to host the next leader-level summit following the previous meeting in Wilmington in 2024, the Philippines' hosting of the summit also reinforces one of the group's foundational strategic pillars – ASEAN centrality. Arguably, the Philippines remains at the front and centre of Chinese misadventures in the Indo-Pacific, with ongoing tussles over sovereignty issues between Manila and Beijing.

Following the Quad's track record at previous leader-level summits, its leaders are expected to reiterate the importance of respecting sovereignty in the South and East China Seas and condemn attempts by powers to disregard international law in the region. Delivering such a message from Manila would carry the weight of strategic symbolism. For Mr. Trump, the objectives of this Indo-Pacific visit should be dictated by two priorities: resetting American posture in the region and helping assert the Quad's commitment against Chinese belligerence from Manila.

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Safeguarding voting rights

Universal adult franchise is the bedrock of Indian democracy, yet hasty digitisation risks turning software into an instrument of exclusion. Whether imposing arbitrary deadlines in Delhi or leaving over half a crore voters "under adjudication" in West Bengal, disregarding technological readiness risks undermining citizens' fundamental voting rights. Electoral governance demands methodical testing, not rushed rollouts.

Vinay Sivakumar
Hyderabad

Burden of inflation

Untamed inflation is a grave concern for the wage-earning class. For more than a decade, the wages for a major section have not been revised upward, forcing them to keep tightening their belts further. In a number of States, wage boards have either not been formed or are not functioning. Normally, government figures fail to reflect the actual reality on the ground. Now, even the official figures show rising inflation. Appropriate government intervention is inevitable to stabilise prices and rescue wage earners from serious plight.

A.G. Rajmohan
Andhra Pradesh

Restoring stability

The recent killings of security personnel and attacks on security installations underline the disturbing reality that militancy continues to raise its ugly head in J&K. Despite sustained counter-terrorism operations and claims of improved security, militant groups retain the ability to strike and disrupt normalcy. The government cannot afford complacency or treat isolated successes as evidence of lasting peace. Alongside firm security measures, winning public confidence and dismantling militant support networks remain essential to restoring stability in the region.

Gregory Fernandes
Mumbai

Letters emailed to letters@thehindu.co.in must carry the postal address.



ILLUSTRATION: SREEJITH R. KUMAR

When boys' voices break

Child sexual abuse of boys often goes unreported as fear, shame, and social stigma keep children and their families silent. **Abhinay Deshpande** reports from Telangana on how families struggle to help their children recover and seek justice, which is often delayed

Trigger warning: The following article talks about child sexual abuse.
Disclaimer: The Hindu did not interview the children subjected to sexual abuse to avoid causing further distress or making them relive their experiences. Their parents were interviewed separately.

On September 23, Hrishkesh*, a 15-year-old, was on his way to tuition class after school, when a person who lived in the same locality stopped him a few metres from his house in Hyderabad. The person asked him to come into the house to help with something. When he refused, he was allegedly dragged inside and locked in. A dog was then let loose to prevent him from escaping.

What happened inside was something the boy would initially struggle to describe to his father. "The person threatened him, removed his clothes and sexually assaulted him. My son is well-built and around 5.5 feet tall. But he was so frightened by the threats that he could not fight back," says his father, who works in a privately run company.



Hrishkesh eventually managed to escape and reach his tuition centre. From there, he called his father, Mohan*, crying, and asked if he could return home.

"I could make out from his voice that something was terribly wrong. I rushed home, but he wouldn't tell me anything. He took a shower and sat quietly. I kept asking him what had happened, but he wouldn't respond," Mohan recalls.

Mohan, a single parent, was worried by his son's silence. When repeated attempts to get him to speak failed, he called Hrishkesh's aunt, hoping the boy would be more comfortable talking to her.

"I thought perhaps he was finding it difficult to tell me something, so I asked my sister to speak to him. When she told me that my son had been sexually assaulted, I was shocked. We had never heard of something like this happening to a boy, especially a 15-year-old," he says, struggling to hold back his emotions.

Mohan was shaken, but he knew he could not let his son see this. The boy, he says, kept repeating that something "bad" had happened to him. "He also told us that the person had tried to influence him by saying he would pass Class 10 with flying colours because he had their blessings," Mohan says, of the trans woman, who had allegedly assaulted his son.

Once Hrishkesh had calmed down, Mohan asked whether he wanted to go to the police. "I didn't want to force him into anything. I asked if he was ready to tell the police what had happened, and he agreed. I was relieved that he had the courage to speak up. We also felt that unless we reported it, another boy in the locality could become a victim," he says.

> Sexual abuse of boys may remain undisclosed because of shame, fear of ridicule, concerns about masculinity, family reputation and reluctance to acknowledge that boys can also be victims of sexual violence
>
> **CHARU SINHA**
> Director General of Police (WSW), Telangana

Data shared by the Women Safety Wing (WSW) of the Telangana Police show that 127 boys were recorded as victims under the Protection of Children from Sexual Offences (POCSO) Act, 2012, between January 2024 and September 2026 in the State.

The number rose from four in 2024 to 61 in 2025. In the first nine months of 2026 alone, 62 boys were recorded as victims. Hrishkesh was one of them.

The rise in recorded cases does not necessarily mean that more boys are being sexually assaulted. It could also mean that more children and their families are willing to report abuse.

Across Telangana, and elsewhere in the country, child sexual abuse of boys often remains hidden. Some families are reluctant to report such incidents because of shame, the fear of how society would react, and a concern for their child's reputation. Some boys are threatened into silence, while others are too frightened to tell their parents. Younger children may not even understand what has happened to them. Mohan and his son are outliers.

Known devil

A study published in 2017 in the *Indian Journal of Psychiatry*, titled 'Silence of male child sexual abuse in India: Qualitative analysis of barriers for seeking psychiatric help in a multidisciplinary unit in a general hospital,' identified "patriarchy" as one of the barriers preventing boys from seeking psychiatric help after sexual abuse.

The study argues that protecting children requires equal attention to boys and girls. "Patriarchy is not protecting our boys more than our girls in childhood. The very low rates of reporting and help-seeking among victims of sexually abused boys in India could be due to the hegemony of patriarchy," the study authors say.

These Telangana numbers, for instance, account only for cases that reached the authorities. Police officers and those working with children in distress say it is difficult to estimate how many boys are sexually abused but never report it, particularly when the perpetrator is someone the child knows.

"In most cases, the perpetrators are known to the children. They either threaten or lure them into remaining silent about the abuse, allowing the perpetrator to escape punishment or continue the abuse until they speak up," says Dr. P. Lavanya Naik Jadav, DCP (She Team and Bharosa), Hyderabad.

In Telangana's capital, She Teams have been set up by the police to provide security to women. Bharosa is a Support Centre for Women and Children.

In one case last year, a child with an intellectual disability was repeatedly sexually assaulted by the warden of a state-run juvenile rescue home in Hyderabad, say police. When the child finally spoke about the assault, five other boys came forward with similar allegations, the officer says, declining to share further details.

In another case reported in August, Mohammed Irfan*, 13, a child from Hyderabad's Old City, was allegedly sexually assaulted by Asif*, 23, at the latter's house. Imran*, Irfan's father and a single parent who works as an electrician, recalls how his son gradually lost interest in studies and food, becaming physically weak. He was hospitalised for several days, but even then, he did not tell his family what had happened.

"He was terrified. Initially, we did not know what to do. But things have slowly started getting better for him," he says. "My son and Asif used to play cricket together in the locality. He only told his older brother about the assault. It had been going on for some months and Asif had threatened him so he would not tell anyone," says Imran.

Telangana police data show that in 61.8% of the recorded cases, the accused were known to the child. They included relatives, neighbours, teachers, schoolmates, and acquaintances. Strangers accounted for 38%.

Under-reporting for a reason

Cases are not confined to Hyderabad. In 2025, while the city recorded 28 male child victims, Khammam district, almost 200 kilometres from Hyderabad, recorded 13. Between January and September 2026, Hyderabad recorded 29 victims, followed by Mahabubabad district, with nine. Warangal, Nirmal, and Karimnagar recorded three each, while Suryapet, Rajanna-Sircilla, Narayanpet, Medak, and Mancherial districts reported two each.

In Khammam district, a case involving students at a residential school shows how difficult it can be to get children and their families to speak, even after the abuse has been reported.

In February 2025, a boy was struggling to concentrate on his studies and was reluctant to return to the hostel of a government residential school. When his parents asked him why, he disclosed that the warden had been abusing him. Gradually, other boys also came forward with their accounts. It came to light that more than 15 students, all between 12 and 15 years, had been abused on multiple occasions.

But when the case was registered, only six boys came forward to record their statements, says G. Rajakumari, a counsellor at the Bharosa Centre in Khammam.

She says several boys and their families were unwilling to testify because they feared shame and humiliation from society. Even after the allegations came to light, some families did not want to pursue the case.

According to the Director General of Police (WSW) Charu Sinha, boys accounted for only 1.37% of the total child victims recorded over the three reporting years. "Such an exceptionally low proportion of reported male victims warrants closer examination of potential under-reporting," she says. Sinha says the gap raises questions about how many boys are suffering abuse without telling anyone.

"Although this disparity cannot establish the actual magnitude of under-reporting, it warrants closer examination. Sexual abuse of boys may remain undisclosed because of shame, fear of ridicule, concerns about masculinity, family reputation and reluctance to acknowledge that boys can also be victims of sexual violence," she explains.

Boys are often expected to be strong, independent, and capable of protecting themselves. Such expectations, she says, can make it harder for them to seek out help to say they have been abused. "This underlines the importance of protection and awareness, especially within familiar environments," Sinha says.

Delayed disclosure, fear of stigma, reluctance among families to report incidents and difficulties in obtaining clear accounts from traumatised children remain major challenges for investigators, she adds.

The slow system of justice

When families approach the police, getting justice can take years. At present, 1,769 POCSO cases are pending before two designated courts in Hyderabad city alone. Public Prosecutor Alluri Ram Reddy says each court has one judge and one Public Prosecutor handling nearly 900 pending cases at a time, on average. Each trial requires at least two to three hours.

"If a court functions from 9.30 a.m. to 5 p.m., nearly half the day is spent hearing other petitions, including bail applications. In the remaining time, judges can take up only one or two POCSO cases a day. Is it humanly possible for a judge and a PP to handle 900 cases?" Reddy asks.

He says the government needs to establish more courts to deal with the pending cases.

"The government must provide the necessary infrastructure in proportion to the pendency of cases to ensure speedy trials," he says.

Another Public Prosecutor says delays in trials often mean that children have to live with the trauma of sexual assault for years along with revisiting unresolved cases repeatedly. "It is unfair on the part of the system to make a child, whether a girl or a boy, repeatedly recall such a horrific experience. Every time they are made to revisit the incident, it causes further trauma. Making laws alone is not enough. The government must also ensure their implementation by providing sufficient resources," the prosecutor says, adding that Hyderabad needs at least four courts to speed up trials.

For some survivors, the effects of sexual abuse can continue long after childhood.

Child psychiatrist Dr. M. Gowri Devi of Asha Hospital, Hyderabad, says there are many myths surrounding child sexual abuse. One is that a child's sexual orientation may change after the abuse. "This is untrue," she says, reiterating that sexual orientation is not triggered by trauma.

Awareness for vigilance

Police say awareness campaigns are particularly needed in residential schools and religious educational institutions, where they say a majority of the reported cases are coming from.

Dr. Devi says women, too, sexually abuse boys, but such incidents are often not reported or recognised as abuse. She recalls three cases involving boys who were sexually assaulted by women, including their own mother, a mother's close friend, and a tuition teacher.

In some cases, she says, teenage boys may mistake the abuse for affection or pleasure without understanding that they are being sexually exploited. The belief that boys cannot be sexually assaulted by women can also prevent victims from speaking about their experiences.

This is why child sex abuse educators talk in terms of safe touch and unsafe touch, rather than good touch and bad touch, because what may feel good may not be safe.

"While some may not recognise the abuse during childhood, its psychological impact can surface years later, particularly when people enter relationships or get married. Some may struggle with intimacy, trust, and their relationship with their spouse, without initially understanding that these difficulties could be linked to the abuse they experienced as children," Dr. Devi says.

A 2022 study, titled 'Disclosure of child sexual abuse: Experiences of men survivors in India,' published in *The British Journal of Social Work*, finds that disclosing child sexual abuse can be a lifelong process for male survivors.

In their conclusion, the study authors say, "When survivors disclose, responses of disclosure recipients are not always supportive or affirming. Unhelpful responses include victim blaming and silence. Barriers as well as unhelpful responses to disclosure are often linked to patriarchal constructions of masculinity and heteronormativity in society."

Dr. Devi says one of the first things she tries to do when treating children who have experienced sexual abuse is to help them understand that they are not responsible for what happened.

"I often ask them to imagine walking on a pavement when a vehicle suddenly hits them. Whose fault is it? The driver's, isn't it? I tell them to look at the assault in the same way. It was not their fault, and they should not blame themselves for what happened," she explains.

She says the trauma can be just as severe for boys as for girls, though boys often take longer to talk about it. Recovery, too, can take years. "A lot depends on the children's self-confidence, willingness to seek help, treatment and, above all, support from their family," she says.

**Names and other identifiable details have been changed to protect identity*

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M ND-NDE

From Page One

U.S. assures India of edge over competitors

"The attempt by both sides is to complete the deal by the end of this financial year," the official added. "We have also agreed to a clause that says that if either country changes its tariffs on the other country, then the second country can also modify its commitments under the deal. This was also a part of the February joint statement," the official said.

The official added that such a clause is "not usual" in trade deals that India enters into, but that it had specifically been included in the deal with the U.S. Separately, Mr. Agrawal said that the talks between the two sides were "on the right track" and that the teams are engaged both in-person and virtually.

"There was a small team from the U.S. that visited India for discussions on customs and trade facilitation in the first week of November," he said. "The discussions went off in a very positive direction. A lot of issues were closed, and there was convergence in a lot of areas."

In addition, he said that the chief negotiators of both sides regularly speak with each other virtually to carry forward the discussions and "iron out some of the language issues or some of the small fixes that remain in the agreement".

Exports at record high; diversification pays off

The data show that India's exports to 12 out of its top 20 export destinations grew by double digits or more. One of the key areas of diversification has been the African continent, with exports to that region growing 44% in April-September 2026 to $31.4 billion.

Trade with West Asia recovering

India's exports to West Asia increased to $5.7 billion in October 2026, compared to $5.5 billion YoY. Imports from the region stood at $16.2 billion versus $15.99 billion during the period.

India's services trade remained robust in October 2026. Services exports grew to $40.5 billion as compared to $35.2 billion in October last year – a 15% growth.

24 killed in highway collision in Assam

"Our foremost priority now is to make sure the injured receive the best possible medical care without delay. (Panchayat and Rural Development) Minister Atul Bora, who was at the site, is overseeing the relief arrangements. I pray for the swift recovery of the injured and for strength for the bereaved families," the Chief Minister said, adding that he would visit the place on Saturday.

"Some of the passengers died on the spot. They included some college students," Mr. Bora, also the local MLA, said.

Officials said the exact number of students who died was being ascertained. Officials suspected that overspeeding by the minibus, travelling from Golaghat to Nagaon in central Assam, caused the accident. A dashcam clip from the container truck heightened the suspicion.

Speed limits are enforced near animal corridors along the 60-km stretch of the National Highway abutting Kaziranga National Park.

A man who identified himself as the truck's driver said he was on his way to Dibrugarh from Tezpur when the minibus hit his vehicle. He and his companion escaped with minor injuries.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi condoled the deaths and said, "An ex-gratia of ₹2 lakh from PMNRF would be given to the next of kin of each of those who lost their lives. The injured would be given ₹50,000."

Disruption of Microsoft hits Indian enterprises

Around 8 p.m. IST on Friday, Charles Lamanna, executive vice president of Copilot, Agents and Platform at Microsoft, said, "We're seeing encouraging recovery progress, with service availability and e-mail delivery performance improving across a growing portion of affected infrastructure. We know our customers rely on our services to get important work done every day, and regret the impact these outages had on those who depend on us. Our teams are reviewing what happened and how we can prevent similar issues going forward."

The company said it was not aware of any malicious activity causing the disruption and promised that it would publish a detailed report on the root cause and corrective measures after services were restored.

Public services hit

Singapore's Government Technology Agency and Japanese Ministries reported e-mail disruptions, according to local media reports and official notices.

In Britain, Rachel Harrison of the GMB Union said National Health Service staff handling emergency calls could not refer to patient details as they normally would, creating a "massive backlog". Britain's National Pharmacy Association said the outage delayed prescriptions, AFP reported.

Four Naga civilians killed in Manipur highway ambush

The assailants ambushed two vehicles and opened fire; Kuki groups deny any involvement; the attack comes a day after a Kuki woman died and two Kuki men got injured in a similar incident

The Hindu Bureau
GUWAHATI

Unidentified gunmen killed four Naga civilians, including a mother and her son, on National Highway 202 in Manipur's Ukhrul district on Friday.

The assailants ambushed the vehicles – a hatchback and a pickup – in New Haven around 1 p.m. The location is in the Litan area, the epicentre of conflict between the Kuki and Naga communities since February this year.

The deceased were identified as Kapangkhui R.S., her son Haoleila R.S., Khanmila Keising, and August Ngalung. The first two victims were from Shangshak village and the latter two were from Tashar village; both villages are in Ukhrul district.

A Manipur Police statement said the miscreants opened fire on the two vehicles, and all four victims died on the spot.


Additional security personnel have been deployed to reinforce safety and prevent any more untoward incidents. FILE PHOTO

"Additional security forces, comprising Manipur Police, BSF (Border Security Force), Army, and Assam Rifles, have been rushed to the area to reinforce security and prevent any further untoward incidents. Search operations have been launched in and around the area of the incident to trace and apprehend those involved," the statement read.

Officials said the site of the attack is about 35 km from Ukhrul town and 6 km short of Litan. A blockade imposed by a Kuki organisation had stopped vehicular movement on the highway until August.

The government provides security escorts for vehicles travelling between Imphal and Ukhrul from Litan in both directions.

Friday's ambush came a day after a Kuki woman was killed and two Kuki men were injured in a similar firing incident in the adjoining Kangpokpi district. Ukhrul has a Naga majority while Kangpokpi has a Kuki majority.

'Impartial probe'

Naga organisations said Kuki armed groups could be behind the attack. However, Kuki groups categorically denied any involvement. Several Kuki civil society organisations condemned the killings of the Naga civilians and demanded an impartial probe into the incident.

More than 65 people have died since an alleged drunken brawl in February triggered the Kuki-Naga conflict in Manipur.

Manipur probe panel gets sixth extension; no sign of report yet

Vijaita Singh
NEW DELHI

The report is awaited even as the ethnic conflict has now spread to Kuki and Naga communities

The three-member Commission of Inquiry, set up by the Union Home Ministry to investigate the 2023 Manipur ethnic violence, was given a sixth extension on Friday.

The Ministry notified that the commission, which was constituted on June 4, 2023, "shall submit its report to the Central government as soon as possible but not later than May 20, 2027".

More than 300 people have been killed in the ethnic violence that erupted between the Kuki-Zo and Meitei people on May 3, 2023. Around 60,000 people have been displaced.

The probe panel's report is awaited even as the ethnic conflict has now spread to the Kuki and Naga communities. Since February this year, more than 60 people have been killed in Naga-Kuki clashes.

The commission is now headed by former Supreme Court judge Balbir Singh Chauhan, after Ajai Lamba, the former Chief Justice of the Gauhati High Court, resigned as the chairperson in February this year.

11,000 affidavits

Manipur's Commission of Inquiry has received around 11,000 affidavits.

President's rule was imposed in the State on February 13, 2025 and on February 4 this year, a new Chief Minister Yumnam Khemchand Singh took oath, ending Central rule.

The inquiry commission is mandated to probe the causes, extent of violence and riots targeting members of different communities, the sequence of events, and whether there were any lapses or dereliction of duty on the part of any of the responsible authorities and individuals.

UAPA ban on Zakir Naik's IRF extended for five years

Vijaita Singh
NEW DELHI

The Union Home Ministry has extended the ban against "Islamic terror-preacher" Zakir Naik's Islamic Research Foundation (IRF) under the Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act (UAPA) for another five years, a government notification said.

The IRF was first declared an "unlawful association" in 2016, which was extended for another five years in 2021.

Naik left India in 2016 and was granted permanent residency by Malaysia. Despite India seeking Naik's extradition, Malaysia is yet to comply with the request.

India's bid at the Interpol to open a Red Corner Notice against Naik, to stop his free movement across the world, has also not materialised.

"If the unlawful activities of the IRF are not curbed immediately, it will take the opportunity to continue its subversive activities and re-organise its activists who are still absconding and disrupt the secular fabric of the country by polluting the minds of the people by creating communal disharmony," the Ministry said in a statement.

'Fostering hostility'

"Led by fugitive terror preacher Dr. Zakir Naik, the organisation has been involved in sinister anti-India designs, including inciting communal hatred, fostering hostility and promoting terrorism. The group has been found to be propagating a venomous ideology of terrorism and separatism, instigating violent unrest, encouraging the regrouping of absconding terrorists and fomenting communal discord," the office of Union Home Minister Amit Shah said in a post on social media platform X.

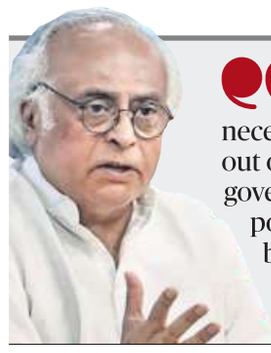
The IRF has been indulging in activities which are prejudicial to the security of the country, and have the potential of disturbing peace and communal harmony and disrupting the secular fabric of the country, the Ministry said.

The Union government is of the opinion that the IRF and its members, particularly, the founder and president of the IRF, Dr. Zakir Abdul Karim Naik alias Dr. Zakir Naik, has been encouraging its followers to promote, on grounds of religion, disharmony or feelings of enmity, hatred or ill-will between different religious communities and groups which are prejudicial to the security of the country, the Ministry said.

The notification has been made under Section 3 (1)(3) of the Unlawful Activities Prevention Act.

Congress slams Modi govt. over soaring cost of living

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI



> From the kitchen to every other daily necessity, prices have spiralled out of control. The Modi government's misguided policies have broken the backs of ordinary people
>
> **JAIRAM RAMESH**
> Congress general secretary

The Congress on Friday accused the Narendra Modi government of failing to contain the rising prices of essential commodities, saying the country was witnessing "*mehengaai ka bhuchaal*" (earthquake of inflation) instead of "*Amrit Kaal*" (period of prosperity).

Congress communications chief Jairam Ramesh, sharing media reports on his X handle, said the rising costs of food and everyday necessities was putting an increasing burden on household budgets.

"Under the Modi government, inflation is no longer just a '*daayan*' (witch); it has become an uninvited guest, devouring every household's budget. From the kitchen to every other daily necessity, prices have spiralled out of control. The Modi government's misguided policies have broken the backs of ordinary people," Mr. Ramesh said.

He claimed that retail inflation had touched a two-year high of 6.09%, while food inflation had risen to 8.94%. Citing price rises, he said onions had become 116% more expensive, garlic 60% and ginger 48%, and that prices had risen across 11 of the 12 consumption categories, impacting households far greater than what official figures indicated.

From flour, cooking oil, ghee, milk, and pulses to soap, the cost of everyday essentials had risen, he said, adding that companies were also considering reducing the quantity of products rather than raising prices further.

Mr. Ramesh also flagged the possibility of interest rate increases. "Now, there are also fears of interest rate hikes, which would make both borrowing and living even more expensive for ordinary people. This is not an Amrit Kaal; it is an inflationary earthquake," he said.

Cancer patient held for planting hijack threat on aircraft

Senjuti Sengupta
KOLKATA

A 56-year-old man with colon cancer was arrested on Thursday for planting a hoax threat on a Mumbai-bound Air India flight from Netaji Subhash Chandra Bose International Airport in Kolkata on Wednesday.

A handwritten note with a hijacking threat was found in the washroom of AI 2772 only a few minutes before the flight was to take off, according to the police. All 105 passengers were immediately offboarded and a search operation was initiated, but nothing suspicious was found.

Meanwhile, the police started questioning the passengers and also collecting samples of their handwriting.

"We noticed an imprint of a rusty button on the slip in which the threat was written. It was assumed that it could be from a wallet. So, we also checked everyone's wallets thoroughly," Prabhakar Adhikari, Inspector, airport police station, said. Both the handwriting and the wallet was matched with one passenger, Partha Pratim Nandi. He was detained immediately for questioning.

During the interrogation on Thursday, he confessed that he had written the message.

"*Prima facie*, he was going to Mumbai, from where he was supposed to take his next flight to South Africa, where he had been selected for a new job. But both he and his wife have been suffering from cancer for a long time. He did not want to go far away from his wife and therefore came up with the idea to cancel the entire flight," the inspector said.

Following the confession, the police arrested him immediately.

India-Bangladesh consular talks to be held on mutually convenient date, says govt.

Kallol Bhattacherjee
NEW DELHI

The fifth round of the India-Bangladesh consular dialogue will be held on a "mutually convenient date", the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) said on Friday.

Speaking to the media during the bi-weekly media briefing, Randhir Jaiswal, official spokesperson of the MEA, reiterated that India seeks to build "positive, constructive and forward-looking" relations with Bangladesh.

"The next round of the India-Bangladesh Consular Dialogue, which will also take up matters relating to the Revised Travel Arrangement, will be held on a mutually convenient date. India remains ready to discuss all bilateral issues with Bangladesh through these existing mechanisms, including at the technical level," Mr. Jaiswal said.


Randhir Jaiswal

The Hindu had reported on Thursday about the postponement of the consular talks that were to be held on November 17 and 18.

"India desires a positive, constructive, and forward-looking relationship with Bangladesh. Accordingly, initiatives have been taken and meetings held under our structured mechanisms in such areas as trade, railways, water resources and border management, among others," said Mr. Jaiswal.

Diplomatic sources had indicated that the postponement was because of the spike in tensions in view of the proposed return of former Prime Minister Sheikh Hasina to Bangladesh. Ms. Hasina has been in India since August 5, 2024 and she has said that she would return to Dhaka in December.

The two sides started consular dialogue in 2017 to strengthen people-to-people contact by having a regular channel of communication on consular, visa and mutual legal assistance cooperation matters. Four rounds of consular dialogue were held during the rule of the Awami League in Dhaka.

The MEA said the fourth round in May 2024 discussed issues such as "visa matters, repatriation, mutual legal assistance treaty cases, etc".

Conference urges BRICS to focus on mental health

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The 11th Together Against Stigma (TAS) conference, being organised by George Institute for Global Health in collaboration with Department of Psychiatry, AIIMS Delhi, and UNICEF, has called for stronger cooperation among BRICS countries to combat mental health stigma and discrimination, with a focus on improving access to inclusive mental healthcare for children, adolescents, and young people.

They identified youth participation, school-based interventions and evidence-based policy reforms as key priorities. Network of Centres of Excellence were also identified as platforms for sharing research and expertise.

Being held at AIIMS, New Delhi, from November 12 to 14, the conference is the first edition hosted in a Global South country.

Rahul says his phone with proof against Modi is being tapped

Opposition leader says PM's political career will be finished if they were to have a debate on who is an anti-national, as it will expose who is being controlled by foreign powers; he adds that there are much more details stored in the phone

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Accusing Prime Minister Narendra Modi of tapping his phone, the Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha, Rahul Gandhi, on Friday dared Mr. Modi to have a debate with him on who was an anti-national.

The Prime Minister's "political career will be over" if he accepted the invitation to debate as he [Mr. Gandhi] had "evidence" against Mr. Modi on his phone, the Congress leader claimed.

"The Prime Minister's political career will be over if he comes and debates with me. He knows that and I know that. He keeps calling me anti-national. I want to show the nation who exactly is anti-national, who is controlled by whom and since when, and he knows that truth," the Congress leader said in a video on his Instagram and X handles.

Replying to a question during an 'Ask Me' session on Instagram on why he was insisting on a public debate when the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) has said the exchange could take place in Parliament, Mr. Gandhi said he was not allowed to speak in the House and even his microphone was switched off.

> You did not let me talk on the farm Bills, vote *chori*, SIR, China, on [General] Naravane's book, [Jeffrey] Epstein. I want a one-on-one debate. I don't want a debate entailing long speeches
>
> **RAHUL GANDHI**
> Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha



One-on-one debate

"You did not let me talk on the farm Bills, vote *chori* (theft), SIR, China, on [General] Naravane's book, [Jeffrey] Epstein. I want a one-on-one debate. I don't want a debate entailing long speeches," Mr. Gandhi said. "I want that Narendra Modi makes allegations against me and I do the same to him. He can come. There will be a table. On one side, there will be Narendra Modi*ji*, and on the other side, it will be me."

Mr. Gandhi suggested that business tycoon Gautam Adani or Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS) chief Mohan Bhagwat could become the judge for the debate. "But I guarantee that the Prime Minister will not remain the PM after a one-on-one debate with me," he said.

"The proof is here," Mr. Gandhi said in response to another question on what proof he had to back his allegations. "The Prime Minister knows it because he taps my phone. The moment he comes for the debate, one-on-one debate, everybody will know who is controlled by foreign powers, who is an anti-national, and since when he has been an anti-national, and lots of other details are on my phone," the Congress leader added.

'Fear in Modi's mind'

"Notice something: there is a little fear in his [Modi's] mind because he is no longer commenting about me, he is no longer attacking me, he is being very, very careful. There is a reason for it, guys," Mr. Gandhi said.

The Opposition leader took a swipe at the Prime Minister over his Deepavali *milan* (gathering) programme at the BJP headquarters with representatives of the media.

"Modi*ji*, even at your own *godi* media's Diwali gathering, you used a teleprompter? The people are yours, the stage is yours, the whole environment is yours, yet you still need a script. Looks like the pressure got to you. Anyway, no worries. Bring a teleprompter to a debate with me too, and seat a judge of your choice as well. Just show up, that's all. The country wants to know – who is the real traitor?" Mr. Gandhi said.

'Great book'

In response to another question on why the BJP was talking so much about *Belonging: A Journey Of Love*, the memoir by his mother and Congress Parliamentary Party chairperson Sonia Gandhi, Mr. Gandhi said it was "great book" and they were all reading it.

"They can't resist reading it and then they have got to comment on it. A lot of them actually secretly like her and they think she is fantastic, but unfortunately they can't say it. The other thing is – all you *bhakts*, please, please keep commenting on the book because the more you comment, the better it does," Mr. Gandhi said.

Congress launches website for voters to check SIR deletions

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Congress on Friday launched a website where voters can check if their names have been deleted from electoral rolls during the special intensive revision (SIR) and register complaints seeking restoration.

Announcing the initiative, Congress general secretary (organisation) K.C. Venugopal said the website, *Iamvoterakshak.in*, would allow citizens to verify their names and formally protest against deletions by applying for restoration.

Before the announcement, Mr. Venugopal chaired a video conference with AICC general secretaries, in-charge leaders, Pradesh Congress Committee (PCC) presidents, AICC secretaries and observers to review the party's ongoing "Vote *Bachao*, *Desh Bachao*" campaign against alleged electoral irregularities.



K.C. Venugopal

'Vote Rakshaks'

As part of the next phase of the campaign, Congress workers will function as "Vote Rakshaks" and visit every polling booth to verify deletions from electoral rolls. "The mission to stop 'vote *chori*' continues in every single corner of India," Mr. Venugopal said, asserting that the Congress would continue its campaign until the integrity of the electoral system was restored.

The party will organise village-level *chaupals* across the country by December 15, where names deleted during the SIR exercise will be read out, Mr. Venugopal said.

The PCCs will organise large-scale "Samvidhan Raksha" marches in their respective States on November 26, Constitution Day.

Bengal CM says CID to probe housing scheme 'scam'

Shiv Sahay Singh
KOLKATA

West Bengal Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari on Friday alleged that around 57,000 fake beneficiaries had fraudulently applied for the Banglar Bari Rural Housing Scheme, out of which 12,000 such beneficiaries had received government funds during the previous Trinamool Congress government.

About 1,000 of the beneficiaries had returned the money fraudulently obtained by the government, and the remaining 11,000 ineligible recipients had till November 30 to return government funds or face legal action, Mr. Adhikari said.

"We want to constitute an SIT (Special Investigation Team) and have the CID investigate the matter. If there has been any lapse at the official level, action will be taken," Mr. Adhikari said at an event at the State Secretariat where the West Bengal government transferred ₹4,201 crore as the second instalment of housing assistance to more than 7.17 lakh beneficiaries across the State.

Himachal govt. approves monthly aid of ₹1,500 for women; 3.50 lakh to benefit

The Hindu Bureau
CHANDIGARH

The Himachal Pradesh government on Friday approved the launch of the "Mukhya Mantri Apna Parivar Sukhi Parivar Yojna," under which eligible women aged 18 to 59 will receive ₹1,500 per month in financial assistance.

The decision was taken at a Cabinet meeting, chaired by Chief Minister Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu, in Shimla. "It has been decided to launch the 'Mukhya Mantri Apna Parivar Sukhi Parivar Yojna' in the State, under which eligible women in the age group of 18 to 59 years will receive financial assistance of ₹1,500 per month," said an official statement.

Under the scheme, eligible beneficiary families will also receive 300 units of free electricity, said the statement, adding, "In all, 3.50 lakh eligible women have been identified as beneficiaries. The government had earlier raised the monthly aid for women above 59 years from ₹1,050 to ₹1,500."



Himachal Pradesh CM Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu during the 'Anti-Chitta Awareness Walkathon' in Mandi on Friday. ANI

Providing financial assistance to women and giving free electricity up to 300 units monthly to households was among the key pre-poll promises made by the Congress during the 2022 Assembly election.

The Cabinet also decided to adopt a uniform State policy for determining and periodically revising the rates for the sale of surplus raw water to neighbouring States, government agencies and industries.

'Drug-free State'

It was also decided to launch the 'Khelo Himachal Chitta Mukt Abhiyan-2026' across all twelve districts of the State. The initiative aims to engage youth in sports activities and strengthen efforts towards drug prevention by promoting a healthy lifestyle, discipline and positive community participation.

Meanwhile, in Mandi, Mr. Sukhu led the anti '*chitta*' (heroin) awareness walkathon.

Addressing a public gathering, he said "I want to make it absolutely clear that there is no place in Himachal Pradesh for those who sell '*chitta*' and destroy the lives of our youth. ... The government had adopted a firm policy against those involved in the illegal drug trade and that strict legal action is being taken against drug peddlers and traffickers."

War of words in U.P. over CM's remark on bulldozer becoming 'brand' of State

Mayank Kumar
LUCKNOW

Criticising Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath's comment inviting industries to manufacture bulldozers in the State, the Opposition parties on Friday said a symbol of injustice and oppression could never be a brand of the State.

"For a long time, U.P. CM has been synonymous with making controversial statements. The remark that the 'bulldozer' has now become a brand of Uttar Pradesh is unacceptable as in the State, bulldozer is used on poor and people hailing from marginalised communities, mostly Dalits and minorities. Bulldozer is a symbol of injustice and a weapon of oppression. Only a divisive leader will make such remarks. Under the garb of zero-tolerance policy towards crime, injustice is being committed against a large section of population," Anil Yadav, a senior Congress leader, said.

The Samajwadi Party alleged the bulldozer is selectively used against political opponents and the poor. "The Chief Minister gives protection to anti-social elements hailing from dominant, feudal communities, while using bulldozer against opponents. We saw how Azam Khan Saheb is being subjected to injustice," SP spokesperson Ameeque Jamei said.



Supporters with earth-mover bulldozers attend a public meeting of Yogi Adityanath in Sidharth Nagar, Uttar Pradesh, in 2022. PTI

Addressing the groundbreaking ceremony of CNH Industrial's new tractor manufacturing plant on Thursday, Mr. Adityanath said, "The rule of law has replaced mafia rule in Uttar Pradesh. The zero-tolerance policy towards crime and criminals, coupled with bulldozer action, has transformed the State into a major investment destination. The bulldozer has now become a brand of Uttar Pradesh. If companies manufacture bulldozers and tractors here, their demand will automatically rise in India and abroad."

Commending the public representatives of the Jewar region, he said, "The area, which was once notorious for crime and gun violence, has emerged as one of India's finest investment destinations and a 'jewel' of the country. With the development of Noida International Airport and YEIDA [Yamuna Expressway Industrial Development Authority], the entire region is evolving into a major industrial, economic and logistics hub."

'Delink poll roll status and welfare benefits'

Press Trust of India
NEW DELHI

A civil society group has written to Panchayati Raj Minister Rajiv Ranjan Singh over his reported remarks that voter ID will replace Aadhaar for identifying beneficiaries of social welfare programmes, urging the government to assure the public that electoral-roll status will not become a condition for receiving welfare benefits.

The letter from Citizens for Fraternity Forum (CFF-Bharat) was signed by former Delhi Lieutenant-Governor Najeeb Jung, ex-AMU Vice-Chancellor Zameer Uddin Shah and former diplomat Ashok Kumar Sharma, among others. It said no eligible citizen should be denied welfare benefits merely because they do not possess a voter ID.

PARADIP PORT AUTHORITY
HARBOUR WORKS DIVISION No.I
e-TENDER CALL NOTICE
e-TCN No.CE/HWDI/ACCTS-03/26/352, dtd. 04.11.2026
Name of the work : "Supply of Cell & Super-M Fenders along with Bollards for installation at different Berths inside Harbour area".
Put to tender value: **Rs.2,52,10,796.16** plus GST as applicable.
Last date & time of submission of tender through online bidding is **30.11.2026 up to 17:15 Hrs.**
For details, please log on to the Website :**https://eprocure.gov.in/eprocure/app**
Executive Engineer,
Harbour Works Division No.I, PPA.
PPA/PR/39/2026-2027, dt.12/11/2026

TAMILNADU CEMENTS CORPORATION LIMITED
(A GOVERNMENT OF TAMILNADU UNDERTAKING)
5th Floor, Aavin Illam, No.3A, Pasumpon Muthuramalingam Salai, Nandanam, Chennai- 35.
Short e-Tender Notice
e-Tender Ref.No:20/2026-27, Supply of PP Woven bags on F.O.R basis at Ariyalur Cement Works, Ariyalur District, T.N. Under piece work/Rate contract basis
Est. Value: Rs.20.28 Crore, EMD: Rs.10,00,000/-
Submission of tender: Up to 12.00 Noon on 30.11.2026
Important Note:
A pre-bid meeting will be held on **18.11.2026** at **3.00 pm** at TANCEM, Registered Office, 5th Floor, Aavin Illam, No.3A, Pasumpon Muthuramalingam Salai, Nandanam, Chennai – 600 035.
The Tender document can be downloaded from **https://tntenders.gov.in** Corrigendum / Addendum to this publication, if any would appear only on the above said website.
DIPR /3587/ TENDER / 2026 General Manager (Marketing)/DRO

TIRUMALA TIRUPATI DEVASTHANAMS - TIRUPATI
Office of the Chief Engineer | TENDER NOTICE
ADV No.46/D3/CE/TTD/2026-27, NIT No.118 /SE-I/TTD/ 2026 -27 dt:11-11- 2026
Name of work:(1) Improvements to Vengamamba Hostel in SPW Junior College, TTD, Tirupati. **Amount 515.80 Lakhs, Time for completion 15 months.**
NOTE: For full details, log on to the Website **https://www.tirumala.org.**
TTD-40021(31)/1/2026-PRO SEC(Adv.No.242) Date:13-11-2026 **EXECUTIVE OFFICER**

AP POWER GENERATION CORPORATION Ltd., VS, VIJAYAWADA-520004
(A Govt. of A.P Undertaking)
NOTIFICATION for AP e-Procurement TENDER Notice
No,02-CE HP SES SRBPH 2026 (Tender ID,1007468)
APGENCO invites open tenders for "Design, Engineering, Manufacture, Programming, Inspection, Packing and Forwarding, Supply & delivery at site stores, dismantling of old Exciatation systems and Erection, Testing & Commissioning of 07 Nos. new Static Excitation Systems for 7X110 MW Units of Srisailam Right Bank Power House, Srisailam project, Nandyala Dist. Andhra Pradesh" through AP e-procurement.
Schedule available Date & Time : **14.11.2026 - 11:00 Hrs** onwards
Bid submission Closing Date & Time: **14.12.2026 - 17:30 Hrs**
For further details visit: **https://tender.apeprocurement.gov.in**
Contact No: **0866-2526-321/081/323/309**
DIPR 5559PP/CL, Dt: 13/11/2026

MAHATRANSCO
Maharashtra State Electricity Transmission Co. Ltd.
E-TENDER NOTICE
MSETCL invites online bids (E-Tender) for following

S.N.	Tender No. & Description
1	RFx. No. 7000042133; Work of Supply, Civil and ETC. (excluding supply of TF) for Work of Additional 1x50MVA 132/33KV Transformer at 220KV Kalmeshwar S/stn under O&M Division Nagpur and Additional 1x25MVA 220/33KV Transformer at 220KV Nagbhid S/stn & Additional 1x50MVA 132/33KV Transformer at each 132KV Bramhapuri S/stn & 132KV Sindewahi S/stn under & 132KV Jam S/stn under O&M Division Balharshah / Wardha **EMD : Rs. 1895880/- & Tender Fees: Rs. 25000/- (GST extra)**

Tenders Available at : https://srmetender.mahatransco.in; Due date for online submission upto: 29.11.2026, 11:00 Hrs; Tender Opening 29.11.2026, 12:00 Hrs if possible
Sd/-
Chief Engineer
EHV PC O&M Zone Nagpur.

Opposition calls for wider consultations by FCRA panel

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Parliament's Joint Committee reviewing the Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Amendment Bill, 2026, met 25 organisations in a single day's sitting on Thursday, as it rushes to finalise its report in time for the upcoming Parliament session that is likely to begin on November 30.

Opposition members, in a letter to the panel Chairperson and BJP leader Sanjay Jaiswal, said the committee should hold wider consultations with stakeholders across the country, arguing that the consequences of the Bill would be felt most acutely at the level of the individual parish, school, college, hospital, orphanage, and welfare home.

"The vast majority of these stakeholders have neither the means nor a realistic opportunity to travel to New Delhi and place their views before the committee," Opposition members wrote. The letter was signed by six members – Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam's P. Wilson; Congress's Christopher Tilak, Captain Viriato Fernandes and Muhammed Hamdullah Sayeed; and the Samajwadi Party's Zia Ur Rehman Barq and Javed Ali Khan.



BJP MP Sanjay Jaiswal, the Chairperson of the Joint Parliamentary Committee, and other members at a meeting last month. FILE PHOTO

Competing arguments

The invitees for Thursday's meeting included the National Council of Churches in India and other Christian organisations, which strongly opposed the legislation, arguing that it would hamper their charitable work.

At least five RSS-linked organisations were also invited to present their views. They argued in favour of the legislation, calling it a key step towards regulating foreign funding.

The Christian groups argued that, in the name of tighter monitoring of foreign funding, many vulnerable groups that receive support from charitable organisations would be denied help.

They also argued that it impinges on their religious freedom. The Opposition members have requested that the Christian groups submit details of the charitable organisations they run that are dependent on foreign funding.

The RSS-linked organisations called for tighter provisions, including listing FCRA violations as a scheduled offence under the Prevention of Money-Laundering Act, 2002 (PMLA), which is a core criminal law aimed at combating terror financing and money laundering.

Those who submitted their opinions before the committee included Apostles Methodist Church, National Council of Churches in India, Evangelical Church of India, Jesus Redeems, Vanvasi Kalyan Ashram, Akhil Bhartiya Adhivakta Parishad, and Rashtriya Sewa Bharati, among others. Opposition members questioned how the RSS-linked groups that were invited qualified as stakeholders.

The Bill was introduced in Lok Sabha on March 25 this year and referred to the panel on August 12, following demands from the Opposition, which alleged that certain provisions of the legislation were highly objectionable.

INBRIEF



Money laundering case: ED questions Azam Khan in Delhi

The Enforcement Directorate (ED) on Friday began questioning arrested Samajwadi Party (SP) leader Azam Khan at its Delhi headquarters in connection with a money laundering case, officers said. Mr. Khan, a former Uttar Pradesh Minister, was remanded to ED custody for four days by a special Prevention of Money Laundering Act (PMLA) court in Ghaziabad on Thursday. The Central agency arrested him outside the Rampur jail in U.P. on October 31, and he was lodged in the Dasna jail in Ghaziabad. Officials said the questioning and recording of Mr. Khan's statement was being conducted by its Lucknow zone investigating team. PTI

M.P. man dies after bomb offered as rasgulla explodes

A 35-year-old man died in Dindori district of Madhya Pradesh safter a crude bomb disguised as a sweet treat exploded in his mouth, the police said on Friday. The victim, identified as Rajendra Barotiya, was offered the explosive by an acquaintance who presented it as rasgulla at Padariya Chhanta village on Tuesday. Locally known as a "*suar mar* bomb" (pig bomb), it is made using dough and gunpowder to kill wild boars. The Additional Superintendent of Police, Dindori, told *The Hindu* that after the bomb exploded, Barotiya was taken to the district hospital, where he died during treatment. The police have arrested two accused.

Comply with revised prices of 137 anti-cancer drugs: NPPA

The National Pharmaceutical Pricing Authority (NPPA) has warned of penal action against those failing to comply with the revised prices of 137 non-scheduled anti-cancer drugs. The NPPA has directed State drug controllers to strictly monitor the prices and submit their action taken reports by November 16, a release said on Friday. The new prices came into effect on November 9, after the government capped the trade margin on these 137 medicines at 30%. Complaints regarding overcharging or non-availability of medicines can be registered on the Pharma Sahi Daam app, the NPPA helpline (1800-111-255), or via email at monitoring-nppa@gov.in. PTI

Second-year student found dead at IIT-Roorkee hostel

A second-year BS-MS student at the Indian Institute of Technology, Roorkee was found dead in his hostel room on Thursday night, the police said. The deceased has been identified as Ayush Rajoria, 20, from Ghaziabad, who was pursuing a degree in mathematics and computing. Pradeep Bisht, SHO at the Roorkee police station, said that the IIT administration informed the police that the student had been experiencing depression and attending counselling sessions. The student's parents do not suspect foul play and have not filed a complaint, the police said. *(Those in distress can contact Tele MANAS at 14416)*

Hope Pakistan will attend SCO meet in Delhi: Minister

Culture Minister says the two countries share a common civilisational legacy; however, External Affairs Ministry indicates it may not grant Punjab CM nod to travel to Lahore for another meet

Suhasini Haidar
Sreeparna Chakrabarty
NEW DELHI

India and Pakistan have a shared "civilisational and cultural" past, Union Culture Minister Gajendra Singh Shekhawat said on Friday, adding that India hopes the neighbouring country will attend the upcoming SCO Civilisational Dialogue Forum in New Delhi. China, Kazakhstan, Iran, Tajikistan, and Uzbekistan are among countries that have already confirmed their participation.

However, the government said it would follow "national policy" on Pakistan in view of the 2025 Pahalgam terror attacks, indicating that it may not grant Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Singh Mann clearance to attend an international Punjabi cultural conference in Lahore in November-end.

Mr. Shekhawat was briefing presspersons about preparations for the first Civilisational Dialogue Forum of the 10-nation Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO) grouping from November 20 to 22. As reported by *The Hindu* on October 28, the government has sent an invitation to Pakistan's Minister for National Heritage and Culture, Aurangzeb Khan Khichi, a first such ministerial-level invitation since 2023. Pakistan has not so far responded to the invitation, and while they have not confirmed the Minister's presence, sources said they expect some Pakistani official participation.



The SCO meet on November 21 and 22 will discuss civilisational and cultural expression, art and architecture, and language, literature and manuscripts, says Gajendra Singh Shekhawat. PTI

'Evolved together'

"I believe that Pakistan's civilisational and cultural progress is no different from ours [India's]," Mr. Shekhawat said in response to a question about the invitation, given the tensions between the two neighbours. "They [Pakistan] separated from us less than 100 years ago, but prior to that we [India and Pakistan] have evolved together. So, we should not have any differences over these issues."

The Minister said the purpose of the upcoming forum, first proposed by Prime Minister Narendra Modi, was to see how the SCO could "go a step beyond geopolitical, strategic and bilateral relations and strengthen our cultural ties so that in the future we can have better relations and communications between the people of our countries".

Asked about Pakistan's participation on Friday, External Affairs Ministry official spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said: "We look forward to hosting this civilisational dialogue." However, on the question of Mr. Mann, who has been invited along with Punjab MLAs by Pakistan's Minority Affairs Minister Ramesh Singh Arora to Lahore, Mr. Jaiswal took a tougher line.

Effect of attacks

"When it comes to relations with foreign countries, we have a national policy and expect everybody to abide by it," Mr. Jaiswal said, adding that the Ministry would make an assessment on the invitation from Pakistan in line with India's overall policy. "As far as our position on Pakistan after the Pahalgam terror attack is concerned, it should be amply clear to all as to where we stand," he said.

Outlining the programme for the SCO dialogue forum, Mr. Shekhawat said the discussions on November 21 and 22 will revolve around the broad themes of civilisational and cultural expression, art and architecture, and language, literature and manuscripts.

WHO flags funding gaps in prevention, treatment of TB

Bindu Shajan Perappadan
NEW DELHI

International donor funding fell by 14%, from $1.1 billion in 2024 to $0.94 billion in 2025, says report

Around 86% of the spending on measures against tuberculosis (TB) in 2025 came from domestic sources, the recently released Global Tuberculosis Report, 2026 by the World Health Organization (WHO) said, even as the reduction in international donor funding to combat the infectious disease remains a cause of concern.

The report notes that $22 billion is needed annually for TB prevention, diagnosis, treatment, and care to achieve the global targets agreed on at the 2023 United Nations high-level TB meeting by 2027.

In absolute terms, Brazil, China, India, the Russian Federation, and South Africa accounted for $3.7 billion (65%) of the total of $5.63 billion provided from domestic sources in low- and middle-income countries (LMICs).

Funding gap

The report notes that international donor funding fell by 14%, from $1.1 billion in 2024 to $0.94 billion in 2025, having been relatively stable at $1.1-1.3 billion a year between 2015 and 2024.

Financing for TB research and innovation, at $1.2 billion in 2023, continued to fall far short of the global target of $5 billion a year. Progress to date has been constrained by the overall level of investment, the report said .

"...Over 80% of cases and deaths are in low- and middle-income countries. In 2025, the largest number of new TB cases occurred in the WHO South-East Asia Region (35%)," the report said.

The WHO on Friday called upon countries in the Southeast Asia Region to accelerate action to end TB. The latest TB estimates show the region accounts for 3.6 million people who developed TB in 2025 – 34% of the global total – and 4,00,000 TB-related deaths, or 35% of the global total. "These numbers are a stark reminder that TB remains one of the Region's most pressing public health and development challenges," said Nilesh Buddha, officer in-charge, WHO South-East Asia Region.

'Deep-ocean submersible to undergo trial in early 2027'

Tiki Rajwi
THIRUVANANTHAPURAM

The 500-metre trial dive of India's deep-ocean submersible Matsya-6000 can be expected early next year, Srinivasa Kumar Tummala, Secretary, Ministry of Earth Sciences, has said. The trial dive will be a significant step towards India's push to send a crewed vehicle to a depth of 6,000 metres under the Samudrayaan Project.

"It is planned for a January-February time-frame in 2027. We are building Matsya-6000 in phases. So the first phase will be 500-metre depth trials," Mr. Tummala told *The Hindu* on the sidelines of the two-day 92nd Annual Meeting of the Indian Academy of Sciences (IASc), which opened at the National Centre for Earth Science Studies (NCESS) in Thiruvananthapuram on Friday.



Srinivasa Tummala. TIKI RAJWI

According to him, the Bay of Bengal will be the location for the dive. Two "pilots", or "aquanauts", from the National Institute of Ocean Technology (NIOT), the autonomous institute under the Ministry responsible for the project, are undergoing training.

Under India's Deep Ocean Mission, the Ministry had entrusted NIOT with the task of designing and developing the "deep-ocean human scientific submersible" – christened Matsya-6000 – as part of the Samudrayaan Project.

The submersible will be capable of transporting three humans within its compact 2.1-metre diameter spherical hull to 6,000 metres, giving India's ocean exploration capabilities a significant boost.

The NIOT is working closely with the Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) for the construction of the titanium hull of Matsya-6000, the Secretary said.

"There are very few countries that are able to build a 2.1-metre (diameter) titanium sphere," he said.

Despite the challenges involved, Samudrayaan and Matsya-6000 have not garnered the kind of public appeal that the ISRO's own Gaganyaan programme has been enjoying. Yet, both initiatives share elements, the Secretary said.

Court orders narco test of TV actor in Ankita murder case

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

A special Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) court in Dehradun on Friday approved narco-analysis and polygraph tests for television actor Urmila Sanawar in connection with the 2022 murder of Ankita Bhandari.

Ms. Sanawar's lawyer, Shivani Tomar, told presspersons that her client had consented to both tests. She added that the tests would be conducted in Gujarat. A medical examination of Ms. Sanawar is likely to be conducted by the third week of November, following which the schedule for the tests will be confirmed.

Ms. Sanawar was arrested in Saharanpur, Uttar Pradesh, on October 25, in connection with a separate case. A fresh FIR was registered against her in Dehradun a day later over alleged defamatory remarks against Sikkim Governor Dushyant Kumar Gautam and other BJP leaders. She was subsequently granted bail by a Haridwar court in a separate defamation and extortion case.



Urmila Sanawar

Ankita Bhandari, a receptionist at Vanantra Resort in the Pauri district of Uttarakhand, was murdered in September 2022 by resort owner Pulkit Arya, son of a former BJP leader, and his two aides. All three were convicted and sentenced to life imprisonment in 2025.

The case drew widespread attention amid allegations that Bhandari was killed after refusing to provide "special services" to a VIP expected to visit the resort that week. Her parents have alleged that Mr. Gautam was the VIP in question and that his political influence had prevented his name from being included in the investigation.

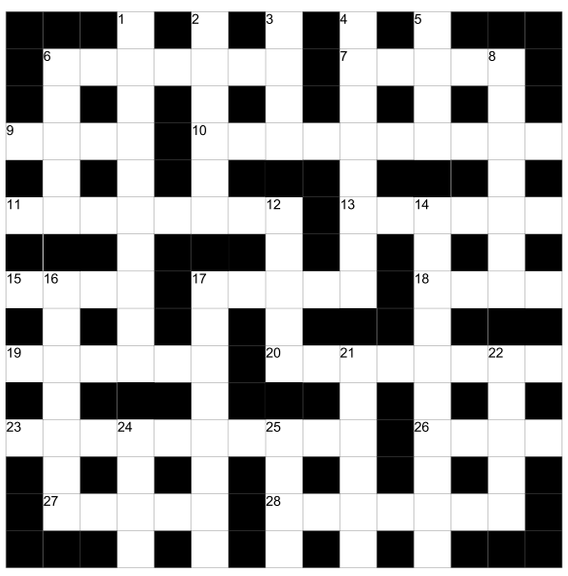
Ms. Sanawar has said she came to know about the alleged involvement of a politically influential VIP in the murder. The CBI had issued notices to her and former BJP MLA Suresh Rathore in connection with an audio recording referring to the alleged VIP link. Both had consented to undergo narco-analysis and polygraph tests in October. The case was handed over to the CBI in February.

TH CROSSWORD + 14948

(set by Gridzilla)

To solve this puzzle online, get across to our crossword site. *https://thehindu.com/crosswords*

SCAN TO PLAY



ACROSS

6. One may help in identifying Spooner's gentle horse (7)
7. Make use of a screen in the auditorium (5)
9. Trauma is caused by shock, mainly (4)
10. A place one barely enjoys? (6,4)
11. Frequently goes abroad, for nothing (5-3)
13. / 16D That Ola stopped moving (6,2,1,4)
15. For starters, it usually takes eons to withdraw case (4)
17. Grinder is good, after directions are switched (5)
18. Not the first to hang up? (4)
19. Way from podcaster's house (6)
20. Annoyed? No (6,2)
23. Gets ready for a shooting? (4,6)
26. Work quota doubles around lunchtime (4)
27. A prickly plant from south or north (5)
28. Take that drunkard in! (2,5)

DOWN

1. Caricature of senior MP is funny (10)
2. Catholic chaps reconcile immediately (2,4)
3. Old footage deceived cops (4)
4. Superintendent taking guards for a little nightly stress buster (8)
5. Secular man essentially hired by Indian insurance company (4)
6. A child shares no snack (5)
8. Daily in Paris, one avoids drink (2,5)
12. Extremely unusual silence surrounds labour camp (5)
14. Where a pedicurist should focus, being alert? (2,4,4)
16. See 13A
17. I'm prone casually after consuming heroin and another drug (8)
21. Least bothered about reading notifications? (6)
22. Friendly dogs love chilling (2,3)
24. Out to kill, for the most part (4)
25. Tongue, by itself, has no trace of pathology (4)

SUDOKU

	8					2		
3							5	1
	2		3	7	6			
4			6	9			7	2
				5				
8	6			1	2			5
			5	2	4		9	
2	5							6
		4					2	

DIFFICULTY RATING: ★★★★★

No. SS7060 Distribution: www.knightfeatures.com

Solution to previous puzzle

C	O	P	I	N	G		S	O	F	T	C	O	P	Y
	G		N		A		E		O		I		E	
C	R	E	D	I	T	O	R		R	E	V	E	R	E
	E		U		E		V		B		E		I	
			C	L	A	R	I	N	E	T	T	I	S	T
	H		T		U		C		A				H	
T	A	X	I				E	U	R	O	S	T	A	R
	R		V		T		I		S		T		B	
A	D	H	E	S	I	O	N				A	L	L	Y
	P				N		D		P		T		E	
H	A	U	T	E	C	O	U	T	U	R	E			
	L		A		T		S		T		W		A	
N	A	S	S	A	U		T	E	S	T	I	E	S	T
	T		T		R		R		C		D		I	
S	E	V	E	R	E	L	Y		H	E	E	H	A	W

Solution to yesterday's Sudoku

7	6	9	1	2	3	5	8	4
8	1	4	5	9	6	3	7	2
3	2	5	8	7	4	1	6	9
1	8	2	3	4	7	9	5	6
9	4	7	6	5	1	8	2	3
5	3	6	9	8	2	7	4	1
6	7	3	4	1	8	2	9	5
2	9	1	7	6	5	4	3	8
4	5	8	2	3	9	6	1	7

FAITH

Chhath Puja

In Vedic cosmology, the powers of nature were venerated as energies that sustain life and grant wisdom and benediction. This signifies the relationship between nature and culture, said Prof. Kumool Abbi.

The festival of Chhath Puja, primarily dedicated to the Sun god, has a special significance in the States of Bihar, Uttar Pradesh, Jharkhand, West Bengal, and countries such as Nepal.

Chhath Puja falls on the sixth day of Kartik Shukla Paksha in the Sashti Tithi as per the Hindu calendar. It is a festival observed for four days. Along with the Sun, the Goddess worshipped on this occasion is known as Chhathi Maiya, mentioned also as Usha, His divine consort, in the Vedas. The magnanimous Sun god and Chhathi Maiya are worshipped for prosperity, abundance, longevity, fertility, health, well-being, and the protection of children.

This festival reveres the Sun god in a spirit of thanksgiving and gratitude. It is also linked ecologically to the agricultural calendar, by seeking the divine to bequeath a good winter (kharif) harvest.

These rituals date back to the hoary hymns of the Rig Veda, worshipping the Sun as a source of illumination, knowledge, wisdom and sustenance.

Sun worship is also narrated in the *Ramayana*. The epic says Lord Rama and Sita together worshipped the Sun god. Sita observed a fast in the month of Kartik, during their coronation after returning to Ayodhya post the 14 years spent in exile. In the *Mahabharata*, Draupadi and the Pandavas performed the ritual of Chhath puja on the recommendation of the noble sage Daumya.

INBRIEF



BYD brings luxury electric brand Denza into India

Chinese EV major BYD has introduced its luxury electric brand Denza in India with the launch of two models – D9, a luxury multi-purpose vehicle (MPV) starting at an ex-showroom price of ₹90 lakh, and Z9 GT, a sports car, starting ₹1.57 crore, ex-showroom. The company will have dedicated showrooms for the Denza brand in six cities namely Mumbai, Gurugram, Ahmedabad, Bengaluru, Chennai and Hyderabad. Bookings are open at a down payment of ₹10 lakh.

Stock markets snap three-day rally on policy rate hike fears

Benchmark indices Sensex and Nifty ended lower on Friday, snapping a three-day rally amid expectations of an RBI policy rate hike next month after retail inflation surged to 6.09% in October. Sensex dropped 318.56 points, or 0.39%, to settle at 81,592.45. During the day, it tumbled 622.26 points, or 0.75%, to 81,288.75. NSE Nifty closed 155.05 points, or 0.61%, lower at 25,144.30. This is the first major decline for both benchmark indices this month. PTI

India's forex reserves jump $2.49 billion to $719.547 billion

India's forex reserves increased by $2.49 billion to $719.547 billion during the week ended November 6, according to RBI data released on Friday. The reserves had touched an all-time high of $785.706 billion during the week ended September 4, driven by a heavy flow of currency as part of a special concessional swap for deposits from the diaspora through which banks raised a record $133 billion, but had been on a decline ever since. PTI

Tata feud: Venu, Vijay Singh hit back at Khambata

Press Trust of India
NEW DELHI

Tata Trusts Vice-Chairmen Venu Srinivasan and Vijay Singh have launched a strong rebuttal to fellow trustee Darius Khambata's criticism of the Tata Sons board's September 17 decisions, accusing him of presenting an incomplete account of the dispute.

In a five-page letter dated November 11, Mr. Srinivasan and Mr. Singh challenged Mr. Khambata's arguments on the Reserve Bank of India's (RBI) regulatory position, the proposed listing of Tata Sons, the fiduciary responsibilities of Trust nominees, and the circumstances surrounding the reappointment of Chairman N. Chandrasekaran.

Tata Sons turns down Noel's request for board meet clips

The Tata Trusts Chairman had sought an audio-video recording of the Sept. 17 proceedings in which N. Chandrasekaran was reappointed as chairman of the conglomerate's holding company

Press Trust of India
MUMBAI

Tata Sons has rejected Tata Trusts Chairman Noel Tata's request for sharing an audio-video recording of proceedings of a board meeting held on September 17 in which N Chandrasekaran was reappointed as the chairman of the largest conglomerate's holding company.

Mr. Noel, the only dissenter on the vote for the reappointment, had sought the recordings through a series of communications to Tata Sons since the board meeting, which brought out the differences between the top echelons of the salt-to-software group, with the management of Tata Sons on one side and its biggest shareholder on the other.



The company has never had a practice of sharing audio/video recording of in-person meeting, read a communication. REUTERS

"Video recording is mandated when one or more Directors attend online. Company has never in the past had a practice of sharing audio/ video recording of in-person meeting," Tata Sons' company secretary Suprakash Mukhopadhyay wrote to Tata Trusts on November 9.

The recording is not required to be either retained or shared with anybody, including directors, the letter reads.

Emails sent to Tata Sons and Tata Trusts went unanswered.

The November 9 communication also said that draft minutes of the meeting were uploaded on the board's app on October 1, and the "required changes" have been carried out in the minutes after receipt of a reply on October 8.

A copy of the amended minutes will be uploaded on the app, and the directors can raise issues on the same when they are placed before the board for confirmation at its next meeting.

Paytm gets RBI's nod to revive wallet business

Gowri Lakshmi
MUMBAI

One97 Communications, the parent company of Paytm Payments Services Ltd., on Friday said it had received in-principle approval from the RBI to operate prepaid payment instruments (PPIs), paving the way for a possible revival of its wallet business.

PPIs allow users to store money in advance in digital wallets and use it to purchase goods and services, transfer funds and make remittances. During Q1 of FY27, the company had disclosed that it had applied for a full-fledged PPI licence. However, it will have to meet the conditions prescribed by the central bank before securing final authorisation.

Mittal says India should retain control over satellite 'Kill Switch'

Press Trust of India
NEW DELHI

Bharti Airtel founder and chairman Sunil Bharti Mittal has called for India to retain control over the "kill switch" for satellite communications operating in the country, warning against dependence on a single foreign provider as the government weighs security conditions for the launch of satellite broadband services.

"The kill switch, as we call it, should not be sitting somewhere else. India must have control over its own space destiny," Mr. Mittal said in an interview with PTI marking the 50th anniversary of Bharti Enterprises.

His remarks come amid an increasingly public contest between satellite operators seeking access to India's potentially vast market, with Elon Musk's Starlink and Bharti-backed Eutelsat OneWeb awaiting regulatory clearances to begin commercial operations.

The comments also acquire significance against the backdrop of a growing dispute over Starlink's entry into India.

Mr. Mittal said OneWeb's ground infrastructure had been ready for three years and its satellites had been hovering over India for five years, but the company was still awaiting the government's signal to begin commercial services.

PV wholesales cross 5 lakh units in October, jump 12% YoY: SIAM

Lalatendu Mishra
MUMBAI

Domestic passenger vehicle (PV) wholesales crossed the 5-lakh milestone for the first time in October, reaching a record 5.19 lakh units, up 12.4% from the corresponding month last year, according to data released by the Society of Indian Automobile Manufacturers (SIAM).

Two-wheeler wholesales rose 16.1% YoY to 25.78 lakh units, while three-wheeler dispatches grew 25.7% to 1.03 lakh units during the month.


Two-wheeler wholesales rose 16.1% YoY to 25.78 lakh units

"The Indian automobile industry continues to witness healthy demand momentum," said SIAM Director General Rajesh Menon.

"In the two-wheeler segment, demand continues to be supported by improved credit availability and replacement demand, across both rural and urban markets. For three-wheelers, last-mile mobility requirements and rapid electrification remain strong structural drivers. Overall, the demand outlook remains positive," Mr. Menon added.

'Oil India on track to achieve 4 MMT of crude oil output'

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Oil India is confident of achieving crude oil output target of 4 million metric tonne (MMT) in FY27, with production expected to rise further in succeeding years, company officials said during an analyst call.

"The point is we are on a path to four and are very confident we will achieve [the same] this year. Our internal targets are a little bit more, but we are targeting four and are on that path," officials said.

The State-owned oil and gas explorer is also expecting a modest rise in natural gas output in FY27. However, a significant boost is anticipated after commissioning the Duliajan feeder line in about 18-20 months.


Stepping on gas: The oil and gas explorer is also expecting a modest rise in natural gas output in FY27. COMPANY WEBSITE

Meanwhile, Numaligarh Refinery, a material subsidiary, is eyeing ₹6,000 crore capex in FY28 as it moves towards completing ongoing projects.

Capex goal

For FY27, the refinery is on track to achieve capex target of ₹7,500 crore. In an interaction with *The Hindu* in May, Ranjith Rath, Oil India chief, mentioned the Duliajan feeder line would allow for more gas to be evacuated.

He mentioned output would get a major boost, thus, addressing an imperative infrastructural need.

He explained the feeder line would also help evacuate more gas out of associated wells viz wells where oil and gas are present.

Copper prices slip amid U.S. rate hike fear, less AI need

Saptaparno Ghosh
NEW DELHI

Global benchmark prices of copper slid to an almost nearly four-month low Friday amid expectations of U.S. Fed raising interest rates and lower demand especially from China and the technology industry.

At the time of writing, copper was trading about 1.8% lower than the previous day's close at $13,461.99 per tonne.

"The fall in copper prices is mainly due to stronger U.S. dollar, expectations of higher U.S. interest rates and concerns over weaker industrial demand, particularly from China," Federation of Indian Mineral Industries told *The Hindu*.

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA **CORRIGENDUM**

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PUBLIC NOTICE

This is to inform to public at large that Sri Himanshu Singh (841315), Officer on Probation, Canara Bank, Son of Sri Brahmpal Singh, residing at Shop no: 6, Block Market, Delhi Meerut Road, Muradnagar, Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh - 201206, is presently posted as a Probationary Officer at Canara Bank, Kallidaikuruchi branch (1106), Madurai Circle, with effect from 24.08.2024. Sri Himanshu Singh (841315), has been unauthorizedly absent from duty since 24.08.2024 without any prior intimation or approval of leave from the competent authority. In this regard, Sri Himanshu Singh (841315) was earlier advised to report through the following communications : **1)** HRWPM : 2024 : NR:841315:1: NRP:NTC:1 dated 04.09.2024, **2)** HRWPM : 2024 : NR: 841315 : 1: NRP : NTC:2 dated 30.09.2024, **3)** HRWPM : 2024: NR:841315: 1: NRP : NTC:3 dated 07.10.2024, **4)** MDUC : HRM : 841315 : 2024 dated 18.12.2024, **5)** MDUC : HRM : 841315 : 2025 dated 31.01.2025, **6)** MDUC : HRM : 201 : 2025 dated 02.08.2025. Through the above communications, Sri Himanshu Singh (841315) was advised to report for duty at his present branch/office within 7 working days from the date of the respective communication. However, despite the above communications, Sri Himanshu Singh (841315) has neither reported for duty at the branch/office nor submitted any explanation for his continued absence. Through this notice, Canara Bank is providing Sri Himanshu Singh (841315) with one more opportunity to report for duty at his branch/office within 15 days from the date of publication of this notice. Failing this, it will be presumed that he has voluntarily abandoned his services, and he himself shall be held responsible for the consequences thereof.

Authorised Signatory, Canara Bank

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PUBLIC NOTICE
REDUCTION IN MRP

To all dealers, retailers & consumers: as per **NPPA Order S.O. 5690(E) dt. 17.10.2026** , MRP **reduced w.e.f. 09.11.2026** (incl. of all taxes):

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KPMG to tap $40-bn India sport potential

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

KPMG in India opened Sports Technology Hub, a platform designed to help sports organisations in the country accelerate digital transformation, unlock new growth opportunities and build future-ready sporting ecosystems.

This is expected to bring together emerging technologies, industry expertise, and practical use cases to address evolving business and operational challenges in the sports industry.

"Fragmented data, legacy infrastructure, operational inefficiencies and rising expectations for personalised experiences continue to hinder innovation." The Sports Technology Hub in Bengaluru aims to address these challenges through practical solutions that sports organisations can evaluate and adopt, KPMG said.



The hub will tackle challenges through practical solutions.

CCPA fines Ola ₹10 lakh for pre-ride 'tip'

Press Trust of India
NEW DELHI

The Central Consumer Protection Authority (CCPA) imposed a penalty of ₹10 lakh on ANI Technologies Private Ltd., which operates ride-hailing platform Ola, for soliciting additional payments from customers before their journeys were completed.

The regulator said the pre-ride 'tip' or 'add-on' feature misled consumers, amounted to an unfair trade practice and employed a dark pattern.

The order, passed by Chief Commissioner Nidhi Khare and Commissioner Anupam Mishra, directed Ola to discontinue the practice immediately.



The pre-ride 'tip' employed a dark pattern, the CCPA said

The company has been asked to ensure strict compliance with the Consumer Protection Act, 2019, the Dark Patterns Guidelines, 2023, and the Guidelines for Prevention of Misleading Advertisements and Endorsements for Misleading Advertisements, 2022.

DAMASCUS

Syria removes visa restrictions on U.S. travellers after backlash



AFP

Syria has lifted restrictions on the entry of U.S. citizens imposed several days ago, after the limits sparked uproar online. The current Syrian government, in place since Islamist-led fighters overthrew Bashar al-Assad in December 2024, has allowed Westerners to obtain entry visas at Damascus airport or border crossings. AFP

MOSCOW

Ukraine fires almost 1,200 drones at Russian targets, kills at least four



AP

Ukraine fired almost 1,200 drones at Russian targets overnight in one of its biggest aerial attacks since Moscow's invasion nearly five years ago. An attack on an industrial facility in the central Russian region of Samara killed four people on Friday, the regional governor said, without providing further details. AFP

JERUSALEM

Eisenkot calls for respect for Arab minority after right-wing attacks



AFP

Israeli Prime Ministerial hopeful Gadi Eisenkot called on Friday for respect for the country's Arab minority after caretaker premier Benjamin Netanyahu and other right-wing figures sought to delegitimise the community's lawmakers by linking them to Hamas. "Arab citizens of Israel are an integral part of the Israeli story." AFP

ISTANBUL

Turkiye, Qatar sign mutual defence agreement to further regional ties



REUTERS

Turkiye and Qatar signed a mutual defence agreement on Friday that President Recep Tayyip Erdogan said would further strengthen ties between the regional allies and "prevent the resurgence of war in the Gulf region", his office said. Mr. Erdogan met Qatari Emir Sheikh Tamim bin Hamad Al Thani in Istanbul. AFP

Iran's IRGC claims it targeted a U.S. radar in Bahrain in retaliatory strike

U.S. Central Command denies the radar was destroyed, and says it intercepted two one-way drones; while Tehran says the Strait of Hormuz is closed, U.S. claims it has opened a southern route for commercial vessels to exit and enter the waters

Stanly Johny



Stern warning: The Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps has warned of a 'borderless confrontation' if violations continue. REUTERS

The Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps (IRGC) on Friday said it had "destroyed" a U.S. military early-warning radar in Bahrain, in retaliation for a U.S. strike on a telecommunications tower in Sirik, southern Iran.

"An hour ago, in response to the enemy's air attack on a telecommunications tower in Sirik, the IRGC's aerospace fighters targeted and destroyed the early-warning radar of the American aggressors on the island of Bahrain," the IRGC said in its statement.

It added that the attack was "a serious warning to the aggressor enemy to end air mischief and oil smuggling in the Strait of Hormuz".

Several hours later, the U.S. military's Central Command denied that the radar had been destroyed and said it intercepted two "one-way attack drones" launched at Bahrain by the Guards.

The U.S. military in recent days had carried out limited air strikes on Qeshm island and other parts of southern Iran near the strait, which it said were "defensive in nature".

October saw a record spike in maritime attacks in the Strait of Hormuz with nearly three dozen tankers being hit. The IRGC says the strait is closed, while the U.S. Navy claims that it has opened a southern route for commercial vessels to exit and enter the critical waterway, while maintaining its "ironclad blockade" of Iranian ports. In the first week of November, at least six vessels came under attack in the strait, according to the UKMTO. The U.S. says its strikes in southern Iran were aimed at neutralising the threats the IRGC posed to maritime traffic.

"In case of repeated violations and aggressions, the IRGC's air force is on full alert for borderless confrontation," the Guards said.

Iran's chief of the general staff Maj. Gen. Ali Abdollahi said any miscalculation by the U.S. and Israel will be met with "devastating strikes". "We warn the United States and the Zionist regime once again that the previous slaps were only the beginning of the story, and in the event of any new miscalculation, far more lethal blows await them," he stated.

China stages unannounced Pacific drills around Taiwan

Reuters
TAIPEI



A Taiwanese coast guard ship monitoring a Chinese coast guard ship off Taiwan's northeastern coast. AFP/FILE PHOTO

China carried out a large, unannounced military exercise across the western Pacific and around Taiwan in early November, in what officials in Taipei have described as a campaign of "silent intimidation" aimed at pressuring Taiwan and other governments before major international meetings.

A senior Taiwan security official, speaking on condition of anonymity due to the sensitivity of the matter, said China's military and coast guard had at one point massed more than 100 vessels in the region early this month, conducting drills that included simulated attacks on other militaries and cities including Taiwan's.

The naval deployment was larger than "Justice Mission 2025", China's last formally named drills targeting Taiwan nearly a year ago and one of the largest Chinese naval deployments to date, the official said.

The drills come as China, which views democratically governed Taiwan as its own territory, has stepped up its military pressure over the past five years, drawing condemnation from Taipei and heightening concern in Western capitals about the potential for conflict.

Chinese President Xi Jinping on Thursday gave a major policy speech about Taiwan, urging peaceful "reunification" though making no mention of using force.

Pakistan calls for end to Houthi attacks on Saudi Arabia at UN

Press Trust of India
UNITED NATIONS

Pakistan has called for the "immediate and unconditional" cessation of Houthi attacks on Saudi Arabia as the UN Security Council renewed targeted sanctions under its Yemen sanctions regime for another year.

The Security Council unanimously adopted the resolution on Thursday.

According to a report in *Dawn*, Pakistan's Permanent Representative to the UN Ambassador Syed Haider Shah, while explaining his country's vote in favour of the resolution, said that Islamabad "condemns in the strongest terms" the continued Houthi attacks against Saudi Arabia.

'Resolute support'

"We stand in full and unwavering solidarity with the leadership, government and brotherly people of Saudi Arabia. Our support for the kingdom's sovereignty, territorial integrity, security and stability is resolute," Mr. Shah said.

Pakistan's Army says it killed 74 militants in raids on their hideouts; car bomb kills 5

Associated Press
ISLAMABAD



The raids were carried out in the Mir Ali and Orakzai districts in Khyber Pakhtunkhwa province. AFP

Pakistani security forces have killed 74 militants in multiple raids on hideouts in the northwest and southwestern regions bordering Afghanistan over the past 10 days, the military said on Friday.

The raids were carried out in the Mir Ali and Orakzai districts in Khyber Pakhtunkhwa province, the military said in a statement. Troops killed 43 militants and seized weapons, ammunition and explosive devices, the statement said. Separately, troops killed 31 militants in multiple operations in Balochistan province, the site of a bloody insurgency led by the outlawed Baloch Liberation Army, since November 3, the military said. It alleged the militants were backed by Afghanistan and India. Kabul and New Delhi have previously denied such allegations.

President Asif Ali Zardari and Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif vowed to continue the fight against militancy.

Meanwhile, five people were killed and 13 injured in a car bombing at a security checkpoint in Pakistan's Balochistan province, a security official said.

The attack took place on Thursday in the Kandawa area of Mastung district. The banned Baloch Liberation Army claimed responsibility for the attack.

China's access to Nvidia chips in doubt as curbs gain traction

Reuters
WASHINGTON

U.S. House Speaker Mike Johnson said on Thursday there was growing consensus in Congress on limiting chip exports to China after a spy scandal forced out Nvidia CEO Jensen Huang.

Lawmakers from both parties have since called for tougher restrictions on China's access to advanced AI chips, threatening access to chips that underpin China's surging AI development.

"The export controls on chips to China has been a big issue around here," Johnson, a Louisiana Republican, told reporters at the U.S. Capitol, adding he favoured limiting China's access to the advanced technology. "I think there's a developing consensus in Congress that is an important position to take."

The case has revived claims among China critics in Washington that U.S. export policies are too weak, boosting calls for more restrictions.

Sport

Pegula in semifinal; Gauff exits

WTA FINALS

Agence France-Presse
LOS ANGELES



Powering ahead: Pegula held her nerve at the crunch. REUTERS

Jessica Pegula saved a match point on the way to a three-set victory over Linda Noskova on Thursday, booking a last-four spot in the WTA Finals, while Coco Gauff was eliminated.

Fifth-ranked American Pegula fired a career-high 16 aces to come up with a 7-6(2), 4-6, 7-5 triumph in the must-win match against Noskova.

Her victory, in the final group one round-robin match, meant World No. 4 Gauff was eliminated from the season-ending event despite her gritty 6-4, 7-5 win over Marta Kostyuk.

"Linda is such a great player," Pegula said. "Every time we have played, if you see the scoreline of our past matches, it is literally the same match every time... I knew I was going to get my chances."

Noskova had already secured her semifinal spot with a pair of round-robin wins and she was on the brink of finishing with a perfect group record with a match point at 5-4 in the third set. But Pegula escaped, firing an ace on game point, and broke Noskova in the next game. She closed out the win on her first match point.

Andreeva up next

Pegula finished second in the group behind Noskova and will face group two winner Mirra Andreeva on Saturday.

India faces Pakistan's might in title clash

U-19 ASIA CUP

Press Trust of India
AL AMERAT



India will eye a revenge. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

India will be keen to deliver an all-round performance as it bids to reclaim the under-19 Asia Cup crown in the clash against defending champion Pakistan here on Saturday.

Pakistan had beaten India by 151 runs last year for its second title while the boys in blue will hunt for a record-extending ninth trophy. The form of Aaryavir Sehwag should give the Lakshya Raichandani-led side confidence: the opener has amassed 303 runs from four matches – it includes a century and two half-centuries – at an average of 101. On the bowling front, Ishan Sood has used his pace to good effect and taken 11 wickets.

For Pakistan, Usman Khan (238 runs) and pacer Rizwanullah (11 wickets) are the top performers while Hamza Zahoor, who hit an unbeaten ton in the win against India earlier in the competition, will be eager to repeat that effort.

England through; Italy beats France

NATIONS LEAGUE

Agence France-Presse
PARIS



Double delight: England's Kane marked his record-breaking 126th appearance with a goal. AP

England secured its place in the Nations League quarterfinals with a 2-1 victory over Croatia on Thursday while Zinedine Zidane suffered his first defeat as France coach as his side lost 1-3 away to Italy.

Harry Kane marked his record-breaking 126th appearance for England by scoring the winning goal from the penalty spot at Wembley, taking his tally to 92 goals. With the victory, Thomas Tuchel's side moved to 12 points from five matches in Group A3.

Spain is top with 15 points after a 2-0 win over the Czechia in Prague.

Meanwhile, France was without Kylian Mbappe and Ousmane Dembele due to injury but Michael Olise pounced on a loose pass from Gianluigi Donnarumma to fire it ahead.

Francesco Pio Esposito steered in Nicolo Cambiaghi's pass to bring Italy level while Davide Frattesi powered home Federico Dimarco's cut-back.

Francesco Pio Esposito doubled his tally for the night in the second half.

The results:

Group A1: Turkiye 1 (Guler 20) lost to Belgium 2 (De Bruyne 27, De Ketelaere 30); Italy 3 (Esposito 26, 75-pen, Frattesi 63) bt France 1 (Olise 10).

A3: Czech Republic 0 lost to Spain 2 (Baena 39-pen, Pubill 90+6); England 2 (Rogers 24, Kane 64-pen) bt Croatia 1 (Sucic 59).

C1: Albania 2 (Muci 35, Manaj 50) bt Finland 0; San Marino 0 lost to Belarus 2 (Gomanov 13, Kontsevoi 17).

Invictus again: South Africa's cinematic rise to the Test summit



South Africa has had some great Test sides and has produced outstanding batters, fearsome fast bowlers, gifted all-rounders, and Jonty Rhodes

The Proteas, under Temba Bavuma and Shukri Conrad, hold both the World Test Championship and the No. 1 ranking — a position of affairs that seemed unimaginable in 2024 when a second-string side, a compromise because of the SA20's emergence, was thrashed by New Zealand

P.K. Ajith Kumar

Invictus must be one of the greatest films about sport. Because it is about much more than sport. It is about how Nelson Mandela saw the 1995 Rugby World Cup as an opportunity to unite a country where apartheid had only recently ended.

South Africa was hosting that World Cup. Mandela, the first black president of the country, was concerned that people of colour were not supporting the predominantly white Springboks ahead of the tournament. Morgan Freeman, one of the finest actors of our time, brought Mandela to life, while Matt Damon excelled as Springboks captain Francois Pienaar in the superbly crafted film directed by Clint Eastwood.

The opening scene

South Africa's ascent to the top of the Test rankings, following the series win against Australia a fortnight ago, has been a bit cinematic, too. The opening scene could well have been the circumstances relating to the selection of the South African team for the tour of New Zealand in early 2024.

India was touring South Africa at the time. The Proteas squad for the New Zealand series was announced after the innings victory in the first Test at Centurion. Only two players from that team, David Bedingham and Keegan Petersen, were booked on the flight to New Zealand. There were eight uncapped players, including the captain Neil Brand. That was because the senior players were contracted to feature in the SA20, South Africa's premier franchise league.

Bavuma has led this team from the front. Remarkably, under him, South Africa has won 13 out of 15 Tests

This was inevitably a topic when this writer met South Africa's coach Shukri Conrad for an interview ahead of the second Test at the magnificent Newlands ground in Cape Town. He was blunt. "We understand as cricketers that the SA20 league is hugely important," he said. "It brings in revenue, so that we can have more Test cricket in the future. But there could be a silver lining. And we might surprise a few people there."

They didn't surprise anyone. The South Africans lost the first Test by 281 runs and the second by seven wickets.

But, they haven't lost a series since. They won against the West Indies, Bangladesh, Sri Lanka, Zimbabwe, India and now Australia. The two-match series in Pakistan last year was drawn. The loss in Lahore was the only one until the 214-run defeat to Australia in the opening Test at Durban.

And yes, they also won the World Test Championship, beating Australia by five wickets at Lord's last year. And they lost the 'chokers' tag, as Aiden Markram and captain Temba Bavuma starred in the chase of 282, against the world's most prolific bowling attack of all time.

Not everyone was appreciative of South Africa's entry to the final, though. Former England captain Michael Vaughan claimed it reached the title clash on "the back of beating pretty much nobody". Kerry O'Keeffe, former Australian leg-spinner turned colourful commentator, was, well, more colourful in his criticism. He said South Africa's campaign was "like making the Wimbledon final without playing a seed on the way".

Conrad, however, begged to differ. "I am never going to apologise for getting into the final," he said. "It is the biggest thing for South African cricket at the moment."



GETTY IMAGES

TEMBA BAVUMA

SHUKRI CONRAD

Proving a point

Conrad's boys have since gone on to show that they can compete with, and beat, the top seeds. Winning both the Tests in India last year and now beating Australia in the three-match series after losing the first Test, they have proven a point or two. It is no fault of theirs that they do not meet the big three more regularly or do not play in series that have more than three Tests.

That is a pity, really. South Africa has had some great Test sides and has produced outstanding batters, fearsome fast bowlers, gifted all-rounders, and Jonty Rhodes. Some of the country's, and the world's, best talents, like Barry Richards, Graeme Pollock, Mike Procter and Garth Le Roux, were lost to the apartheid-era ban. South Africa played no international cricket between 1970 and 1990.

Not surprisingly, many South Africans moved to other countries and did well. There have been players like Tony Greig, Kepler Wessels, Allan Lamb, the Smith brothers Chris and Robin, Jonathan Trott, Devon Conway and Kevin Pietersen, who shifted his base to England after Ali Bacher, the then managing director of the United Cricket Board of South Africa, said that provincial teams would not field all-white sides.

South Africa may have lost some of its best players, but it has always unearthed exceptional talents like Jacques Kallis, A.B. de Villiers, Dale Steyn, Allan Donald, Graeme Smith, Shaun Pollock, Makhaya Ntini, Hashim Amla, Mark Boucher, Vernon Philander and Quinton de Kock.

South Africa had become the No. 1 Test team for the first time in 2012, and retained that ranking for 21 months till Australia took over. That side was led by Smith and featured players like Kallis, de Villiers, Amla, Steyn, Philander, Faf du Plessis and Morne Morkel.

Bavuma's team may not boast as many big stars, but in Kagiso Rabada it has an all-time great fast bowler. The world's No. 1 all-rounder (and No. 2 bowler) at the moment is his teammate Marco Jansen. The bowler who took 10 Australian wickets in the third Test is Simon Harmer, who had taken 17 wickets in the two Tests in India.

And it was centuries from Ryan Rickelton and Wiaan Mulder, coming in at No. 6 and No. 7, that ensured enough runs on the board for South Africa in the second innings. This South African side deserves to be the Word No. 1.

Bavuma has led this team from the front, too. Remarkably, under him, South Africa has won 13 out of 15 Tests. That the Rainbow Nation has achieved cricketing glory with two men of colour, Bavuma and Conrad, at the helm is significant.

Beating the odds

To go back to *Invictus* and the 1995 Rugby World Cup: South Africa beat the odds, and strong favourite New Zealand in the final, to lift the trophy at Johannesburg's Ellis Park Stadium in front of a crowd of 60,000, among whom was Mandela, wearing the No. 6 jersey (of Pienaar). That remains one of South African sport's greatest moments.

Martin Meredith wrote in his acclaimed biography of Mandela: "Never before had blacks had cause to show such pride in the efforts of their white countrymen. It was a moment of national fusion that Mandela had done much to inspire."

Winning the WTC and regaining the No. 1 ranking in Tests should also matter a lot for a country that takes pride in sporting achievements and culture, and that has loved its cricket even when it had, for a couple of decades, no hopes of playing an international game.

STACKING UP

ATP Men's Top 15

#	Player	Age	Points	Events
1	Alexander Zverev	29	9,550	20
2	Jannik Sinner	25	9,450	17
3	Carlos Alcaraz	23	7,100	18
4	Ben Shelton	24	5,170	22
5	Daniil Medvedev	30	3,820	24
6	Flavio Cobolli	24	3,680	25
7	Arthur Fils	22	3,625	20
8	Frances Tiafoe	28	3,390	23
9	Alex de Minaur	27	3,370	24
10	Taylor Fritz	29	3,285	23
11	Rafael Jodar	20	3,234	21
12	Novak Djokovic	39	2,940	15
13	Tommy Paul	29	2,925	23
14	F. Auger-Aliassime	26	2,865	21
15	Jiri Lehecka	25	2,540	22

Top Indians ▶



Sumit Nagal
Rank 264 ▲ 1 spot



Karan Singh
Rank 355 ▼ 1 spot

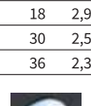
WTA Women's Top 15

#	Player	Age	Points	Events
1	Elena Rybakina	27	8,099	20
2	Aryna Sabalenka	28	6,485	20
3	Mirra Andreeva	19	6,306	20
4	Coco Gauff	22	5,763	20
5	Jessica Pegula	32	5,760	20
6	Elina Svitolina	32	5,121	20
7	Karolina Muchova	30	4,665	20
8	Linda Noskova	21	4,343	20
9	Iga Swiatek	25	4,188	19
10	Marta Kostyuk	24	3,910	20
11	Diana Shnaider	22	3,238	23
12	Maja Chwalinska	25	3,016	23
13	Iva Jovic	18	2,941	23
14	Elise Mertens	30	2,540	23
15	Sorana Cirstea	36	2,386	22

Top Indians ▶



Vaishnavi Adkar
Rank 344 ▼ 10 spots



Vaidehee Chaudhari
Rank 392 ▲ 21 spots

English Premier League Standings

#	Team	GP	W	D	L	GF	GA	GD	PTS
1	Arsenal	10	9	0	1	15	5	10	27
2	Brighton	10	7	1	2	26	7	19	22
3	Man. City	10	7	0	3	21	13	8	21
4	Liverpool	10	5	3	2	14	10	4	18
5	Chelsea	10	5	1	4	19	16	3	16
6	Everton	10	4	4	2	12	10	2	16
7	Bournemouth	10	4	3	3	16	14	2	15
8	Brentford	10	3	5	2	16	11	5	14
9	Leeds United	10	3	5	2	10	8	2	14
10	Aston Villa	10	3	4	3	14	17	-3	13
11	Tottenham	10	3	3	4	10	11	-1	12
12	Newcastle	10	3	3	4	13	16	-3	12
13	Hull City	10	2	5	3	11	11	0	11
14	Ipswich Town	10	3	2	5	15	20	-5	11
15	Fulham	10	2	4	4	10	12	-2	10
16	N. Forest	10	2	3	5	9	13	-4	9
17	Coventry City	10	3	0	7	10	19	-9	9
18	Man. United	10	1	5	4	14	19	-5	8
19	Sunderland	10	2	2	6	8	17	-9	8
20	Crystal Palace	10	2	1	7	10	24	-14	7

Italian Serie A Standings

#	Team	GP	W	D	L	GF	GA	GD	PTS
1	Lazio	11	9	2	0	25	9	16	29
2	Inter Milan	11	9	1	1	28	13	15	28
3	Roma	11	8	3	0	31	10	21	27
4	AC Milan	11	7	3	1	23	13	10	24
5	Como	11	7	2	2	18	10	8	23
6	Frosinone	11	6	2	3	24	15	9	20
7	Juventus	11	5	3	3	15	12	3	18
8	Bologna	11	5	2	4	16	14	2	17
9	Cagliari	11	5	1	5	10	15	-5	16
10	Napoli	11	4	3	4	18	14	4	15
11	Torino	11	4	2	5	15	17	-2	14
12	Atalanta	11	4	2	5	17	20	-3	14
13	Genoa	11	4	1	6	11	16	-5	13
14	Lecce	11	3	1	7	12	22	-10	10
15	Fiorentina	11	2	3	6	17	25	-8	9
16	Parma	11	2	2	7	9	17	-8	8
17	Sassuolo	11	2	2	7	16	29	-13	8
18	Monza	11	2	1	8	17	25	-8	7
19	Venezia	11	2	0	9	8	21	-13	6
20	Udinese	11	1	2	8	12	25	-13	5

Spanish LaLiga Standings

#	Team	GP	W	D	L	GF	GA	GD	PTS
1	Barcelona	12	11	0	1	48	13	35	33
2	Real Madrid	12	10	0	2	31	10	21	30
3	Atletico Madrid	12	9	1	2	23	10	13	28
4	Real Betis	12	8	2	2	20	15	5	26
5	Real Sociedad	12	7	1	4	21	20	1	22
6	Sevilla	12	5	3	4	17	19	-2	18
7	Athletic Club	11	4	4	3	15	11	4	16
8	Villarreal	12	4	3	5	17	15	2	15
9	Deportivo	12	3	6	3	15	14	1	15
10	Racing Santander	12	4	2	6	17	30	-13	14
11	Celta Vigo	12	2	7	3	10	10	0	13
12	Alaves	12	3	4	5	15	17	-2	13
13	Espanyol	12	3	3	6	13	14	-1	12
14	Rayo Vallecano	11	3	3	5	15	21	-6	12
15	Getafe	12	3	3	6	8	18	-10	12
16	Osasuna	12	3	3	6	12	23	-11	12
17	Levante	12	2	5	5	16	21	-5	11
18	Elche	12	2	4	6	14	20	-6	10
19	Valencia	12	2	3	7	8	20	-12	9
20	Malaga	12	0	5	7	9	23	-14	5

German Bundesliga Standings

#	Team	GP	W	D	L	GF	GA	GD	PTS
1	Bayern	9	6	3	0	29	9	20	21
2	Dortmund	9	6	3	0	16	7	9	21
3	SC Freiburg	9	6	1	2	20	10	10	19
4	RB Leipzig	9	6	0	3	27	13	14	18
5	Leverkusen	9	5	1	3	20	17	3	16
6	Werder	9	4	3	2	17	15	2	15
7	Elversberg	9	4	1	4	17	18	-1	13
8	Stuttgart	9	4	0	5	15	15	0	12
9	Hoffenheim	9	4	0	5	16	17	-1	12
10	E. Frankfurt	9	3	3	3	15	20	-5	12
11	Hamburg	9	4	0	5	10	20	-10	12
12	Mainz	9	3	1	5	18	19	-1	10
13	Paderborn	9	2	4	3	8	11	-3	10
14	Augsburg	9	2	3	4	20	20	0	9
15	Cologne	9	2	3	4	10	14	-4	9
16	Union Berlin	9	1	4	4	7	21	-14	7
17	Schalke	9	1	3	5	5	11	-6	6
18	M'gladbach	9	1	1	7	12	25	-13	4

Test Batting

#	Player	Rating	Career best
1	Harry Brook	861	898
2	Joe Root	816	932
3	Travis Head	799	884
4	Temba Bavuma	793	818
5	Steve Smith	790	947
6	Rachin Ravindra	740	740
7	Rahmat Shah	735	735
8	Rishabh Pant	713	801
9	Daryl Mitchell	710	804
10	Shubman Gill	709	807

Test Bowling

#	Player	Rating	Career best
1	Mitchell Starc	881	881
2	Marco Jansen	875	876
3	Matt Henry	861	870
4	Ollie Robinson	856	856
5	Jasprit Bumrah	853	908
6	Scott Boland	821	829
7	Simon Harmer	817	817
8	Pat Cummins	789	914
9	Kagiso Rabada	801	902
10	Josh Hazlewood	785	864

ODI Batting

#	Player	Rating	Career best
1	Shubman Gill	822	855
2	Daryl Mitchell	794	840
3	Virat Kohli	781	908
4	Rohit Sharma	754	879
5	Ibrahim Zadran	752	756
6	Ben Duckett	733	733
7	Shai Hope	710	782
8	Harry Brook	674	693
9	Babar Azam	661	894
10	K.L. Rahul	657	676

ODI Bowling

#	Player	Rating	Career best
1	Rashid Khan	760	775
2	Keshav Maharaj	660	737
3	Abrar Ahmed	642	675
4	Mitchell Santner	621	656
4	Shaheen Afridi	621	691
6	A. Omarzai	610	610
7	Kuldeep Yadav	602	757
8	Mehidy Hasan	597	722
9	Taskin Ahmed	595	595
9	Maheesh Theekshana	595	680

T20I Batting

#	Player	Rating	Career best
1	Abhishek Sharma	889	931
2	Sahibzada Farhan	883	883
3	Ishan Kishan	862	916
4	Harry Brook	793	793
5	Jos Buttler	789	794
5	Dewald Brevis	789	806
7	Shreyas Iyer	777	829
8	Phil Salt	775	881
9	Shai Hope	759	766
10	Pathum Nissanka	720	796

T20I Bowling

#	Player	Rating	Career best
1	Rashid Khan	731	828
2	Adam Zampa	700	746
3	Adil Rashid	695	747
3	Abrar Ahmed	695	757
5	Mitchell Santner	676	735
6	Nathan Ellis	675	678
7	Jamie Overton	674	674
8	Nasum Ahmed	661	661
9	Mahedi Hasan	654	654
10	Liam Dawson	648	652

GETTY IMAGES



The era of Collen: Kebinatshipi chases 400m immortality

The 22-year-old from Botswana followed last year's breakthrough at the World championships with a season of spectacular dominance. The 2027 Worlds, the 2028 Olympics and the one-lap world record are next on the agenda for athletics' rising superstar

Sports Bureau
Agence France-Presse

The 400m is one of the most fascinating events in athletics. Also known as the long sprint, it requires competitors to master every aspect of running, including the speed of the sprinter and the endurance of the half-miler.

The shorter sprints – the 100m and 200m – are tests of pace. The 400m, however, can have variations in how the race is run; athletes have to be aware of their competitors and respond to them. In addition to race strategy, 400m runners also have to put mind over matter in situations few other athletes have to contend with – once the lactic system is overwhelmed, 400m runners must continue sprinting hard despite their bodies urging them to slow down.

The greatest ever

Only truly exceptional athletes dominate the event. Among men, South Africa's Wayde van Niekerk owns the world record (43.03 seconds), Olympic gold (2016) and two World titles (2015 and 2017). American Michael Johnson, a four-time World champion and the only man to win back-to-back Olympic gold medals (1996 and 2000) in the discipline, held the world record for 17 years, and is widely considered the greatest to ever run the 400m.

> Winning Worlds 'early' didn't get in my head. This year was about putting my name up there and showing people who I am and what I'm capable of

Over the last 14 months, an athlete from Botswana has done enough to suggest that he might one day be spoken of in the same hushed tones.

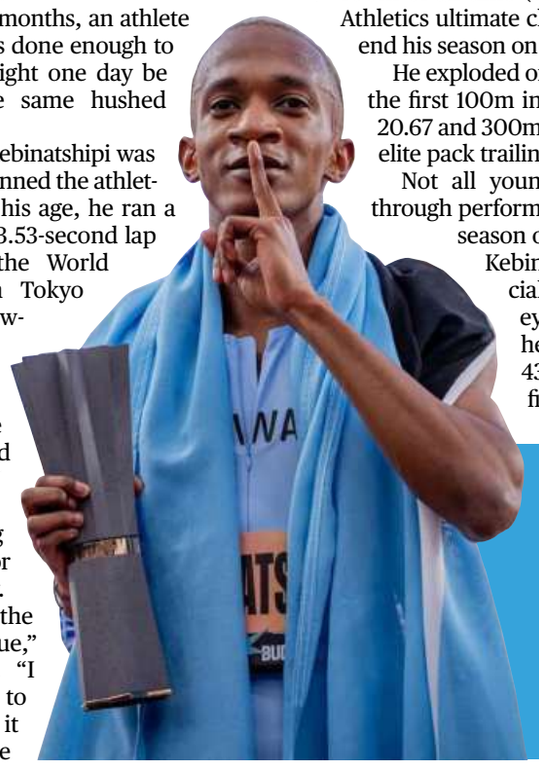
Busang Collen Kebinatshipi was 21 when he first stunned the athletics world: belying his age, he ran a perfectly judged 43.53-second lap to win gold at the World championships in Tokyo last year. He showcased maturity in not getting drawn into the unsustainable pace the early running had set and came off the final bend strongly, driving through the rain for a dominant victory.

"Getting gold is the dream come true," said Kebinatshipi. "I didn't expect it to come so early, but it shows that I'm able to do even more in the coming years."

He certainly has done "even more" in the year since that victory, staying invincible on the Diamond League circuit and running the fifth fastest 400m of all time (43.39) in winning the World Athletics ultimate championship in Budapest to end his season on a triumphant note.

He exploded off the blocks, tearing through the first 100m in 10.61, completing 200m in 20.67 and 300m in a searing 31.37, leaving an elite pack trailing in his wake.

Not all young athletes follow a breakthrough performance at a major event with a season of consistent dominance. But Kebinatshipi is clearly very special. In addition to September's eye-catching run at Budapest, he scorched to an impressive 43.40 in the Diamond League finals in Brussels, having also claimed top spot in Chorzow in August, Monaco and Eugene in July, Paris in June, and Xiamen in May. Six out of six in the Diamond League!



> Obviously [the world record of 43.03] is always running through my mind. If I go like 20.9 for the first 200, and then I go 22.0 or 22.1, it's going to give us a 42.9

The 22-year-old was also in rare form at the World Athletics relays at home in May. In a dream finish to two days of high-octane action in the Botswanan capital of Gaborone, Kebinatshipi came up with the goods in the 4x400m relay.

It was neck-and-neck between Botswana, South Africa and Australia at the final baton handover, but the reigning World champion decided to give his adoring home crowd a moment of magic. He broke free 40 metres from the line to win in a blistering 2min 54.47s, just 18 hundredths of a second slower than the world record set by a US quartet featuring Michael Johnson in 1993.

Built for the big stage

Kebinatshipi had also run a superb last leg in tricky, rain-drenched conditions at last year's World championships to win Botswana a historic 4x400m gold – this is evidently a man made for the biggest of stages and toughest of moments, an athlete supremely comfortable in his skin.

"Trust me," he told World Athletics in an interview after finishing the season. "This was just the start of an era of Collen. My plan is just to dominate for the longest period possible."

Next year's World championships, the Los Angeles Olympics in 2028 and the 400m world record are his three main goals in the near term. "Last year's win [at the Worlds] opened a lot of doors for me, but that was just the beginning, because this year was about putting my name up there and showing people who I am and what I'm capable of," he said.

"Winning Worlds 'early' didn't get in my head. Now, we go back to the drawing board for what we are aiming for – the 2028 Olympics. The world-record talks will be on the table, maybe in LA28. For now, I just want to make sure I stay healthy until the [2027] World championships."

Kebinatshipi isn't merely eyeing van Niekerk's 43.03: his sights are set on the first sub-43 run, even if he admits that there is still work to be done. Having extended his record for the most sub-44-second performances in a single season (six), while breaking the Diamond League record three times along the way, he knows what it takes to chase down a mark.

"Obviously it [the world record] is always running through my mind," said Kebinatshipi. "If I go like 20.9 for the first 200, and then I go 22.0 or 22.1, it's going to give us a 42.9. But with the world record, it hasn't been in our chat with my coach. We've just been discussing that we have to go season-by-season and, when I'm ready to run a good time, I'll push a good time."

The area Kebinatshipi has identified for improvement is the backstretch of the 400m. He describes himself as "still a bit light" and believes greater strength could help unlock his full potential. But his immediate focus is rest and recovery after a long, draining season.

Kebinatshipi blacked out not long after the ultimate championship in Budapest and had to spend several minutes recuperating in a wheelchair. "It's normal," he said. "I know every time I push my body, it's like that. The plan was to give everything, leave everything on the track."

Down time

Kebinatshipi's off-season is being spent on a 10-acre farm at home with his beloved boerboel dogs. "Unfortunately, they are not as fast as I am – they have big muscles and cannot keep up with me," he said. Not many can. It's why he thinks he still has "10, 11 years in this track life".

Having clocked a very impressive 9.89 seconds in the 100m this year, he fancies his chances in other events, too. "If we achieve what we want, run under 43 in the next five years, it'd give us another window to try another event," he said. "Once I accomplish it, in less than five years, I'm going to move to the 200m and after achieving what I want, I can skip again, go to the 800m."

GAME THEORY

Age just a number for Test's golden oldies

In the first Test between Zimbabwe and Afghanistan, which concluded in Sharjah on Monday, first Brendan Taylor and then Craig Ervine became two of the oldest male batters to reach three figures in cricket's classical format. A look at where they rank on the list of Test cricket's oldest century-makers:

Oldest batters to score a Test hundred

Rank	Player	Age	Team	Match start date
1	Jack Hobbs	46y 82d	England	8 Mar 1929
2	Patsy Hendren	45y 151d	England	6 Jul 1934
3	Warren Bardsley	43y 202d	Australia	26 Jun 1926
4	Dave Nourse	42y 291d	South Africa	12 Nov 1921
5	Frank Woolley	42y 61d	England	27 Jul 1929
6	Misbah-ul-Haq	42y 47d	Pakistan	14 Jul 2016
7	Eric Rowan	42y 6d	South Africa	26 Jul 1951
8	Bob Simpson	41y 359d	Australia	28 Jan 1978
9	Warwick Armstrong	41y 265d	Australia	11 Feb 1921
10	Tom Graveney	41y 263d	England	6 Mar 1969
11	Herbie Taylor	41y 241d	South Africa	1 Jan 1931
12	Bert Sutcliffe	41y 108d	New Zealand	5 Mar 1965
13	Craig Ervine	41y 78d	Zimbabwe	5 Nov 2026
14	Geoff Boycott	41y 63d	England	23 Dec 1981
15	Graham Gooch	40y 314d	England	2 Jun 1994
16	Brendan Taylor	40y 272d	Zimbabwe	5 Nov 2026

SOURCE: CRICINFO.COM | AGE AT THE START OF THE TEST (FOR THE LAST/MOST RECENT HUNDRED BY THE PLAYER)


JACK HOBBS


PATSY HENDREN


WARREN BARDSLEY


BRENDAN TAYLOR


CRAIG ERVINE

PICTURE THIS



GETTY IMAGES

Ice-capade

With winter about to make its presence felt in certain parts of the world, athletes of an icy persuasion have begun to anticipate the wonderland it opens up.

Notable among them are daredevil climbers, who seek to conquer a challenge like no other. Ice climbing is an enormously dangerous adventure sport that involves ascending routes made of frozen water. It evolved as a standalone skill from alpine climbing (rock, ice and snow) in the 1970s.

Climbing routes come in a variety of forms, including seasonally frozen waterfalls, high permanently frozen gullies and large hanging icicles. The discipline requires both specialised equipment, including double ice axes, ice tools, rigid crampons and steel ice screws, and rigorous training.

Climbers take care to ensure that the ice stays firm as they ascend, but the risk of the ice breaking is ever present. The seriousness of leading an ice climbing route is considered significantly greater than that of a traditional rock climbing route.

The sport's two major competitions are the World Cup and the World Championships.

BOLT FROM THE BLUE

Shreyas reckons pitch changed drastically in the second innings



AFP

Shreyas Iyer on Friday blamed the change in the pitch for India's 244-run defeat to New Zealand in the fourth ODI, saying it went from a belter to a seaming track. "A tough one, I guess, to take that. There was a huge difference between the wickets between innings," said Shreyas, who captained India in ODIs for the first time.

QUALITY SIDE

We've shown that we can put India under pressure: Henry



AFP

As a bowling unit, we were trying to be relentless. The way we have bowled with the new ball has been fantastic. We have shown that we can take wickets and put India, which is world-class, under pressure. It has the best batting line-up in the world — Matt Henry, New Zealand pacer.

WORRYING SIGNS

Gambhir concerned about India's batting collapses ahead of WC



AFP

You're always concerned when you get bundled out for 90-odd (*sic*). Why won't I be concerned? These are conditions which are going to be closest to what we might get during the World Cup. The bigger concern is not the runs. It's how quickly we got bundled out, around 26 or 27 overs — Gautam Gambhir, India head coach.

MAN IN CHARGE

Manchester United announces Pochettino as new head coach



AP

Manchester United named Mauricio Pochettino as its new head coach on Friday following the dismissal of Michael Carrick. "The club has reached an agreement with the US soccer federation for Mauricio and his staff to be released after conclusion of their responsibilities with the US men's team," the club said.

Young ton, Henry six-for flatten India as Kiwis pull one back

The opening batter makes the visiting side pay dearly for two early drops as the Black Caps rack up 333; the pace spearhead returns career-best figures on his comeback as the Men in Blue get bowled out for 89 in the 27th over

INDIA IN NZ

Agence France-Presse
MOUNT MAUNGANUI

Will Young struck a century and Matt Henry took six wickets as New Zealand thrashed a ragged India by 244 runs in the fourth ODI here on Friday.

Henry removed Rohit Sharma, Virat Kohli and Shreyas Iyer all without scoring in the first over of India's chase to tear the top-order apart with the visitor needing a massive 334 for victory.

New Zealand made 333 after being asked to bat as Young punished two simple drops to bring up his fifth ODI hundred.

India never stood a chance of chasing the total after Henry's heavenly opening over.

Rohit edged his first ball to slip, Kohli was bowled off the fourth ball he faced, and then Shreyas was pegged on his back leg to be trapped in front of the wicket.

India's rebuild never happened, Ishan Kishan top-scoring with just 27 as it was shot out for 89.

Henry ended with six for 27 and Matthew Fisher took three for 31.

New Zealand's imposing total came on the back of Young's 125 from 108 balls, including 14 fours and four sixes. Young and Tim Seifert combined for an 85-run opening partnership.





Home heroes: Young rode his luck en route his fifth ODI hundred while Henry rocked India with a triple strike in the first over. AFP

While Young rode his early luck – dropped twice off successive balls when on five in the second over, first by Rohit at slip and then by wicketkeeper Kishan – Seifert played the aggressor with a brisk 39-ball 50. When Seifert fell for 58 (48b, 6x4, 3x6), Nick Kelly and Dean Foxcroft soon followed playing reckless shots.

Young found better support in Finn Allen, the two putting on 90 runs off just 65 balls as they cashed in on the wayward Indian attack.

Young's first 50 came off 49 balls, and his second from just 39 as he hit regular boundaries through the middle overs.

Allen made 41 from 30 deliveries, including five fours and two sixes.

Axar Patel took two for 39 from 10 overs as India put the brakes on the scoring, while Auqib Nabi had two for 59 and Gurnoor Brar two for 69.

India leads the five-match series 2-1 with the final game to be played at the same venue on Sunday.

SCOREBOARD

NEW ZEALAND
Will Young c sub (Kushagra) b Dhir 125 *(108b, 14x4, 4x6)*, Tim Seifert c Kishan b Gurnoor 58 *(48b, 6x4, 3x6)*, Nick Kelly st. Kishan b Axar 4 *(8b)*, Dean Foxcroft c Gurnoor b Nabi 8 *(13b)*, Finn Allen c Rohit b Axar 41 *(30b, 5x4, 2x6)*, Michael Bracewell c Dhir b Gurnoor 15 *(20b, 1x4)*, Mitchell Santner c Kishan b Arshdeep 24 *(29b, 1x4, 2x6)*, Kristian Clarke lbw b Nabi 22 *(22b, 1x4, 1x6)*, Kyle Jamieson (not out) 19 *(21b, 1x4)*, Matt Henry run out 2 *(2b)*, Matthew Fisher run out 1 *(1b)*; Extras (b-4, lb-5, nb-2, w-3): 14; Total (in 50 overs): 333.

FALL OF WICKETS
1-85 (Seifert, 11.6 overs), 2-96 (Kelly, 14.2), 3-125 (Foxcroft, 19.3), 4-215 (Allen, 30.2), 5-256 (Young, 36.6), 6-258 (Bracewell, 37.5), 7-293 (Santner, 44.2), 8-318 (Clarke, 47.6), 9-332 (Henry, 49.5).

INDIA BOWLING
Arshdeep 10-0-55-1, Nabi 8-0-59-2, Gurnoor 10-0-69-2, Axar 10-0-39-2, Kuldeep 8-0-73-0, Dhir 4-0-29-1.

INDIA
Rohit Sharma c Allen b Henry 0 *(1b)*, Ruturaj Gaikwad c Bracewell b Jamieson 5 *(13b)*, Virat Kohli b Henry 0 *(4b)*, Shreyas Iyer lbw b Henry 0 *(1b)*, Ishan Kishan b Henry 27 *(53b, 4x4)*, Axar Patel c Allen b Fisher 21 *(36b, 3x4)*, Naman Dhir c Santner b Fisher 21 *(24b, 2x6)*, Auqib Nabi c Seifert b Fisher 5 *(8b, 1x4)*, Kuldeep Yadav b Henry 1 *(4b)*, Gurnoor Brar b Henry 2 *(13b)*, Arshdeep Singh (not out) 0 *(3b)*; Extras (w-7): 7; Total (in 26.4 overs): 89.

FALL OF WICKETS
1-0 (Rohit, 0.1), 2-0 (Kohli, 0.5), 3-0 (Shreyas, 0.6), 4-9 (Ruturaj, 5.3), 5-53 (Axar, 17.1), 6-61 (Kishan, 20.1), 7-66 (Nabi, 21.4), 8-69 (Kuldeep, 22.6), 9-83 (Dhir, 23.6).

NEW ZEALAND BOWLING
Henry 9.4-2-27-6, Jamieson 6-2-12-1, Clarke 2-0-13-0, Fisher 7-1-31-3, Bracewell 2-0-6-0.

Toss: India; **PoM:** Henry.
New Zealand won by 244 runs, India ahead 2-1.
Fifth and final ODI: Nov. 15, Mount Maunganui, 7.30 a.m. IST.

Sportstar book celebrates Tendulkar and Kohli's 15,000-run feat in ODIs

Sports Bureau

Only two batters have crossed the 15,000-run mark in ODI cricket: Sachin Tendulkar and Virat Kohli. Separated by generations but united by an extraordinary appetite for runs, the two greats are the subject of *The 15,000 Club: Two Generations, One Summit*, a special publication launched by *Sportstar* on Friday.

The book was formally launched by K.M. Mammen, Chairman and Managing Director of MRF Limited, and Rahul Mammen Mappillai, Managing Director of MRF Limited, in the presence of N. Murali, Chairman of the Board of Directors of *The Hindu* Group Publishing Private Limited (THGPPL), and N. Ram, Director of *The Hindu* Group. Also present were Ramesh Rangaranjan, Director, Kasturi & Sons Limited, and K. Venugopal, KSL Director.

The association between MRF and the two legends has its own place in cricketing history. Tendulkar's iconic 'Desert Storm' knocks in Sharjah in 1998, when he struck 143 and 134 against Australia, remain among the enduring images of his MRF years.

Kohli, too, produced several defining performances with the MRF branding on his bat, including his unbeaten 82 against Pakistan in the 2022 T20 World Cup in Australia.



The launch: K.M. Mammen and N. Murali hold the first copy of *The 15,000 Club: Two Generations, One Summit* at *The Hindu* office in Chennai on Friday. N. Ram and Rahul Mammen Mappillai are also seen. B. VELANKANNI RAJ

K.M. Mammen recalled Tendulkar's early association with the MRF Pace Foundation, where the prodigy had initially arrived hoping to become a fast bowler.

"When Dennis Lillee [the first Director of Coaching at the MRF Pace Foundation] saw him, he didn't want to upset him, but he made him bowl and then said, 'You are promoted.'

But Sachin was so adamant that he came back and said, 'Why don't you try me out for a little bit of batting?' That was when we saw his potential," Mammen said.

He also recalled the financial leap of faith MRF took when it first signed Tendulkar, at a time when the company was still establishing itself.

"When we signed Sachin, he asked for a substantial amount," Mammen said with a laugh. "But we did whatever it took to get him on board, and things just took off from there."

The *15,000 Club* goes beyond milestones and statistics to revisit the careers of the two stalwarts through extracts from original match reports from *The Hindu* and *Sportstar* archives, archival photographs and contemporary accounts.

Interviews with former teammates offer an intimate perspective on their methods, mindsets, personalities and influence in the dressing room.

Tracing Tendulkar's emergence as a wunderkind and Kohli's rise into a modern great, the book explores the continuities between two remarkable careers and the distinct legacies they have left on Indian cricket.

Debutant Beardman demolishes England

Agence France-Presse
PERTH

Mahli Beardman took six for 24 on debut before Mitchell Marsh smashed a 29-ball 50 as Australia crushed England by seven wickets in the first ODI here on Friday.

After Marsh chose to bowl, the 21-year-old Beardman tore through the England batting as the visitor was bundled out for 131 in 33.4 overs.

Beardman bowled with real pace and aggression to record the best ODI bowling figures by an Australian on debut.

Marsh then put the issue beyond doubt with a devastating half-century, hitting four boundaries and clearing the fence another four times to the delight of his home crowd.

The scores: England 131 in 33.4 overs (Johnson 3/42, Beardman 6/24) lost to Australia 132/3 in 23.3 overs (Marsh 50). **Toss:** Australia; **PoM:** Beardman.

Abhimanyu holds his own against Carlsen

TOTAL CHESS

Jayantho Sengupta
BUDAPEST

Abhimanyu Mishra had welcomed the chance to play Magnus Carlsen twice when the Total Chess World Championship Tour pilot's draw was announced. On Thursday, the youngest Grandmaster in the field drew both games against the World No. 1, who had to defend an inferior position in their second meeting.

Abhimanyu, the 17-year-old American with a rating of 2644 to Carlsen's 2823, held firm with black in round three of the Fast Classic group stage. The position in the Italian Game remained balanced despite Carlsen's bishop sacrifice on h6, and a rook exchange on move 50 led to a draw.

Carlsen chose the Scandinavian Defence in the return game, but his position worsened after he moved his king to d7 on move 26. Abhimanyu manoeuvred his knight to h5 and picked up the g7 and h6 pawns, gaining a substantial advantage. Carlsen reached an opposite-coloured bishop ending and held on for an 80-move draw, his fourth in as many games.



No way through: Abhimanyu put on an impressive defensive display. FLICKR.COM

Abhimanyu moved to three points in Group C, one behind Carlsen with six games to go. Ian Nepomniachtchi and Haik Martirosyan shared the lead with six points. Martirosyan and Anish Giri won a game each.

In Group D, Bibisara Assaubayeva (Elo 2532), upset the higher-rated Arjun Erigaisi (2746) with black in round three. Arjun won the return game, also with black, to draw level with Assaubayeva on five points and be placed third. R. Vaishali lost both games to Hans Niemann and stayed last with one point. Niemann joined Maxime Vachier-Lagrave on eight after the Frenchman secured a win and a draw against Wesley So.

R. Praggnanandhaa lost twice to Fabiano Caruana and remained bottom of Group B with two points. Caruana led with 10, two clear of Liem Le, who posted a win and a draw against Vincent Keymer. Alireza Firouzja led Group A with eight points after a win and a draw against Jorden van Foreest.

(The writer is in Budapest at the invitation of Total Chess).

Priyansh, Parneet top qualifiers

ARCHERY

Y.B. Sarangi
SHILLONG

Priyansh and Parneet Kaur bounced back from quieter phases of their respective careers to claim top position in compound men's and women's qualification rounds respectively in the National archery championships at the Parade Ground here on Friday.

Former World youth champion Priyansh shot brilliantly to gather 713, studded with 32 Xs, to beat 18-year-old challenger Mohit Dagar by just one point. Asian Games team gold medallist Kushal Dalal and former World champion Ojas Deotale took third and fourth spots with 710 and 707, respectively.

Parneet totalled 710 with the help of 28 Xs. Madhura Dhamangaonkar and Asian Games team gold winner Chikitha Taniparthi secured second and third places with 704 and 699, respectively.

While weather remained steady on a sunny day, wind tested the archers' skills.



Proving their class: Priyansh and Parneet shone in windy conditions. RITU RAJ KONWAR

Parneet, who rectified an issue with her gripping earlier this year, overcame the disappointment of missing out on a berth in the Asian Games to record two identical segments of 355 and claim the top rank. Later, she guided the Punjab women's team to the final.

Important results: Compound: Individual: Qualification round: Men: 1. Priyansh (Del) 713, 2. Mohit Dagar (Har) 712, 3. Kushal Dalal (Har) 710, 4. Ojas Deotale (Mah) 707, 5. Prathamesh Fuge (Mah) 707, 7. Rajat Chauhan (AIP) 707, 8. Abhishek Verma (Del) 707, 14. Rishabh Yadav (Har) 704, 18. Sahil Jadhav (RSPB) 702. **Women:** 1. Parneet Kaur (Pun) 710, 2. Madhura Dhamangaonkar (Mah) 704, 3. Chikitha Taniparthi (Tel) 699, 4. Nishtha Gupta (UP) 699, 5. Vaidehi Jadhav (Mah) 698, 7. Priya Gurjar (Raj) 698, Muskan Kirar (MP) 697, 15. Pragati (Del) 692, 18. Avneet Kaur (Pun) 691. **Team: Elimination: Men: Semifinals:** Punjab bt Rajasthan 235-232, Madhya Pradesh bt RSPB 233-233 (28-27 via shoot-off); **Bronze medal match:** Rajasthan bt RSPB 234-233. **Women: Semifinals:** Uttar Pradesh bt Maharashtra 233-231, Punjab bt Delhi 233-226.

INBRIEF



Shakeel ensures Pakistan-SL first Test ends in a draw

Saud Shakeel missed out on a century for the second successive time but his gritty 97 foiled Sri Lanka's push for a win on the fifth and final day in the drawn first Test against Pakistan in Rawalpindi on Friday. By the time Shakeel got out, the home team had reached 284 for eight for an overall lead of 272 as the players shook hands and the match was called off.

The scores: Pakistan 434/9 decl. & 284/8 in 84.5 overs (Saud Shakeel 97) drew with Sri Lanka 446; **PoM:** Saqib Khan.

Suraj makes Singapore Classic squash quarterfinals

Indian squash player Suraj Chand entered the men's singles quarterfinals of the Singapore Classic with a straight-game win over Benjamin Ratcliffe in the second round of the PSA Challenger event at the Kallang Squash Centre. The sixth-seeded Indian, who was crowned world university champion in August, beat his Australian opponent 11-6, 11-4, 11-4. He will next face Malaysian world No. 60 Sanjay Jeeva, who defeated Om Semwal 11-9, 11-9, 11-8 in the second round. In the women's competition, third seed Tanvi Khanna, Sanya Vats and Rathika Seelan bowed out following losses in the second round.

Argentina coach Scaloni renews contract until 2030

Argentina coach Lionel Scaloni renewed his contract with the national team through 2030, putting him on track to become the first manager to lead *La Albiceleste* at three World Cups.

Deepti and Jansen Players-of the-Month for October

India all-rounder Deepti Sharma and South Africa's Marco Jansen have been named the ICC Women's and Men's Players-of-the-Month for October.

Splendid Dream wins feature event

BENGALURU: Mr. Srinivasa M's Splendid Dream (Antony up) won the Sports Authority Of India Trophy (1,200m), the main event of the races held here on Friday (Nov. 13). The winner is trained by G. Sandhu.

THE RESULTS:

1. SHIMSHA PLATE (1,400m): THE GOLDEN DREAM (A. Asbar) 1, Absolute Thunder (Salman Khan) 2, Carter (Md. Talib) 3 and CR Seven (R. Vaibhav) 4. Not run: Days Date. 2-3/4, 4-1/2 and Lnk. 1m 28.71s. ₹50 (w), 18, 10 and 14 (p), SHP: 29, THP: 34, FP: 232, Q: 67, Trinella: 326/144, Exacta: 531/222. Favourite: Absolute Thunder. Owner: Mr. C.V. Prasad Rao. Trainer: M. Rajendra Singh.

2. HOGENAKKAL FALLS PLATE (1,600m): EMINENT GOLD (A. Asbar) 1, Mandate (Antony) 2, Blue Picasso (R. Pradeep) 3 and Desert Shield (N. Darshan) 4. 2-3/4, 3/4 and 1-1/2. 1m 38.64s. ₹23 (w), 10, 10 and 19 (p), SHP: 28, THP: 34, FP: 75, Q: 23, Trinella: 199/138, Exacta: 332/80. Favourite: Eminent Gold. Owners: Mr. Mukul A. Sonawala, Mr. Kian Byramji & Mr. Chetan Shantilal Shah. Trainer: Darius Byramji.

3. VIDURASHWATHA PLATE (Div. II), 1,200m: BORN TO RISE (Suraj) 1, Preview (Trevor) 2, Bellucci (Arvind K) 3 and Annabelle (Antony) 4. 4-1/2, 1-1/2 and 4-1/2. 1m 12.27s. ₹12 (w), 10, 15 and 14 (p), SHP: 22, THP: 30, FP: 25, Q: 25, Trinella: 65/35, Exacta: 92/48. Favourite: Born To Rise. Owners: Mr. S. Narredu, Mr. Daulat Chhabria, Mr. Ashok Ranpise, Mr. Akshay Dattatray Ranpise & Mr. Raghu S. Trainer: S. Narredu.

4. ROYAL CALCUTTA TURF CLUB CUP (1,600m): ROYAL VANGUARD (Trevor) 1, Knightbridge (Akshay K) 2, Conquistador (Suraj) 3 and Lorenzo (Srinath) 4. 5-1/2, 3/4 and 3/4. 1m 37.96s. ₹19 (w), 10 and 23 (p), SHP: 31, THP: 31, FP: 83, Q: 46, Trinella: 67/37, Exacta: 112/80. Favourite: Royal Vanguard. Owners: M/s. Blazing Saddles(PF), Mr. P. Prasanna Kumar & Mr. Anil Saraf. Trainer: Prasanna Kumar.

5. SPORTS AUTHORITY OF INDIA TROPHY (1,200m): SPLENDID DREAM (Antony) 1, Carat Love (A. Hangal) 2, Absolute Force (Ganesh S) 3 and Agera (Jagadeesh) 4. Lnk, 2-1/4 and 4. 1m 13.75s. ₹20 (w), 12, 17 and 46 (p), SHP: 57, THP: 117, FP: 156, Q: 111, Trinella: 2,111/2,262, Exacta: 48,945 (c/o)/10,488. Favourite: Flight Of Fancy. Owner: Mr. Srinivasa. M. Trainer: G. Sandhu.

6. HEBBE FALLS PLATE (1,400m): SCARLETTE LADY (Srinath) 1, Star Honour (M. Prabhakaran) 2, Joyful Spirit (Lave Kumar) 3 and Augusto (Arvind K) 4. 3, Nk and 3/4. 1m 26.13s. ₹19 (w), 13, 19 and 21 (p), SHP: 47, THP: 50, FP: 149, Q: 86, Trinella: 396/213, Exacta: 2,712/1,030. Favourite: Scarlette Lady. Owners: Mr. Chethan Neelakanta, Mrs. Sreya Bose & Mr. Ashok Ranpise. Trainer: K. Purushotham.

7. VIDURASHWATHA PLATE (Div. I), 1,200m: RAVISHING QUEEN (Suraj) 1, Whistling Glory (Antony) 2, Rocking Star (A. Hangal) 3 and Everynne (Akshay K) 4. Not run: Icing. 2, 1-3/4 and 1. 1m 12.96s. ₹14 (w), 10, 15 and 21 (p), SHP: 29, THP: 47, FP: 39, Q: 26, Trinella: 202/154, Exacta: 421/146. Favourite: Ravishing Queen. Owners: Mr. K. Kaliyaperumal, Mr. M. Rishad, Mr. P.J. Vazifdar, Mrs. P.J. Vazifdar & Mr. S.R. Sanas. Trainer: James Mckeown.

Jackpot: ₹536; Runner-up: 122; Mini Jackpot: 638; Treble (i): 77; (ii): 213.

LIVE TELECAST

SMAT: JioHotstar, 8.30 a.m.

Men's u-19 Asia Cup: India vs. Pakistan, Sony Sports Ten 1 & LIV, 10.30 a.m.

Afghanistan vs. Zimbabwe: Second Test, day 2, FanCode, 11.30 a.m.

SAFF Championships: India vs. Bhutan, VETO App, 2.30 p.m. & 8 p.m.

Football: Nations League, Sony Sports Ten 1, 2, 5 & LIV, 10.30 p.m. & 1.15 a.m. (Sunday)

A scouting ground and a life-changing opportunity

The domestic T20 tournament offers hope both for the rookies and seasoned campaigners; teen sensation and Bihar skipper Sooryavanshi could be this edition's biggest attraction

SMAT

S. Prasanna Venkatesan
INDORE

The most revealing feature of the Syed Mushtaq Ali Trophy (SMAT) last season was not necessarily what happened on the field, but who was watching. Several IPL franchises were represented: Parthiv Patel and Vikram Solanki were in attendance for Gujarat Titans (GT), John Wright for Mumbai Indians (MI), K.B. Arun Karthick for Chennai Super Kings (CSK), and Varun Aaron for Sunrisers Hyderabad (SRH). The national selectors, led then by Ajit Agarkar, were also present.

It was an unusually visible reminder that the tournament is a scouting ground, a second audition and, occasionally, a career-changing opportunity.

Ishan Kishan was last season's most conspicuous beneficiary, his title-winning campaign for Jharkhand earning him a recall to the Indian team for the 2026 T20 World Cup.

Mukul Choudhary's astonishing 26-run final over assault against Delhi and Salil Arora's explosive batting earned them IPL contracts with Lucknow Super Giants (LSG) and SRH. Kartik Sharma's ability to take on spin impressed Arun Karthick, while Urvil Patel made a compelling case for a place in CSK's playing XI with a scintillating 37-ball 119 against Services on the opening day.



Precocious talent: Sooryavanshi, right, has it in him to light up the competition with his dazzling strokeplay. ANI

The tournament has room for every variety of cricket hope again this season. For established internationals such as Suryakumar Yadav, Shardul Thakur, and Mohammed Shami, it offers competitive game time and an opportunity to push for a return to the Indian team.

For Prithvi Shaw, who last played an IPL match in 2024, it is about persuading the cricket world to invest in his talent again.

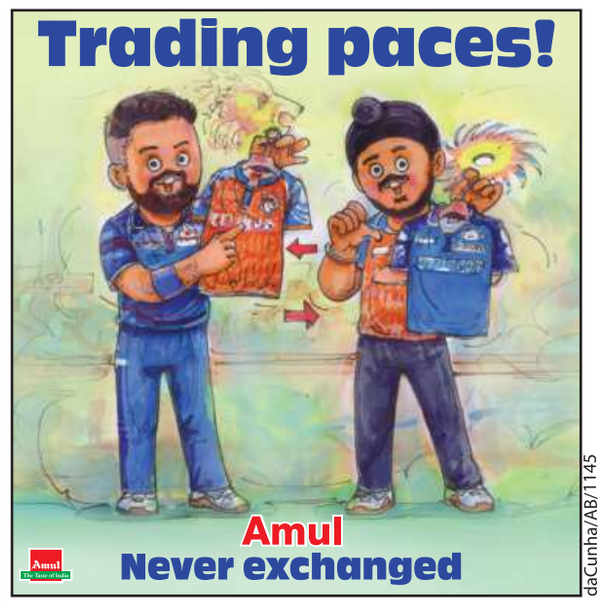
Then there are players who have known the IPL, if only fleetingly, and have since slipped out of its orbit. Virat Singh and Ashwin Hebbar belong to this category. Manisankar Murasingh, meanwhile, has spent years doing the hard, unglamorous work of domestic cricket, producing performances and waiting for the larger rewards to follow.

Andre Siddarth and Shaik Rasheed occupy the uncomfortable space between recognised potential and professional reward, having missed out on the IPL 2026 auction shortlist. It is an assembly of cricket fortunes: those who have made it, those who nearly made it, those who made it and slipped away, and those who believe their moment is overdue.

Perhaps this season's biggest draw is the tournament's youngest centurion, the 15-year-old global sensation Vaibhav Sooryavanshi, who will captain Bihar in its first two matches.

SYED MUSHTAQ ALI TROPHY - SATURDAY'S MATCHES

Elite: Group A: At Mumbai: Chandigarh vs. Baroda, Mizoram vs. Jharkhand, Rajasthan vs. Uttar Pradesh, Karnataka vs. Bengal.
Group B: Indore: Punjab vs. Haryana, Saurashtra vs. Bihar, Railways vs. Tamil Nadu, Jammu & Kashmir vs. Delhi.
Group C: Mohali & New Chandigarh: Maharashtra vs. Puducherry, Tripura vs. Andhra, Himachal Pradesh vs. Assam, Madhya Pradesh vs. Kerala.
Group D: Kolkata: Hyderabad vs. Mumbai, Gujarat vs. Odisha, Vidarbha vs. Goa, Uttarakhand vs. Chhattisgarh.
Plate: Sovima: Nagaland vs. Meghalaya, Arunachal Pradesh vs. Manipur, Services vs. Sikkim.



BFI signs MoU with Basketball Australia

Sports Bureau
CHENNAI

The Basketball Federation of India (BFI) has signed a three-year Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with Basketball Australia. The partnership is aimed at strengthening coach, referee and player development and fostering closer sporting ties between the two countries.

According to a BFI release on Friday, the collaboration will include friendly matches, exchange programmes and international exposure tours, particularly for the junior players.

The two federations will also facilitate knowledge-sharing in sports science, high-performance development and modern training methodologies. The tie-up will extend to sharing expertise and best practices in sports governance, sports administration and institutional development.



BFI president Aadhav with Consul General of Australia in Chennai Silai Zaki, centre, and Vice-Consul General Katrina Knapp.

The MoU was signed virtually by Aadhav Arjuna, president of the BFI. Basketball Australia was represented by its Chief Executive Officer Matt Scriven and general manager (Government and International Relations) Tristan Russell.



Special ability: Mayank can swing the ball at speed.
FILE PHOTO: K.R. DEEPAK

Mayank a big boost for Delhi: Sanjeev

Vivek Krishnan
NEW DELHI

Not since 2023 has Mayank Yadav featured for Delhi in domestic cricket. Considering the speedster's tryst with injuries, India has chosen to polish the diamond in the rough under its close watch. After playing three T20Is for the Men in Blue in 2024, in the wake of an eye-catching IPL season for Lucknow Super Giants (LSG), he returned to international cricket this year with appearances against Zimbabwe, West Indies and New Zealand.

With the 2026-27 Syed Mushtaq Ali Trophy – the domestic T20 competition – kicking off on Saturday, Mayank's highly-anticipated return for Delhi will come against Jammu & Kashmir at the Holkar Stadium in Indore. The young tearaway is available for the entire tournament.

Delhi's bowling coach Sanjeev Sharma is enthused by the attributes that Mayank will bring to the table. "His presence is a big boost for the team. He is looking very fit. He was getting the ball to swing in the air at speed during the net sessions. There is a day's gap after every match in the group stage. So he looks ready to play all the games," the former India pacer told *The Hindu* over the phone.

He rates the 24-year-old as a natural wicket-taker given his searing pace. "Anyone who bowls 145kmph-plus is a wicket-taker. Such bowlers can change the game at any stage," Sanjeev, who played two Tests and 23 ODIs for India, reckoned.

Delhi's bowling unit also comprises the experienced Ishant Sharma. Five years since playing the last of his 105 Tests, the 38-year-old adds immeasurable wisdom to the outfit. Harshit Rana, Simarjeet Singh, Digvesh Rathi and Suyash Sharma are the other bowlers at Delhi's disposal.

"Ishant is 38, but he looks more like 32. He is full of energy and always guiding the younger bowlers," noted Sanjeev. "If he has committed to playing, he will deliver".

Sayan rejoins Bengal's Mushtaq Ali Trophy squad after father's demise

Shayan Acharya

Sayan Ghosh had travelled to Mumbai with the Bengal squad on Wednesday, looking ahead to another important assignment in the Syed Mushtaq Ali Trophy.

But the tournament quickly took a back seat when news arrived in the early hours of Thursday that his father, who had been battling lung cancer for some time, had passed away. The pacer rushed back to Kolkata to be with his family and attend the last rites. It was a difficult moment for Sayan, and there was little thought of cricket in those hours.

But on Friday evening, Sayan was back in Mumbai, rejoining the Bengal squad. He arrived at the Wankhede Stadium for a training session ahead of the marquee clash against Karnataka. The grief was still fresh, but Sayan wanted to be with the team. Confirming his return, Cricket Association of Bengal (CAB) treasurer Sanjay Das told *The Hindu*: "He has joined the team. He wanted to be with his teammates, and we will constantly back him."



Duty calls: Sayan put his personal grief behind him and returned to training on Friday. FILE PHOTO: K. MURALI KUMAR

Bengal coach Laxmi Ratan Shukla, meanwhile, praised Sayan's spirit and determination.

"He was determined to come back. His father had been suffering for a long time, and he always wanted Sayan to play cricket. So, Sayan wanted to return and be with the team as a tribute to his father, while also finding comfort in being around his teammates," Shukla said.

The CAB and team management have assured Sayan of their support as he navigates this difficult phase.

Lakshya in semifinal; Srikanth crashes out

BADMINTON

Press Trust of India
KUMAMOTO (JAPAN)

Lakshya Sen kept India's flag flying at the Kumamoto Masters Japan Super 500 badminton tournament by reaching the semifinals, while veteran shuttler K. Srikanth bowed out after a loss here on Friday.

World No. 13 Lakshya, who needs to break into the top eight of the BWF World Tour rankings to qualify for the season-ending tournament in China, outwitted Japan's Yushi Tanaka 21-16, 21-15 in a 40-minute quarterfinal.

Eighth seed Lakshya is currently 12th in the BWF World Tour rankings with 64,980 points.

He will face sixth seed Alwi Farhan of Indonesia in the semifinals. The Indian has lost both his previous meetings with the World No. 10.



Lakshya. FILE PHOTO: SHIV KUMAR PUSHPAKAR

World No. 31 Srikanth, however, once again struggled for consistency as he looked in control for much of the match but suffered an inexplicable meltdown in the second game to lose 22-24, 15-21 to Japan's World No. 15 Koki Watanabe.

SNAPSHOTS

Cummins dismisses Khawaja's claims as 'utter nonsense'

SYDNEY: Pat Cummins on Friday said Usman Khawaja was "100% wrong" in claiming the whole team knew about Sandpapergate, prompting David Warner to accuse the Australia captain of throwing the former opener "under the bus". "When he says we all knew, if by that he means we knew sandpaper was going out on the field, he's 100% wrong," Cummins said. "I did not know it was happening. But I think Usman actually says things that are far more serious than that. He says that I and others were architects of a scheme to ball tamper with sandpaper. That's utter nonsense."



Cummins. REUTERS

Ikwaput's late strike wins it for East Bengal

KOLKATA: East Bengal FC began its title defence with a dramatic 1-0 victory over Gokulam Kerala FC in the Indian Women's League on Friday. Ugandan Fazila Ikwaput found the net in the second minute of added time to secure all three points.

Razmi, Gurbaxani notch up victories

INDORE: India's Rayaan Razmi outclassed Nepal's Wangchyu Tamang 4-0 in the first stage of the IBSF World snooker championships. Kreishh Gurbaxani outplayed Sabin Tamang of Nepal 4-0, and Iraq's Ahmed Mustafa 4-0.